

**PHILIPPINE OBSTETRICAL AND GYNECOLOGICAL SOCIETY
(FOUNDATION), INC.**

ADMINISTRATIVE MANUAL 2026

**CHAPTER 1
MEMBERSHIP**

I. CATEGORIES OF MEMBERSHIP

The membership of the Philippine Obstetrical and Gynecological Society (POGS) Foundation shall be in the following categories: Fellow, Diplomate, Junior, Associate, Affiliate and Honorary Member.

A. Fellow – a Diplomate in Obstetrics and Gynecology (OB-GYN) who, after a prescribed period, has been approved by the Board of Trustees (BOT) upon the recommendation of the Committee on Credentials and Membership and the Committee on Ethics and Medical Practice (CEMP). All Fellows at the time of adoption of the 1978 By-Laws shall fall under this category.

1. Life Member – a Fellow who has any of the following qualifications:
 - a. Reached the age of sixty-five (65) with at least ten (10) years of continuous status
 - b. Completed twenty-five (25) years as an active Fellow, has applied to the BOT, and has been approved as such
 - c. Served the POGS Foundation as President

**APPLICATION GUIDELINES FOR LIFE MEMBERSHIP
(for Category B)**

Requirements:

1. Active Fellow for at least twenty-five (25) years
2. Fellow in good standing
3. Attended the Annual Convention and Business Meeting for the last three (3) consecutive years
4. Duly accomplished Life Membership Application Form (Appendix I: Life Membership Application Form)
5. Letter of intent addressed to the Chair of the Committee on Credentials and Membership

Administrative Procedure:

1. The applicant shall submit the required documents to POGS office.
2. The Committee on Credentials and Membership shall validate the qualifications of the applicant.
3. The Committee shall recommend to the BOT the approval / disapproval of the application.
4. The Committee shall send a letter to the applicant informing the status of his/her application.

5. Once approved, the Life Membership Fee shall be paid on or before the date specified by the Committee, in the amount approved by the BOT upon the recommendation of the Committee.
6. The Life Member status shall take effect on the 1st day of January of the following year.
7. The Life Member shall subsequently be exempted from paying the annual dues.

2. **Honorary Fellow** – one who has been nominated by at least two (2) active Fellows and recommended by the **Committee on Credentials and Membership**, with the approval by the **BOT**, for having any of the following:

- a. Gained national and/or international recognition in the field of OB-GYN
- b. Earned a distinction by performing extraordinary humanitarian service in the field of OB-GYN
- c. Rendered meritorious services to the POGS Foundation

B. **Diplomate** – an obstetrician-gynecologist who has fulfilled the requirements set forth by the **Philippine Board of Obstetrics and Gynecology (PBOG)** and has been duly recognized by the **BOT**.

REINSTATEMENT GUIDELINES FOR DIPLOMATES AND FELLOWS DROPPED FROM THE MEMBERSHIP ROLL

These guidelines are intended to ensure that Diplomates or Fellows who were dropped from the roll of members due to non-compliance with the POGS Foundation's policies, and who now seek to reinstate their membership with the intent to resume private practice in the Philippines, are sufficiently updated and aligned with current competencies and standards of care in the field of OB-GYN.

I. Eligibility for Reinstatement

The applicant shall:

1. Have previously been a Diplomate or Fellow who was dropped from the roll.
2. Signify intent to resume permanent practice in the Philippines.
3. Have no unresolved legal or ethical case related to medical practice.

II. Reinstatement Requirements

1. Submission of one (1) certificate of attendance each for the Annual Convention and a postgraduate course, with a combined total of 30 PRC-CPD units
2. Participation in a skills-based program (e.g. PRIME Program)
3. Settlement of Financial Obligations as certified by the Committee on Finance
4. Submission of Documents
 - a. Letter of intent addressed to the BOT
 - b. Updated PRC license and PMA membership
 - c. Proof of local practice intent (e.g., clinic/hospital affiliation or job contract)
 - d. Curriculum vitae and summary of professional activity abroad

III. In cases where there is prolonged absence from OB-GYN clinical practice or where doubt about clinical readiness exists, the Committee on Credentials and Membership may call for an interview or assessment.

IV. Upon compliance with all the above, reinstatement takes effect on the date approved by the BOT upon recommendation of the Committee on Credentials and Membership.

Checklist for Reinstatement

- Letter of Intent
- Certificate of Attendance (2 of 3 conventions)
- Updated PRC License
- PMA Membership Certificate
- Updated CV
- Documentation of OB-GYN CME/CPD
- Participation in POGS Reorientation Program Activities
- Proof of Local Practice
- Settlement of Arrears (as verified by the Committee on Finance)
- Committee Interview (if applicable)

Committee Action: _____ BOT Approval: _____

C. Junior Member – an obstetrician-gynecologist who has the following qualifications:

1. Completed an accredited residency training program in OB-GYN in the Philippines or an equivalent training program abroad
2. Passed Part I of the certifying examinations given by the PBOG
3. Applied for and has been recommended by the Committee on Credentials and Membership and approved by the BOT

The Junior Member shall have attained Diplomate status within five (5) years of his/her admission or be dropped from the rolls.

D. Associate Member – an obstetrician-gynecologist who was approved as such by the BOT prior to 1985.

E. Affiliate Member – an obstetrician-gynecologist who has the following qualifications:

1. Completed an accredited residency training program in OB-GYN in the Philippines or an equivalent training program abroad
2. Applied for and has been recommended by the Committee on Credentials and Membership and approved by the BOT

The Affiliate Member shall be required to fulfill the requirements set forth by the regio` within five (5) years from graduation to be upgraded as Junior Member or be dropped from the rolls.

F. Honorary Member – an individual from any field of endeavor who has been nominated by an active Fellow and approved as such by the BOT for meritorious service to the POGS Foundation.

II. REQUIREMENTS FOR ADMISSION

A. Fellow

1. The candidate shall:
 - a. Be a Diplomate of good standing. Good standing means no outstanding annual dues and must have attended two (2) Annual Conventions over the last three (3) years. In exceptional cases where attendance at the Annual Convention is not feasible, attendance at the Midyear Convention may be recognized as a substitute for one (1) Annual Convention, subject to approval by the BOT upon the recommendation of the Committee on Credentials and Membership.
 - b. Have devoted oneself to the practice of the specialty for at least two (2) years.
 - c. Have good moral values, including honesty in disclosure.
 - d. Conform with the norms of ethics and professionalism of the discipline.
 - e. Follow good clinical practice.
 - f. Be free of any form of litigation or medicolegal issues. However, the POGS Foundation, through the Committee on Credentials and Membership, may reconsider candidates who have already served the penalty.
 - g. Be endorsed as professionally competent and morally upright by two (2) active Fellows.
 - h. Be invited by the POGS Foundation through the Committee on Credentials and Membership and upheld by the CEMP and shall be physically present during the induction at the time and place designated by the BOT.
2. The Fellow status shall take effect on the 1st day of January of the following year.

GUIDELINES REGARDING THE INVITATION FOR DIPLOMATES TO BECOME FELLOWS

The requirements for candidates for Fellows are as enumerated in Section II.A.

The list of invited Diplomates should be published at a prescribed period of time to allow proper deliberation.

Qualifications of the Endorser:

The FIRST ENDORSER shall:

1. Be a Fellow in good standing.
2. NOT be a member of the BOT, Committee on Credentials and Membership and Committee on Awards.
3. NOT be a first degree relative by affinity and consanguinity.
4. Be from the same region as the candidate's current place of practice.
5. Have known the candidate for at least three (3) years.

The SECOND ENDORSER shall:

1. Be a Fellow in good standing.
2. NOT be a member of the BOT, Committee on Credentials and Membership and Committee on Awards.
3. NOT be a first degree relative by affinity and consanguinity.

4. Be any of the following:
 - a. Chair of the Department of OB-GYN or Medical Director (POGS member) of an accredited residency training institution, and shall belong to the institution where the candidate has his/her main practice as an obstetrician-gynecologist. In case the accreditation for residency training has been revoked, the current Chair of the Department can still be the second endorser.
 - b. POGS Regional Director of the region where the candidate currently practices

The list of Diplomates to be invited shall be given to the Regional Directors to check their status in their respective regions. The Regional Directors shall submit a confirmation report that the candidates are members of good standing or if there are ethical or legal issues where they are currently involved.

B. Diplomate

1. The candidate shall:
 - a. Have passed Part I and Part II of the certifying examination given by the PBOG.
 - b. Be physically present during the induction at the time and place designated by the BOT.
2. The Diplomate status shall take effect on the 1st day of January of the following year.

C. Junior Member

1. The candidate shall:
 - a. Have passed Part I of the certifying examination given by the PBOG.
 - b. Be a member in good standing of the Philippine Medical Association (PMA).
 - c. Comply with the current PBOG Handbook.
2. The Junior Member status shall take effect on the 1st day of January of the following year.

D. Affiliate Member

1. The candidate shall:
 - a. Have completed an accredited residency training program in OB-GYN in the Philippines or an equivalent training program abroad.
 - b. Be a member in good standing of the PMA.
 - c. Have applied for membership using the prescribed form, which must bear the signature/endorsement of the respective Regional Director, and has been recommended by the Committee on Credentials and Membership for approval by the BOT.
 - d. Be free of any form of litigation or medicolegal issues. However, the POGS Foundation, through the Committee on Credentials and Membership, may reconsider candidates who have already served the penalty.
2. The Affiliate Member status shall take effect on the 1st day of January of the following year.
3. Application Procedure:
 - a. The complete application shall be submitted no later than the 31st day of July of the current year to ensure membership effectivity on the 1st day of January of the subsequent year.

- b. The process of application, review and monitoring shall be managed by the Committee on Credentials and Membership.
- c. The candidate shall submit certificates of attendance from OB-GYN related activities with a minimum of 35 Continuing Professional Development (CPD) units attended within one (1) year prior to the application.

III. RIGHTS

- A. All members are entitled to the following:
 - 1. Participate in all official functions of the POGS Foundation
 - 2. Right to vote
 - 3. Avail of Certificates of Membership
 - 4. Receive support from the POGS Foundation for any worthwhile undertaking of professional nature
 - 5. Receive benefits as provided for in the regulations of the Committee on Mutual Assistance Program (CMAP)
 - 6. Express grievances against the POGS Foundation, its instrumentalities or any of its members
- B. Fellows and Diplomates shall have the right to affix the letters F.P.O.G.S. and D.P.O.G.S. respectively, after their names, as applicable.
- C. Honorary Fellows shall have the right to affix the letters F.P.O.G.S. (Hon.)
- D. Honorary Fellows, Honorary and Affiliate Members may avail of the above rights except the right to vote and be voted upon.

IV. PRIVILEGES

- A. Members may receive honoraria for services rendered in projects and activities collaborated with and funded by international and/or national development agencies, societies and organizations.
- B. Fellows and Diplomates may serve as official delegates of the POGS Foundation to any government and/or non-government fora.
- C. Diplomates, Junior and Affiliate Members may avail of the above privileges except to be nominated as BOT or Regional Director.

V. DUTIES AND OBLIGATIONS

- A. The members of the POGS Foundation shall:
 - 1. Maintain the high standards of professional conduct set forth in the Membership Pledge of the POGS Foundation. (See Chapter on Protocol)
 - 2. Conduct oneself in a manner consistent with the tenets and principles of the PMA Code of Medical Ethics and of the POGS Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct 2025 Edition.
 - 3. Attend at least two (2) out of three (3) consecutive Annual and/or Midyear Conventions.
 - 4. Pay all dues, fees and assessments promptly.
 - 5. Be a member in good standing of the PMA.
- B. Regional affiliation of members:

Members shall affiliate themselves in the region/chapter where their main place of practice in OB-GYN is conducted. This should be included and emphasized in the invitation letter to candidates for Diplomates and Fellows.
- C. An Associate Member, in addition to the above duties and obligations, shall attend at least one (1) Continuing Medical Education (CME) activity recognized by the POGS Foundation in a given year.

VI. DUES, FEES AND ASSESSMENTS

- A. All members shall pay all dues, fees and assessments in the amount and terms as determined by the BOT.
- B. A member with unpaid dues for two (2) consecutive years, despite proper notification, shall be referred to the Committee on Credentials and Membership for proper action.
- C. A member who has retired due to sickness shall apply for exemption from payment of dues; otherwise, he/she shall be considered in arrears.
- D. The following are exempted from paying annual dues and convention fees:
 - 1. Life Members
 - 2. Honorary Fellows
 - 3. Honorary Members

VII. DISCIPLINARY PROVISIONS

For disciplinary provisions, refer to the Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct 2025 Edition, Article XII: Enforcement and Accountability.

VIII. FELLOW IN GOOD STANDING

- A. Fellow is in good standing if he/she:
 - 1. Has physically attended and has been issued a Certificate of Attendance in at least two (2) out of three (3) consecutive Annual Conventions and Annual Business Meetings.
 - 2. Is NOT under censure or suspension from membership, as certified by the Board Secretary.
 - 3. Is NOT delinquent in the payment of his/her financial obligations. Delinquency in payments must be certified by the Treasurer.
 - 4. Has been certified to be in good standing by the Regional Director.
 - 5. Is a member in good standing of the PMA.
- B. A Certificate of Good Standing shall be issued by the POGS Foundation upon request.

PROCESS OF ISSUANCE OF CERTIFICATE OF GOOD STANDING

1. The Certificate of Good Standing serves as the official documentation that a member complies with all requirements for the status as defined in Section VIII.
2. Requirements for Member Submission:
 - a. Proof of payment of current and previous year's annual dues, ensuring the member is not delinquent in financial obligations (Section VIII.A.3)
 - b. Submission of clearance or a certification of good standing from the respective POGS Regional Director (Section VIII.A.4)
 - c. Submission of a copy of the Certificate of Good Standing from the PMA and its local component society (Section VIII.A.5)
3. Mandatory Internal Verification:
 - a. The member has complied with the attendance requirements of the POGS Foundation (Section VIII.1).
 - b. The member is not currently under censure, suspension or any pending disciplinary action from the POGS Foundation (Section VIII.A.2).
4. Procedure for Issuance
Upon the successful verification of all requirements specified in Section VIII, the official Certificate of Good Standing shall be issued by the POGS Foundation through the Committee on Credentials and Membership in digital or hard copy format.

CHAPTER 2 GOVERNANCE

I. PROVISIONS

- A. The POGS Foundation shall be governed by a BOT whose executive arm shall be the Officers.
- B. The members of the BOT shall be active Fellows for at least five (5) consecutive years immediately prior to their election and have not been disqualified under any of the provisions of the Election Code. Only those who have completed five (5) years of membership of good standing at the date of the election are qualified.
- C. The BOT shall take their oath of office during the Annual Convention.
- D. The term of office of the BOT shall commence on the 1st day of January and shall terminate on the 31st day of December of the same year.
- E. The BOT shall not receive any salary for services rendered to the POGS Foundation. However, expenses incurred in the performance of such services may be reimbursed upon the approval by the BOT.

II. GOVERNING BODY

A. BOARD OF TRUSTEES

- 1. The BOT shall be the governing body and shall consist of at least fifteen (15) members, five (5) of whom shall be the Officers, and the rest shall be Board Members: eleven (11) from the NCR, two (2) from Luzon, one (1) from the Visayas and one (1) from Mindanao.
- 2. The members of the BOT shall be elected by the general membership who are eligible to vote. The rules and regulations governing the manner and conduct of the elections shall be provided for in the Election Code.
- 3. The corporate powers of the POGS Foundation shall be vested upon the BOT, who shall exercise any and all incidental and implied powers to carry out the objectives in the best interest of the POGS Foundation.
 - a. The decision made by the BOT as authorized by the Bylaws is final, subject only to appeal to the body upon written petition of at least 10% of the general voting population of members in good standing. A majority vote (50 + 1) by the BOT is required to reverse the decision of the BOT.
 - b. The authority of the BOT is almost absolute. However, it is prudent that the general membership be consulted through a Town Hall meeting on major issues or affiliations,

and on matters concerning contracts or projects. The attendees of the Town Hall meeting shall include, at the minimum, the BOT, Regional Directors, Chapter Presidents and Past Presidents.

4. The members of the BOT shall serve for a term of one (1) year and until the election and qualification of their respective successors. They may be re-elected for not more than two (2) consecutive terms.
5. The BOT shall meet regularly as scheduled and shall be empowered to meet more frequently or to cancel meetings, as deemed necessary.
6. Any member of the BOT may be removed from office for culpable violation of the Bylaws by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the general membership after discussion or deliberation in a special meeting.
 - a. The members of the POGS Foundation shall be notified of the proposed removal at least two (2) weeks prior to the voting.
 - b. Removal from office is a serious punishment. There must be overwhelming evidence of the gravity of the offense for the BOT to resort to such action.
7. In case of resignation,
 - a. An elected member of the BOT shall tender the letter of resignation to the BOT.
 - b. When an Officer of the BOT resigns from his/her position, he/she may remain as its member.
 - c. All appointed members of various committees shall tender the letter of resignation to the BOT.
8. In case of vacancy,
 - a. The next ranking candidate/s in the national election shall be declared the successor/s to hold office for the unexpired term of the member concerned.
 - b. A special meeting of the BOT shall be called by the President who shall then announce the successor within thirty (30) days.
 - c. If the vacancy leaves the BOT without a quorum, immediate action (within 7-15 days) is advisable to comply with the corporate governance rules. The Revised Corporate Code of the Philippines (R.A. 11232) provides guidance on filling board vacancies for nonstock, nonprofit organizations.

B. OFFICERS

1. The officers of the POGS Foundation shall consist of the following: The President, the Vice President, the Board Secretary, the Treasurer and the Public Relations Officer (PRO). They shall constitute the Executive Committee (EXECOM) of the BOT.
 - a. All fifteen (15) members of the BOT, sitting en banc, shall elect among themselves the officers of the POGS Foundation, except the Board Secretary who shall be appointed by the President. The candidates with the highest votes shall be declared elected.
 - b. An Officer shall hold only one (1) position in the EXECOM, but may hold other positions outside the EXECOM.

- c. The BOT may create new positions as it deems necessary for the efficient operation of the POGS Foundation.
2. The rules and regulations governing the manner and conduct of the election of the Officers shall be provided for in the Election Code.
3. It is mandatory that the candidate for President shall have served as the Vice President immediately prior to the election.
4. It is mandatory that the candidate for the Vice President shall have served in the BOT for at least one (1) year within the last five (5) years prior to the election.
5. The President and Vice President shall each serve for a term of one (1) year.
6. Any Officer may be removed from the EXECOM for culpable violation of the Bylaws by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the BOT in two (2) successive meetings, and by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the general membership in a special meeting.
7. In case of a vacancy in the EXECOM, excluding the Board Secretary, the vacated position shall be filled through an election conducted among the remaining members of the BOT within thirty (30) working days. The newly elected Officer shall serve for the unexpired period of the term only.

C. DUTIES OF THE OFFICERS

1. The President shall:
 - a. Act as the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the POGS Foundation.
 - b. Act as Presiding Officer in the meetings of the BOT, the Annual Business Meeting and special meetings.
 - c. Be responsible for the successful implementation and execution of all the policies approved by the BOT.
 - d. Appoint Chairs and members of all standing, statutory, constitutional and Ad Hoc committees, subject to the approval by the BOT.
 - e. Serve as Chair of the Committee on External Affairs.
 - f. Serve as an Ex-officio member of all the standing committees.
 - g. Serve as an Editorial Consultant of the Philippine Journal of Obstetrics and Gynecology (PJOG).
 - h. Render a report during the Annual Business Meeting.
 - i. Serve concurrently as the official representative to the House of Delegates of the PMA and Chair of its Scientific Session in OB-GYN.
 - j. Represent the POGS Foundation in the General Assembly Meeting of the International Federation of Gynaecology and Obstetrics (FIGO), the Asia and Oceania Federation of Obstetrics and Gynaecology (AOFOG) and the Medical Association of Southeast Asian Nations (MASEAN) Chapter of OB-GYN, by virtue of the Foundation's affiliation in those organizations.

The President shall be given a subsidy as official representative to FIGO or AOFOG Congress. This subsidy shall cover the following:

- 1) Airfare: Premium Economy for flights less than 8 hours, and Business Class for flights exceeding or equal to 8 hours
 - 2) Accommodation: Single occupancy accommodation at the official convention hotel
 - 3) Daily allowance: A maximum of 100 US Dollars per day for the duration of convention. All expenses shall be supported by appropriate receipts and shall be fully liquidated within a month after the convention.
- k. Perform all other duties usually associated with the office of the President.

NOTE: The Presidential rotation shall be in the following sequence:

1. Far Eastern University – Nicanor Reyes Medical Foundation (FEU-NRMF)
2. University of the East Ramon Magsaysay Memorial Medical Center (UERMMMC)
3. Government
4. University of Santo Tomas (UST)
5. University of the Philippines, Manila – Philippine General Hospital (UP-PGH)
6. Manila Central University – Dr. Filemon D. Tanchoco Medical Foundation (MCU-FDTMF)
7. Private
8. Regional

Any change in this rotation requires a unanimous decision of all parties involved.

2. The Vice President shall:
 - a. Assist the President in the performance of duties.
 - b. Act as President in the temporary absence of the latter.
 - c. Succeed the President in case of permanent disability, death, removal from office or resignation of the latter but only for the unexpired term.
 - d. Serve as the Chair of the Organizing Committee of the Annual Convention.
 - e. Serve as Chair of the Committee on Internal Affairs.
 - f. Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the President and the BOT.
3. The Board Secretary shall:
 - a. Be the custodian of all records and properties of the POGS Foundation and shall oversee the day-to-day business of the Administrative Staff, and shall supervise the Executive Officer and the Secretariat in the performance of their duties.
 - b. Record and keep the minutes of all meetings of the POGS Foundation and the BOT.
 - c. Prepare the agenda and serve due notices of all meetings of the POGS Foundation and of the BOT in accordance with the Bylaws.
 - d. Issue the program and invitations to all the functions of the POGS Foundation.
 - e. Keep and maintain an updated registry of all members of the POGS Foundation.
 - f. Serve as the Chair of the Committee on Credentials and Membership and CMAP.
 - g. Serve as liaison officer between the BOT and PBOG, Council for Residents' Education, Enhancement and Development (CREED), Committee on Finance, CEMP, Committee

on Information Dissemination and Communication Technology (ICT), Committee on Bids and Awards (BAC).

- h. Act as the Protocol Officer of the POGS Foundation.
- i. Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the President and the BOT.

4. The Treasurer shall:

- a. Act as custodian of all funds, securities and valuable documents of the POGS Foundation.
- b. Oversee the POGS Foundation's cash management and ensure that sufficient funds are available to cover operational needs with minimal financial risk to the Foundation.
- c. Deposit all funds and other valuable effects in depository banks approved by the BOT.
- d. Maintain complete and accurate records in the POGS Foundation's books of accounts of all receipts, disbursements, credits, assets, liabilities and general financial transactions of the Foundation.
- e. Make proper vouchers for all the disbursements of the POGS Foundation with the signed approval by the President.
- f. Serve as the Chair of the Committee on Finance.
- g. Prepare and present a monthly financial report to the BOT and an annual financial report to the POGS Foundation during the Annual Business Meeting.
- h. Prepare and present the proposed Annual Budget to the BOT for approval.
- i. Oversee the development of the POGS Foundation's financial policies and upon approval by the BOT, ensure and monitor its proper implementation.
- j. Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the President and the BOT.

5. The PRO shall:

- a. Serve as the Chair of the Committee on ICT.
- b. Serve as Liaison Officer between the POGS Foundation and the public.
- c. Serve as Editor-in-Chief of the POGS Newsletter and Chair of the Foundation Day Celebration.
- d. Serve as a member of the Committee on External Affairs and its subcommittees.
- e. Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the President and the BOT.

III. ADMINISTRATIVE STAFF

A. The POGS Foundation shall maintain an Administrative Staff (Secretariat) which shall be composed of the following positions, with duties and responsibilities defined in their respective job descriptions:

- 1. Executive Officer
- 2. Data Protection Officer (DPO)
- 3. Accounting Head

4. Accounting Staff
5. Line Secretaries
6. ICT Administrator
7. Librarian
8. Safety Officer
9. Messenger
10. Maintenance Personnel
11. Outsourced Service Providers
12. Other positions, as may be deemed necessary by the BOT

The Executive Officer issues the job description of each employee. The job description shall be regularly reviewed by the EXECOM.

B. DUTIES OF THE ADMINISTRATIVE STAFF

1. The Executive Officer shall:
 - a. Organize and manage the workflow of the Secretariat.
 - b. Supervise administrative operations and may set internal deadlines and performance targets for the Secretariat to ensure timely delivery of outputs, subject to the directives of the Board Secretary and existing policies.
 - c. Ensure that the Secretariat understand their duties or delegated tasks.
 - d. Monitor the Secretariat's productivity and provide constructive feedback and coaching, in coordination with the Board Secretary.
 - e. Recommend to the Board Secretary the appointment, dismissal and disciplinary action of any member of the Secretariat whenever necessary, subject to approval by the BOT.
 - f. Ensure the confidentiality of all BOT proceedings and safeguard against any unauthorized disclosure of sensitive matters discussed during their meetings.
 - g. Work under the direct authority of the BOT, with the Board Secretary as the immediate supervisor.
 - h. Report to the POGS Foundation President.
 - i. Attend conventions, symposia, conferences and other official functions of the POGS Foundation as assigned.
 - j. Maintain professionalism and adhere to the POGS Foundation's policies while performing all duties.
 - k. Perform other related tasks as may be required.
2. The DPO shall:
 - a. Monitor and ensure the compliance of the POGS Foundation with the Data Privacy Act of 2012.
 - b. Serve as the Head of the Breach Management Response Team and act as the POGS Foundation's designated liaison to the National Privacy Commission (NPC).
 - c. Submit an annual report to the NPC.

- d. Coordinate with the Compliance Officers for Privacy (COP) in the regions.
 - e. Work under the direct authority of the BOT as the Personal Information Controller (PIC).
 - f. Report to the President and Board Secretary.
 - g. Attend conventions, symposia, conferences and other official functions of the POGS Foundation as assigned.
 - h. Maintain professionalism and adhere to the POGS Foundation's policies while performing all duties.
 - i. Perform other related tasks as may be required.
3. The Accounting Head shall:
- a. Oversee and supervise the Accounting Section.
 - b. Act as Secretary-in-Charge of the Committee on Finance.
 - c. Maintain and ensure accurate records of the POGS Foundation's assets and funds, and submit financial reports to the Executive Officer and Treasurer.
 - d. Prepare and review the Cash Position Report, Investment Report, Treasurer's Report, monthly financial statements and reports on special projects or other monetary transactions, for submission to the BOT.
 - e. Monitor the POGS Foundation's bank accounts, placements and investments; coordinate with bank officers and recommend favorable investment opportunities to the Treasurer.
 - f. Coordinate with the Treasurer in the preparation of the annual budget and with the External Auditor on accounting and audit matters.
 - g. Review all reports prepared by the Accounting Staff.
 - h. Supervise the collection, cashiering, posting of collections and disbursements, and preparation of monthly journal entries and bank reconciliation statements.
 - i. Work under the direct authority of the BOT, with the Treasurer as the immediate supervisor.
 - j. Attend conventions, symposia, conferences and other official functions of the POGS Foundation as assigned.
 - k. Maintain professionalism and adhere to the POGS Foundation's policies while performing all duties.
 - l. Perform other related tasks as may be required.
4. The Accounting Staff shall:
- a. Provide support and assistance to the Accounting Head in all phases of accounting operations.
 - b. Handle collections and cashiering, including:
 - 1) accepting payments of dues, fees and other receivables
 - 1) issuing official receipts
 - 2) preparing collection reports and deposit slips
 - 3) maintaining accurate member accounts in coordination with the Committee on Credentials and Membership

- c. Prepare and process vouchers, checks, payroll and other financial documents, ensuring compliance with internal controls and validity of transactions.
 - d. Prepare and send statements of account to members, committees, subspecialty societies and other concerned parties.
 - e. Be responsible for preparation of reports and compliance requirements for government regulatory agencies (e.g. Bureau of Internal Revenue [BIR], Social Security Services [SSS], Philippine Health Insurance Corporation [PhilHealth], Home Development Mutual Fund [HDMF]).
 - f. Assist in purchasing, supply management and annual/periodic physical inventory.
 - g. Attend conventions, symposia, conferences and other official functions of the POGS Foundation as assigned.
 - h. Maintain professionalism and adhere to the POGS Foundation's policies while performing all duties.
 - i. Perform other related tasks as may be required.
5. The Line Secretaries shall:
- a. Prepare agenda, minutes, committee reports and other official documents for review and approval by the Committee Chair.
 - b. Collect materials for meetings, lectures and conferences.
 - c. Coordinate and organize the assigned committee's calendar of activities.
 - d. Maintain and safeguard the filing records of the assigned committee.
 - e. Handle correspondence, communication and logistical arrangements for committee activities.
 - f. Safeguard the confidentiality of committee records and ensure compliance with the POGS Foundation's data privacy policies when handling personal or sensitive information.
 - g. Liaise with the Executive Officer, Committee Chair, members of the BOT and other Secretariat for matters concerning committee operations.
 - h. Attend conventions, symposia, conferences and other official functions of the POGS Foundation as assigned.
 - i. Maintain professionalism and adhere to the POGS Foundation's policies while performing all duties.
 - j. Perform other related tasks as may be required.
6. The ICT Administrator shall coordinate with the Committee on ICT for the following functions:
- a. Monitor computer systems, servers, networks and related hardware and software.
 - b. Provide day-to-day technical support to employees.
 - c. Ensure proper data storage, backup, recovery and protection against data loss or corruption.
 - d. Implement security measures, manage user accounts and permissions, protect systems from malware, and ensure compliance with security policies.

- e. Maintain accurate records of ICT assets, configurations, procedures and technical issues.
- f. Liaise with external ICT vendors for hardware, software, maintenance and technical support services.
- g. Recommend, plan and implement system upgrades and new technologies, and process improvements to enhance efficiency.
- h. Coordinate with the DPO regarding the implementation of data privacy measures, incident reporting, system access controls and compliance with data protection policies.
- i. Work under the direct authority of the BOT, with the PRO as the immediate supervisor.
- j. Attend conventions, symposia, conferences and other official functions of the POGS Foundation as assigned.
- k. Maintain professionalism and adhere to the POGS Foundation's policies while performing all duties.
- l. Perform other related tasks as may be required.

7. The Librarian shall:

- a. Manage and organize library collections, including books, journals, electronic resources and archival materials.
- b. Develop and implement policies for collection development, cataloging, circulation and resource access.
- c. Assist members, staff and researchers in locating and using library resources effectively.
- d. Maintain accurate records of library holdings and usage.
- e. Oversee acquisition, subscription and renewal of print and digital information resources.
- f. Ensure proper preservation, storage and security of library materials.
- g. Implement and manage library systems, databases and digital repositories.
- h. Promote library services and resources to members and Secretariat.
- i. Ensure compliance with copyright, intellectual property and data protection policies.
- j. Prepare periodic reports on library utilization and resource development.
- k. Work under the direct authority of the BOT, with the Chair of Committee on Library and Archives as the immediate supervisor.
- l. Attend conventions, symposia, conferences and other official functions of the POGS Foundation as assigned.
- m. Maintain professionalism and adhere to the POGS Foundation's policies while performing all duties.
- n. Perform other related tasks as may be required.

8. The Safety Officer shall:

- a. Develop, implement and monitor building safety and occupational health policies appropriate for administrative and public-use facilities.
- b. Ensure compliance with national and local safety regulations, fire codes, building codes and environmental health standards.

- c. Conduct regular inspection of offices, meeting rooms, conference halls, elevators, stairways, electrical systems and common areas.
 - d. Identify potential hazards (fire, electrical, structural, ergonomic, crowd safety) and recommend preventive and corrective measures.
 - e. Oversee emergency preparedness plans, including fire evacuation, earthquake response and medical emergencies.
 - f. Coordinate and conduct safety orientations and drills for staff, officers, tenants and event participants.
 - g. Monitor proper installation and maintenance of safety equipment (e.g. fire extinguishers, alarms, emergency lights, first aid kits, automated external defibrillators [AEDs]).
 - h. Investigate accidents, incidents or near-misses occurring within the building and prepare incident reports.
 - i. Maintain records of inspections, drills, incidents and safety training activities.
 - j. Coordinate with building administration, security personnel, maintenance staff and external safety or regulatory agencies.
 - k. Ensure safe conduct of meetings, conferences and events held within the building.
 - l. Promote safety awareness and a culture of shared responsibility among the Secretariat, members and visitors.
 - m. Work under the direct authority of the BOT, with the Board Secretary as immediate supervisor.
 - n. Attend conventions, symposia, conferences and other official functions of the POGS Foundation as assigned.
 - o. Maintain professionalism and adhere to the POGS Foundation's policies while performing all duties.
 - p. Perform other related tasks as may be required.
9. The Messenger shall:
- a. Collect and deliver messages, documents, packages and other items from predetermined locations as required by the authorized officers and personnel, and ensure delivery to the intended recipients.
 - b. Confirm and clarify delivery schedules before leaving the POGS office.
 - c. Ensure the security, confidentiality and proper handling of all documents, packages and other items during transport.
 - d. Verify and document that the proper recipient receives the items.
 - e. Record all the transactions and deliveries performed during the day and submit a report to the Executive Officer.
 - f. Attend conventions, symposia, conferences and other official functions of the POGS Foundation as assigned.
 - g. Maintain professionalism and adhere to the POGS Foundation's policies while performing all duties.
 - h. Perform other related tasks as may be required.

10. The Maintenance personnel shall:
 - a. Clean, maintain and ensure upkeep of all office spaces, building premises and facilities.
 - b. Perform basic repairs and preventive maintenance of office equipment, furniture and fixtures.
 - c. Maintain an adequate inventory of cleaning supplies, tools and equipment, and report when replenishment is needed.
 - d. Operate cleaning and maintenance equipment safely and efficiently.
 - e. Ensure proper disposal of waste and recycling materials in accordance with organizational and environmental guidelines.
 - f. Assist with setting up and arranging venues for meetings, conferences and events as needed.
 - g. Attend conventions, symposia, conferences and other official functions of the POGS Foundation as assigned.
 - h. Maintain professionalism and adhere to the POGS Foundation's policies while performing all duties.
 - i. Perform other related tasks as may be required.
11. Outsourced Service Providers:
 - a. The POGS Foundation engages external service providers for specialized functions that are not part of its core operations. These contracted personnel are not company employees but provide essential services under service agreements.
 - b. Outsourced positions include:
 - 1) Legal Counsel
 - 2) ICT Support Services
 - 3) Auditing Services
 - 4) Transportation Services
 - 5) Ambulance Services
 - 6) Food and Beverage Services
 - 7) Other services as applicable
 - c. Guidelines:
 - 1) These service providers operate under contractual agreements with defined scopes of work.
 - 2) They are subject to the POGS Foundation's policies regarding confidentiality, security and professional conduct while on POGS Foundation premises or handling POGS Foundation matters.
 - 3) Direct employees should coordinate with designated contact person/department when engaging these service providers.
 - 4) All outsourced personnel must comply with POGS Foundation safety, security and data protection protocols.

NOTE: Other information about the Administrative Staff is detailed in Employee Handbook.

CHAPTER 3 COMMITTEES

I. DEFINITION OF TERMS

- A. **Standing Committees** – are permanent bodies that oversee specific functions, initiatives and policies within the POGS Foundation. These committees ensure the continuous implementation of its programs and uphold its mission to advance women’s health and the OB-GYN profession in the Philippines. These committees report directly to the BOT.
- B. **Statutory Committees** – shall be mandated by the Bylaws or governing documents, wherein the chairmanship is predefined and not subject to discretionary appointments. Their existence are required and cannot be altered without a formal amendment process.
- C. **Constitutional Committees** – shall:
 - a. Be mandated by the Constitution and Bylaws with specific roles essential to the governance and integrity of the POGS Foundation.
 - b. Have functions and composition explicitly stated in the Constitution and Bylaws, and cannot be altered without a formal amendment process.
 - c. Function independently from the BOT.
- D. **Subcommittee** – a smaller group formed under a parent committee to handle a more specific area, task, or technical function within the broader mandate of the main committee. It derives its authority from the parent committee and reports back to it for recommendations, coordination, or approval.
- E. **Ad Hoc Committee** – a temporary committee created by the BOT to address a specific concern, issue, or mandate not covered by existing standing committees. It shall have clearly defined objectives and deliverables and shall perform primarily advisory, evaluative or recommendatory functions. The Committee shall be automatically dissolved upon completion of its assigned task or submission of its final report. Its term shall not exceed one (1) year, unless extended by the BOT upon justifiable grounds. Functions requiring continuing oversight beyond one (1) year shall be endorsed for conversion into a subcommittee or program.
- F. **Program** – a sustained, continuing and strategic set of activities or initiatives of the POGS Foundation designed to achieve specific long-term objectives of the Foundation aligned with its mission, vision and long-term goals. It is institutional in nature, with defined leadership, sustainable resource support and periodic monitoring and evaluation. Programs are intended to produce long-term impact and continuing benefit to the Foundation and its stakeholders. Programs may operate under a standing committee or directly under the BOT and are intended for continuing implementation beyond one (1) year.

- G. Project – a defined undertaking of the POGS Foundation with a specific objective, scope, timeline and resource allocation, designed to produce a measurable output or deliverable. Projects may be implemented under a committee or program, and shall have a designated leadership, monitoring mechanisms and evaluation processes.
- H. Task Force – a special, time-bound and action-oriented body constituted by the BOT to respond to a priority need, urgent concern or strategic initiative of the POGS Foundation. It is composed of members selected for their relevant expertise and experience, and is mandated to develop, implement, and/or operationalize specific outputs or interventions within a defined period. The Task Force shall be dissolved upon accomplishment of its objectives or as directed by the BOT.

The creation and implementation of the Ad Hoc Committees, Programs, Projects and Task Forces shall be subject to the approval by the BOT reflected in an official Board Resolution, and shall operate under clearly defined terms of reference, including objectives, scope, duration, reporting structure and expected outputs.

II. **STANDING COMMITTEES**

A. COMMON PROVISIONS

1. The Standing Committees are the following, but not limited to:
 - a. Clinical Practice Guidelines
 - b. Community Service
 - c. Continuing Medical Education
 - d. Environment and Women's Health
 - e. Hospital Accreditation for Service
 - f. Library and Archives
 - g. Maternal and Perinatal Welfare
 - h. Nationwide Statistics
 - i. Patient Safety and Quality Health Care
 - j. Reproductive Health
 - k. Scientific Works
 - l. Women's Cancers
2. Each Standing Committee shall be composed of at least five (5) active Fellows, maximum of seven (7), who are generally known to have the necessary knowledge and experience required for the position. The Chair shall submit a justification to the BOT should there be more than seven (7) members.
 - a. The Chair of each committee shall be a member of the BOT.

- b. The Chair shall appoint a Secretary from among the committee members, who shall perform the usual duties pertaining to such position.
 - c. Each member shall be limited to a maximum membership in two (2) Standing Committees.
 - d. Members shall serve for a term of one (1) year without prejudice to re-appointment, starting from their respective dates of appointment and assumption of office, for a maximum of three (3) years.
- 3. Responsibilities:
 - a. The Chair of each committee shall present to the BOT his/her plans for the year with the proposed budget during the budget deliberation.
 - b. The Committee may propose policies or guidelines within their respective areas.
 - c. There may be subcommittees and programs under each committee, as necessary, upon the approval by the BOT.
 - d. The Chair of each committee shall submit to the BOT a bi-annual report to provide clear documentation and assessment of its activities and accomplishments to be submitted one (1) month before the Midyear Convention and one (1) month before the Annual Convention.

B. COMMITTEE ON CLINICAL PRACTICE GUIDELINES

The Committee shall:

- 1. Be responsible for setting the standards for the general practice of OB-GYN.
- 2. Create and periodically update guidelines in the clinical practice of OB-GYN.
- 3. Formulate Practice Bulletins, as needed by the POGS Foundation.

C. COMMITTEE ON COMMUNITY SERVICE

The Committee shall:

- 1. Initiate, coordinate, supervise and promote activities aimed at improving reproductive healthcare, especially in underserved communities/regions.
- 2. Promote, coordinate and supervise the active involvement of members of the POGS Foundation in meaningful community service-oriented activities.
- 3. Provide guidance and support to the Regional Directors on matters related to Community Service.
- 4. Seek and receive grants from government and non-government sources to support the successful implementation of community service programs.

D. COMMITTEE ON CONTINUING MEDICAL EDUCATION

The Committee shall:

1. Plan, develop, implement and evaluate high-quality evidence-based CME programs that promote lifelong learning, enhance clinical competence and ensure the continuous professional development of members in conformity with the current standards of practice and the evolving needs of the POGS Foundation.
2. Organize CME activities for members and other interested parties, including the Midyear Convention and other postgraduate courses and scientific meetings in different regions (except industry-driven programs).
3. Coordinate its activities with the Subcommittee on Scientific Program of the Annual Convention and the Committee on CME of the PMA.
4. Provide guidance and support to the Regional Directors on matters related to CME activities.
5. Issue certificates of attendance along with the corresponding CPD units to fulfill the requirements of the Professional Regulation Commission (PRC).
6. Accept grants from government and non-government sources to successfully implement CME programs.
7. Oversee and ensure the administrative coordination, operational management and periodic evaluation of programs or initiatives assigned to the Committee as duly approved by the BOT for implementation:
 - a. Prompt Response and Intervention for Maternal Emergencies (PRIME)
 - b. Other future programs which shall be developed and approved by the BOT

E. COMMITTEE ON HOSPITAL ACCREDITATION FOR SERVICE (CHAS)

The Committee shall:

1. Oversee and be responsible for the inspection, evaluation and approval or disapproval of application for accreditation for service of different hospitals and maternity clinics.
2. Promulgate rules and regulations relative to accreditation for service upon the approval by the BOT.

F. COMMITTEE ON ENVIRONMENT AND WOMEN'S HEALTH

The Committee shall:

1. Address the impact of environmental factors on women's health, promote environmental health literacy, and advocate for policies that protect both women's health and the environment.
2. Formulate and promote activities for the awareness of the effects of the environment on reproductive health, such as developing educational materials and conducting seminars,

workshops, campaign caravans and other activities for members, trainees and communities on endocrine disrupting chemicals (EDCs), climate change and disaster preparedness related to reproductive health.

3. Formulate strategies on sustainable practices that promote reproductive health through environmental protection and disaster preparedness to members, trainees and communities, such as:
 - a. Environmental conservation practices, which include tree/mangrove planting, urban farming, coastal clean-up and other related activities
 - b. Zero waste at home and in the workplace
 - c. A healthy food system
 - d. Training workshops to provide maternity and gynecological services in a disaster situation
 - e. Volunteer registry of members and their safe deployment to disaster locations
4. Foster partnerships with stakeholders as advocates for the environment and reproductive health.
5. Collaborate with local, regional and international organizations in capacity building for positive climate action, disaster response and reproductive environmental and developmental health.
6. Engage in collaborated research on the environmental effects specifically of climate change, calamities and disasters on reproductive health.

G. COMMITTEE ON LIBRARY AND ARCHIVES

The Committee shall:

1. Be responsible for setting up, upgrading and maintaining a physical and virtual library, including medical cataloging of materials relevant to the practice of OB-GYN, while ensuring that all physical and logistical requirements are met.
2. Cater to literature search and the research needs of the POGS Foundation.
3. Document and archive significant files, events and milestones of the POGS Foundation which shall include but not limited to the following:
 - a. Annual reports
 - b. Roll of Fellows, Diplomates, Junior, Associate, Affiliate and Honorary Members
 - c. Roll of Officers and members of the BOT
 - d. Roll of Chairs and members of all committees
 - e. File of signed Fellowship Pledges
 - f. File of signed Life Membership Pledges
 - g. Scientific and nonscientific publications
 - h. Portraits of Past Presidents
 - i. Member data and photos
 - j. Memorabilia
 - k. Books, journals, important documents and accounting and bookkeeping records
 - l. Virtual files of the aforementioned

H. COMMITTEE ON MATERNAL AND PERINATAL WELFARE

The Committee shall:

1. Develop and implement strategies to reduce maternal and perinatal morbidity and mortality through evidence-based practices and timely interventions.
2. Advocate policies and programs that improve maternal and perinatal care, ensuring access to quality healthcare for all women and newborns.
3. Organize activities to educate expectant mothers on prenatal care, nutrition, safe childbirth practices and breastfeeding, fostering early intervention and healthy pregnancies.
4. Conduct two (2) Maternal and two (2) Perinatal Morbidity and Mortality conferences in a year.
5. Have at least three (3) members from the academe and/or Fellows of the Philippine Society of Maternal and Fetal Medicine (PSMFM).
6. Oversee and ensure the administrative coordination, operational management and periodic evaluation of programs or initiatives assigned to the Committee as duly approved by the BOT for implementation, such as:
 - a. POGS-AOFOG Uniting for Quality Maternal Care
 - b. Other future programs which shall be developed and approved by the BOT

I. COMMITTEE ON NATIONWIDE STATISTICS

The Committee shall provide aggregated, anonymized data to support clinical research, systematic reviews and meta-analyses in OB-GYN by:

1. Supervising the timely collection, compilation and the annual publication of coded POGS Nationwide Statistics System (PNSS) data in OB-GYN.
2. Formulating rules, regulations and strategies to improve data collection.
3. Furnishing the CHAS and the PBOG with a list of hospitals that have faithfully complied with the requirements based on up-to-date statistical recording and reporting.

J. COMMITTEE ON PATIENT SAFETY AND QUALITY HEALTH CARE

The Committee shall:

1. Set national goals for patient safety, develop an agenda for implementation in accordance with international standards and track their progress.
2. Be responsible for the creation and dissemination of nationwide tools and protocols such as Root Cause Analysis (RCA) and Team Strategies and Tools to Enhance Performance and Patient Safety (TeamSTEPPS) to enhance patient safety and quality healthcare.
3. Promote a voluntary, confidential reporting system to detect system weaknesses.
4. Identify persistent safety issues that require more intensive analysis.
5. Conduct at least one (1) Patient Safety workshop per year.

6. Oversee and ensure the administrative coordination, operational management and periodic evaluation of programs or initiatives assigned to the Committee as duly approved by the BOT for implementation, such as:
 - a. Program on Patient Blood Management (PBM)
 - b. Other future programs which shall be developed and approved by the BOT

K. COMMITTEE ON REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH

The Committee shall:

1. Provide updated information on reproductive health and reproductive health-related issues to members, affiliates, trainees and other interested parties through gathering of literature and published researches.
2. Formulate activities for the promotion and application of reproductive healthcare services nationwide.
3. Facilitate equitable access to reproductive health services as embodied in the Republic Act 10354, otherwise known as the Responsible Parenthood and Reproductive Health (RPRH) Act of 2012.
4. Have coordinators from Northern Luzon, Southern Luzon, the Visayas and Mindanao regions.
5. Oversee and ensure the administrative coordination, operational management, and periodic evaluation of programs or initiatives assigned to the Committee as duly approved by the BOT for implementation, such as:
 - a. Program on Sexual and Gender Minorities (SGM)
 - b. Other future programs which shall be developed and approved by the BOT

L. COMMITTEE ON SCIENTIFIC WORKS

The Committee shall conduct, initiate, promote, support and coordinate research activities of the POGS Foundation and its stakeholders. It shall:

1. Identify and recommend to the Editorial Board of the PJOG original scientific works for publication.
2. Organize and conduct research related activities.
3. Provide grants to members, residents-in-training and fellows-in-training for outstanding scientific work.
4. Receive grants from government and non-government sources to support the successful implementation of its programs.
5. Be composed of two (2) subcommittees, namely:
 - a. Interesting Case Subcommittee
Receives entries and selects the winner/s of the midyear and annual residents-in-training interesting case contests.

- b. Research and Innovations Subcommittee
 - 1) Receives entries and selects the winner/s of the midyear and annual residents-in-training and POGS Fellows research contests.
 - 2) Receives entries and selects the winner/s of the POGS Flagship Research Project.
 - 3) Oversees the general conduct of research in the POGS Foundation by monitoring and evaluating researches completed by its stakeholders.
 - 4) Periodically organizes the resetting of the research agenda of the POGS Foundation following standard guidelines (POGS Unified Research Agenda [PURA]).

CRITERIA AND GUIDELINES FOR OUTSTANDING SCIENTIFIC WORKS

I. GRANTS FOR LECTURE/PRESENTOR IN INTERNATIONAL FORA

This will be given to a Fellow, Diplomate, Fellow-in-training and Resident-in-training of accredited training hospitals in the form of cash award with the amount adjusted according to the level of the grantee and the type of presentation. All applications must be prospective and received at the POGS Office at least one (1) month prior to the forum.

1. FELLOW – limited to a maximum of two (2) grants (one [1] Regional/Asia and one [1] trans-Atlantic) per Fellow per year
 - P25,000 for an Oral Presentation (plenary or symposium)
 - P15,000 for a Free Paper Presentation
 - P10,000 for a Poster Presentation
2. DIPLOMATE – limited to one grant per Diplomate per year
 - P15,000 for an Oral Presentation (plenary or symposium)
 - P10,000 for a Free Paper Presentation
 - P7,000 for a Poster Presentation
3. FELLOW-IN-TRAINING – limited to one grant per year
 - P10,000 for an Oral Presentation (plenary or symposium)
 - P7,000 for a Free Paper Presentation
 - P5,000 for a Poster Presentation
4. RESIDENT-IN-TRAINING – limited to one grant per year
 - P10,000 for an Oral Presentation (plenary or symposium)
 - P7,000 for a Free Paper Presentation
 - P5,000 for a Poster Presentation

Guidelines:

1. Grants for all categories are subject to the availability of appropriated funds for the calendar year. All applicants are advised to submit requirements one (1) month before the date of the event.

2. Grants to be provided as follows:
 - a. Presenters Grant: Fellows: maximum of two (2) – one (1) Regional/Asia, one (1) Trans-atlantic per year
 - b. Publications Grant: Fellows, Diplomate to Residents: maximum one (1) grant per year
3. All applications for scientific grants must have been approved by the BOT from January to October of the calendar year.
4. For all the grants, the release of the check shall be upon return from the congress/forum with compliance of certificate of attendance and abstract of the paper. (Must claim within one (1) month after the date of the event).

II. GRANTS FOR INTERNATIONAL PUBLICATION

This will be given to recognized Fellows of the POGS Foundation who have published works in International Scientific Indexing (ISI) or Medline Journals. It aims to encourage more publications from members and institutions.

1. For each paper published in an ISI journal – P20,000 pro-rated for each Fellow or Diplomate
2. For each paper published in non-ISI but Medline journal – P20,000 pro-rated for each Fellow or Diplomate, subject to the approval by the BOT
3. For each paper published in non-ISI and peer-reviewed – P10,000 pro-rated for each Fellow or Diplomate, subject to the evaluation by the PJOG editor and approval by the BOT
4. For PJOG research articles – P10,000.00 pro-rated for each Fellow or Diplomate, subject to the approval by the BOT
5. For PJOG case reports – P5,000.00 pro-rated for each Fellow or Diplomate, subject to the approval by the BOT
6. The paper should identify the institution of the Fellow or Diplomate.
7. The paper should not be industry-sponsored.

III. POGS FLAGSHIP RESEARCH PROGRAM

Guidelines:

1. Electronic copy (using Microsoft Word or Compatible Software) of the complete research proposal including a Gantt Chart and itemized budget
2. Prior approval of the research proposal by an accredited technical review board (with names of technical reviewers/expert panel) and by a separate Ethical Review Board (ERB): the approving ERB must be in the list of Philippine Health Research Ethics Board (PHREB) accredited review boards
3. The principal investigator must be a POGS member: Curriculum vitae of all investigators must be submitted, including previously completed researches and ongoing researches.
4. The principal investigator must preferably belong to an institution that shall vouch for the investigator and shall assure completion of the research project. For independent principal investigators, the Regional Director will vouch for him/her. A Memorandum of Agreement (MOA) shall be signed.
5. Counterpart funds, including those from private/government sources and pharmaceutical companies, may be allowed:
 - a. As long as the fund is declared as an unrestricted research grant (esp. for pharmaceutical companies).

- b. The principal investigator (and site investigators) must declare engagement, entanglements, and conflicts of interest
- 6. The project should be completed within two (2) years (preferred) and within the budget appropriated.
- 7. The budget shall be appropriated in the following tranches:
 - a. FIRST TRANCHE (upon signing of contract)
 - 1) Twelve (12) months of the personnel costs
 - 2) Twelve (12) months of the maintenance and other operating expenses (MOOE)
 - 3) 100% of the equipment costs
 - b. SECOND TRANCHE (at the 11th month of the project and upon submission of status of project and first ten (10) months financial report of personnel and MOOE)
 - 1) Twelve (12) months of the personnel costs
 - 2) Twelve (12) months of the MOOE
 - c. LAST TRANCHE (upon submission of final report)

M. COMMITTEE ON WOMEN'S CANCERS

The Committee shall:

1. Assist in the formulation, implementation and evaluation of national policies and programs related to the prevention, early detection and control of women's cancers, aligned with national and global initiatives.
2. Coordinate capacity building activities for general obstetrician-gynecologists and primary care providers in cancer screening, early detection, referral protocols and community-based management.
3. Collaborate with local, regional, global, governmental and non-governmental organizations and other international women's cancer organizations and groups to promote education, prevention and early detection of women's cancers.
4. Coordinate with relevant societies primarily involved with the diagnosis, care and management of women with cancers.
5. Collaborate with local and international organizations to promote fertility preservation in women's cancers.

III. STATUTORY COMMITTEES

A. COMMON PROVISIONS

1. The Statutory Committees are the following:
 - a. External Affairs
 - b. Internal Affairs
 - c. Annual Convention

- d. Credentials and Membership
 - e. Mutual Assistance Program
 - f. Finance
 - g. Information Dissemination and Communication Technology
 - h. Awards
2. Each Statutory Committee shall be composed of at least five (5) active Fellows who are generally known to have the necessary knowledge and experience required for the position. The Chair shall recommend additional members if deemed necessary, after justification and approval by the BOT.
- a. The Chair of each Committee shall be a member of the EXECOM or a Past President, as applicable.
 - b. The Chair shall appoint a Secretary and Co-Chair from among the committee members, who shall perform the usual duties pertaining to such position.
 - c. Members shall serve for a period of one (1) year without prejudice to re-appointment, with a maximum of three (3) consecutive years, starting from their respective date of appointment and assumption of office.

B. COMMITTEE ON EXTERNAL AFFAIRS

1. The Committee shall:
- a. Foster relationships, build consensus and promote interest on a national and global scale.
 - b. Oversee the POGS Foundation's liaison activities with the government, PMA, other specialty societies in the Philippines, international and regional OB-GYN societies, and national and international non-governmental organizations.
2. The committee shall have three (3) subcommittees:
- a. The Subcommittee on Legislation shall:
 - 1) Be responsible in representing POGS in Congress and the PMA Commission on Legislation with regard to proposed bills that affect the practice of OB-GYN in particular and to the welfare of women in general.
 - 2) Endeavor to establish and maintain a cooperative and cordial relations with the media in order to promote the POGS Foundation's wholesome image.
 - b. The Subcommittee on Non-legislative Government Agencies shall coordinate with the Department of Health (DOH), PhilHealth, PRC and other non-legislative government agencies.
 - c. The Subcommittee on International and Local Medical Associations shall coordinate with international and local medical associations with regard to issues that concern and affect the practice of OB-GYN in particular and to the welfare of physicians in general.

3. Composition

- a. The President shall serve as the Chair of the Committee.
- b. The PRO shall be a member of all its subcommittees.
- c. The Co-chair shall be a tenured representative designated for three (3) years by the BOT and preferably a Past President or a former BOT.
- d. These three (3) shall be augmented by at least eight (8) more active members. These members shall assume position in staggered three (3) year terms to be determined from their respective dates of appointment and assumption of the post.

4. Each subcommittee shall perform the following functions:

- a. Represent the POGS Foundation in meetings and hearings relevant to the practice of OB-GYN and provide a resource speaker or reactor, as the need arises.
- b. Evaluate laws and provisions which have a direct effect on the practice of OB-GYN.
- c. Prepare recommendations that shall embody the POGS Foundation's position on issues concerning the practice of OB-GYN.
- d. Review MOAs between the POGS Foundation and any institution, subject to the approval by the BOT.

C. COMMITTEE ON INTERNAL AFFAIRS

1. The Committee shall:

- a. Foster harmonious relationships and coordinate activities between the POGS Foundation and the subspecialty and affiliate societies.
- b. Establish mutually beneficial conditions and guidelines for recognition of subspecialty and affiliate societies.
- c. Grant recognition to subspecialty and affiliate societies upon application and approval by the BOT.

2. Composition:

- a. The Vice President shall serve as the Chair of the Committee.
- b. The members are the:
 - 1) PBOG Chair
 - 2) Incumbent presidents of each subspecialty and affiliate society

D. COMMITTEE ON ANNUAL CONVENTION

1. The Committee shall:

- a. Be responsible for the organization and conduct of the Annual Convention.

- b. Have an Organizing Committee and Subcommittees tasked to undertake responsibilities.
2. Composition:
- a. The Vice President shall serve as the Overall Chair.
 - b. Each Subcommittee shall have a Chair.
 - c. Each Subcommittee must be composed of five (5) members including the Chair. For subcommittees requiring less than or more than five (5) members, the proposed number is subject for approval by the BOT.
 - d. Members shall be active Fellows or Diplomates duly approved by the BOT.
 - e. A member shall be appointed to only one (1) subcommittee.
 - f. The subcommittees include:
 - 1) Documentation
 - 2) Exhibits
 - 3) Hospitality and Tours
 - 4) Hotel Accommodation and Shuttle Service
 - 5) Physical Arrangements and Technical System (PATS)
 - 6) Programs and Invitations
 - 7) Registration
 - 8) Scientific Program
 - 9) Scientific Works and Abstracts
 - 10) Socials
 - 11) Souvenir Program
 - 12) Speaker's Bureau
 - 13) Sports
 - 14) Other subcommittees as deemed necessary
 - g. Members shall have the commitment to attend meetings and participate in discussions/deliberations for the duration of the meeting so that the decisions to be made are collegial, substantiated with a quorum.
 - h. For Subcommittees requiring contracts, contracts shall be reviewed and officially recommended to the President and Vice President for final approval.
 - i. The official signatories in the contracts shall be the President and Vice President with the Subcommittee Chair as witness.
 - j. The Subcommittee budgets shall be finalized and submitted on or before the deadline set by the Treasurer.
3. Duties and Responsibilities
- a. The Overall Chair shall:
 - 1) Be responsible for the organization and conduct of the Annual Convention.
 - 2) Assign Chairs and Co-chairs of each Subcommittee.
 - 3) Create a specific timetable for each Subcommittee.
 - 4) Preside over the Organizing Committee meetings.

- 5) Implement the administrative guidelines as well as the conduct of meeting and the exercise of decorum.
 - 6) Oversee the preparations and activities pertaining to the Annual Convention.
 - 7) Submit to the BOT monthly updates on the preparations for the Annual Convention.
- b. The Convention Secretary shall:
- 1) Prepare requirements for all the meetings of the Annual Convention. The regular meetings shall be determined and agreed upon during the first meeting.
 - 2) Preside over Organizing Committee meetings in the absence of the Overall Chair.
 - 3) Assist the Overall Chair in the implementation of the POGS Foundation's Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) as well as conduct of meeting and the exercise of decorum.
 - 4) Keep an up-to-date report of all subcommittees.
 - 5) Assist the Overall Chair in overseeing the preparations and activities pertaining to the Annual Convention.
 - 6) Prepare content and ensure dissemination of Convention announcement and updates on various platforms.
 - 7) Ensure that the family of awardees/honorees, keynote speakers/guest of honors/inducting officers, and all other guests and participants are invited through the Subcommittee of Programs and Invitations.
 - 8) Serve as the Master of Ceremonies during the Opening Ceremonies.
 - 9) Consolidate the budget of all subcommittees.
 - 10) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and the BOT.
- c. The Subcommittee on Documentation shall:
- 1) Oversee and supervise coverage of all convention activities.
 - 2) Document all scientific and social activities in coordination with the Subcommittee on PATS.
 - 3) Obtain quotations from different suppliers (printing, video and photography services) and recommend which is most favorable to the POGS Foundation.
 - 4) Arrange photo sessions of the BOT, Regional Directors, PBOG, CREED, invited dignitaries, Annual Convention Organizing Committee members, and Fellow and Diplomate inductees.
 - 5) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and Convention Secretary.
- d. The Subcommittee on Exhibits shall:
- 1) Plan for the commercial exhibits with regard to:
 - i. Venue
 - ii. Layout
 - iii. Sizes of booths and learning suites

- iv. Baggage counters
 - v. Exhibit contractors
 - vi. Pricing, collection and reporting
 - 2) Coordinate with the Subcommittee on PATS in the designation and assignment of areas of commercial exhibits.
 - 3) Coordinate with the Committee on Ways and Means for solicitation of prospective exhibitors and provision of free booths as part of packages.
 - 4) Preside over the Exhibitors Meeting held prior to the convention to discuss the following concerns:
 - i. Policies and guidelines of the Subcommittee
 - ii. House rules of the venue
 - iii. Security
 - 5) Coordinate with non-commercial exhibitors (both local and international) regarding guidelines on exhibits.
 - 6) Oversee activities during construction, installation, ingress, exhibition and egress of exhibits.
 - 7) Conduct the formal Opening of Exhibits.
 - 8) Ensure that all receivables are settled prior to the Annual Convention.
 - 9) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and Convention Secretary.
- e. The Subcommittee on Hospitality and Tours shall:
- 1) Coordinate local and foreign speakers' itineraries, travel plans, accommodations, schedule of lecture and off-site activities.
 - 2) Recommend tokens/gifts and present to the Organizing Committee for approval.
 - 3) Coordinate with the Subcommittees on Scientific Program, Socials and PATS for the assigned tasks.
 - 4) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and Convention Secretary.
- f. The Subcommittee on Hotel Accommodation and Shuttle Service shall:
- 1) Coordinate with convention hotels regarding room allocations, special rates and booking arrangements for the delegates, speakers and guests.
 - 2) Ensure that hotels meet safety, comfort and accessibility requirements.
 - 3) Manage accommodations for invited dignitaries, officers, speakers, foreign guests, members and other attendees.
 - 4) Coordinate with pharmaceutical companies regarding sponsorship of hotel accommodations of the delegates.
 - 5) Provide information to delegates on available hotels, rates and booking procedures.
 - 6) Ensure collection of hotel rebates in coordination with the Committee on Finance.

- 7) Evaluate hotels and gather feedback for possible endorsement to future annual conventions.
 - 8) Coordinate with shuttle service providers for the transportation of delegates, speakers, invited dignitaries and foreign guests from the hotel to the convention venue and vice versa.
 - 9) Coordinate the parking areas of shuttle service with the convention venue.
 - 10) Ensure compliance of the transport provider to safety requirements and service agreements.
 - 11) Coordinate with the Subcommittees on PATS and Hospitality and Tours for logistical requirements.
 - 12) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and Convention Secretary.
- g. The Subcommittee on Physical Arrangements and Technical Systems (PATS) shall:
- 1) Be responsible for the ocular inspection and reservation of the venue, facilities and other physical arrangement requirements for the Annual Convention.
 - 2) Be responsible for managing the technical, logistical and virtual requirements for the Annual Convention.
 - 3) Coordinate with concerned Subcommittees for their requirements.
 - 4) Designate venues for the learning suites, booths, lounging areas and baggage counters and coordinate with the Subcommittee on Ways and Means and Subcommittee on Exhibits for the assignments.
 - 5) Coordinate with the responsible agencies to ensure security and safety of the venue for the duration of the Annual Convention.
 - 6) Coordinate with the Overall Chair, Convention Secretary and other subcommittees for the meal requirements of the participants, officers, Secretariat and other personnel.
 - 7) Coordinate with other agencies regarding the technical and logistical requirements of the Annual Convention.
 - 8) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and Convention Secretary.
- h. The Subcommittee on Programs and Invitations shall:
- 1) Prepare the convention program and coordinate all activities, both scientific and social.
 - 2) Prepare the convention bulletins and announcements, and assist the Convention Secretary in the publication of the convention infographics and newsletter.
 - 3) Coordinate with the Subcommittee on Ways and Means for financial support for the cost of publication of the program.
 - 4) Ensure that the final program is ready for timely distribution to guests and participants at least two (2) weeks before the convention.

- 5) Invite the families of awardees (Dr. Baldomero L. Roxas Memorial Lecturer and Awardee for Academic Distinction, Dr. Ramon M. Lopez Award of Merit for Community Service, Dr. Honoria D. Acosta-Sison Award of Merit for Research, Dr. Constantino P. Manahan Young Researcher Award, and Dr. Julita R. Jalbuena Award of Excellence in Clinical Practice) to attend the Opening Ceremony. Invite the keynote/special guest and inducting officer to attend the Closing Ceremony.
 - 6) Prepare invitation letters for Past Presidents and other guests (Presidents of medical societies, subspecialty and affiliate societies, industry partners).
 - 7) Coordinate with the Subcommittee on PATS for the orderly conduct of the activities of the Annual Convention.
 - 8) Serve as the Master of Ceremonies during the Closing Ceremony.
 - 9) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and Convention Secretary.
- i. The Subcommittee on Registration shall:
- 1) Plan and conduct a systematic and efficient registration.
 - 2) Formulate, publish and disseminate guidelines and mechanics of registration subject to approval by the BOT.
 - 3) Prepare for the expected number of participants based on the number of registrants in the past years.
 - 4) Prepare the convention kits, convention IDs and Certificates of Attendance.
 - 5) Coordinate with the Subcommittee on PATS for the physical and technical requirements including:
 - i. Registration booths (invited dignitaries, speakers, pre-registered, onsite delegates)
 - ii. Automated registration kiosks manned by ICT service provider
 - 6) Publish the registration process in the POGS website.
 - 7) Oversee on-site registration in coordination with the Accounting Secretariat.
 - 8) Report on the number of pre-registered participants and on-site participants during the Annual Convention.
 - 9) Coordinate with the ICT service provider on the computerized data of actual participants who registered.
 - 10) Prepare an updated number of registered participants and submit to the Board Secretary before the Annual Business Meeting.
 - 11) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and Convention Secretary.
- j. The Subcommittee on Scientific Program shall:
- 1) Identify the convention theme, lecture topics and schedule of scientific sessions.
 - 2) Invite foreign and local speakers and moderators.

- 3) Coordinate with the following:
 - i. Subcommittee on Ways and Means for the sponsorship of invited speakers
 - ii. Speaker's Bureau for follow up communications with the speakers
 - iii. PATS for the inclusion of the Scientific Program and curriculum vitae of speakers in the POGS Events App
 - iv. POGS subspecialty and affiliate societies for the topics and speakers of the Simultaneous Sessions
 - 4) Prepare the scientific program and coordinate with the Subcommittee on Programs and Invitations for the timely printing and publication.
 - 5) Oversee the conduct of scientific sessions during the convention:
 - i. Ensure that time schedules are observed.
 - ii. Confer with the speakers as to their needs.
 - iii. Plan alternatives in any untoward eventuality.
 - 6) Submit requirements for application for PRC-CPD and PMA-CME units before the convention and post-activity completion report according to the requirements of the concerned agency.
 - 7) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and Convention Secretary.
- k. The Subcommittee on Scientific Works and Abstracts shall:
- 1) Prepare the guidelines/requirements of the scientific papers for presentation in the Annual Convention.
 - 2) Screen and select scientific papers for oral and poster presentation in the Hall of Abstracts.
 - 3) Coordinate with the Subcommittee on PATS and event coordinator on the visual layout and presentation of the scientific works during the Annual Convention.
 - 4) Invite judges and prepare the evaluation criteria to select the winners of the paper presentation.
 - 5) Prepare the certificates of recognition and participation for the winners and finalists, and certificates of appreciation for the judges.
 - 6) Coordinate with the Subcommittee on Ways and Means with the support of sponsors for the event, including trophies, prizes, tokens and other logistical requirements.
 - 7) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and Convention Secretary.
- l. The Subcommittee on Socials shall:
- 1) Organize the Welcome Reception and Fellowship Night.
 - 2) Coordinate with the following:
 - i. Subcommittee on Ways and Means for the support and logistical requirements of the social activities
 - ii. Subcommittee on PATS for venue requirements and details of the program

- iii. BOT, Regional Directors and Organizing Committee for the presentation numbers during the Fellowship Night.
- 3) Ensure that the general protocols are followed in the preparation of the social programs.
- 4) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and Convention Secretary.
- m. The Subcommittee on Souvenir Program shall:
 - 1) Prepare the souvenir program to include activities and highlights of the Annual Convention and all other materials necessary for its publication.
 - 2) Submit cover design based on the theme for approval by the BOT.
 - 3) Coordinate with Subcommittee on Ways and Means for solicitation of advertisements and collection of fees.
 - 4) Coordinate with other subcommittees for the inclusion of their activities in the souvenir program.
 - 5) Submit content and layout of the souvenir program for approval by the Overall Chair.
 - 6) Obtain quotations for printing.
 - 7) Ensure that the souvenir program is ready for distribution at least one (1) week before the Annual Convention.
 - 8) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and Convention Secretary.
- n. The Subcommittee on Speakers' Bureau shall:
 - 1) Coordinate with the Subcommittees on Scientific Program, Documentation, Hospitality and Tours, and PATS for the requirements prior to and during the convention including:
 - i. Lecture abstracts/manuscripts
 - ii. Curriculum vitae and photos of speakers
 - iii. Lecture in e-file at least one (1) week prior to the scheduled session
 - iv. Travel plans and proposed itinerary of speakers
 - v. Attendance during sessions
 - 2) Ensure follow up letters are sent to speakers for updates on travel plans.
 - 3) Coordinate with the PATS and ICT service provider to address technical requirements of speakers.
 - 4) Coordinate with the assigned Session Chair and Co-chair before and during the session.
 - 5) Collate questions and submit them to the Session Chair and Co-chair.
 - 6) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and Convention Secretary.

- o. The Subcommittee on Sports shall:
 - 1) Propose a theme for the sporting event and organize all related activities that will encourage active participation of members and promote camaraderie and unity rather than competition.
 - 2) Set the date and the venue of the sports activity.
 - 3) Ensure the safety of all members during the sporting event with the support of the Organizing Committee.
 - 4) Coordinate with the PATS and ICT service provider to address technical requirements of the event.
 - 5) Prepare logistical requirements such as trophies, prizes, tokens and submit them to the Organizing Committee for approval by the BOT.
 - 6) Perform such other duties as may be assigned by the Overall Chair and Convention Secretary.

E. COMMITTEE ON CREDENTIALS AND MEMBERSHIP

- 1. The Committee shall:
 - a. Regularly assess the status of members and recommend measures to maintain active membership.
 - b. Recommend to the BOT the candidates for Fellows, Junior, Affiliate and Honorary Members.
 - c. Receive the list of Diplomates from the PBOG and present to the BOT.
 - d. Review cases of members with financial delinquency referred by the Committee on Finance, and recommend appropriate censures or disciplinary actions to the BOT, in accordance with the provisions of the Bylaws.
 - e. Shall oversee and ensure the administrative coordination, operational management and periodic evaluation of programs or initiatives assigned to the Committee as duly approved by the BOT for implementation:
 - 1) Members Mental Wellness and Motivation (M3)
 - 2) Other future programs which shall be developed and approved by the BOT
- 2. Composition:
 - a. The Board Secretary shall serve as the Chair of the Committee.
 - b. The members of the committee shall be four (4) active Fellows.
 - c. The members shall serve for three (3) years on a staggered basis.
 - d. The PBOG and CREED Secretary shall serve as ex-officio members.

F. COMMITTEE ON MUTUAL ASSISTANCE PROGRAM

1. The Committee shall:
 - a. Be responsible for providing financial assistance for death and sickness to POGS Mutual Assistance Program (MAP) members as provided for in the MAP manual.
 - b. Set the rules, regulations and guidelines governing the implementation of the MAP, subject to the approval by the BOT.
 - c. Report quarterly or periodically, any disbursement and accounting thereof to the BOT.
2. Composition:
 - a. The Chair shall be the Board Secretary and shall serve as the Business Manager.
 - b. The members shall be five (5) active Fellows who shall serve for a term of three (3) years on a staggered basis, except for the Chair.

Note: Refer to the MAP Manual for the implementation of policies, guidelines and procedures.

G. COMMITTEE ON FINANCE

1. The Committee shall:
 - a. Manage the POGS Foundation's funds and provide the BOT with guidance on financial planning and fiscal responsibility, as outlined in Article XI of the Bylaws.
 - b. Assist the BOT in preparing the budget of the POGS Foundation.
2. Composition:
 - a. The Treasurer shall serve as the Chair of the Committee.
 - b. The members shall be:
 - 1) Business Manager of the CMAP
 - 2) Secretary of PBOG
 - 3) Business Manager of the PJOG
 - 4) Two (2) active fellows
3. The Subcommittee on Ways and Means shall accept donations to support all activities of the POGS Foundation and the Annual Convention and shall abide by the guidelines of the Unrestricted Educational Grants. (Appendix II: Ethical Guidelines on Pharmaceutical and Non-Pharmaceutical Sponsorship).

H. COMMITTEE ON INFORMATION DISSEMINATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY

1. The Committee shall:
 - a. Effectively communicate the POGS Foundation's vision, mission, core values, policies and activities to members and the public.
 - b. Manage all forms of information from the POGS Foundation including but not limited to:
 - 1) POGS Website
 - 2) Newsletter
 - 3) Other media platforms
 - c. Promulgate rules and regulations pertaining to information dissemination and communication technology.
 - d. Explore ways to integrate information technology into the POGS Foundation's interactions with members nationwide and globally
 - e. Develop programs and policies to incorporate information technology into the POGS Foundation's operations.
 - f. Ensure compliance to the ethical standards of the POGS Foundation.
 - g. Ensure compliance to the Data Privacy Law, as provided for in the Data Privacy Manual
2. Composition:
 - a. The PRO shall serve as the Chair of the Committee.
 - b. The Board Secretary shall be one of its members.
 - c. The members of the Committee shall be five (5) active Fellows
 - d. The Chair and the members shall have a tenure of three (3) years on a staggered basis depending on the year of appointment or assumption of post.

I. COMMITTEE ON AWARDS

1. The Committee shall:
 - a. Be responsible for the search and selection of outstanding members for the different POGS Foundation awards:
 - 1) Dr. Baldomero L. Roxas Memorial Lecturer and Awardee for Academic Distinction
 - 2) Dr. Ramon M. Lopez Award of Merit for Community Service
 - 3) Dr. Honoria D. Acosta-Sison Award of Merit for Research
 - 4) Dr. Constantino P. Manahan Young Researcher Award
 - 5) Dr. Julita R. Jalbuena Award of Excellence in Clinical Practice
 - b. Promulgate rules, procedures and criteria in the choice of nominees for the awards subject to approval by the BOT. Any change in the criteria shall be subject to approval by the BOT.
 - c. Recommend to the BOT qualified members for local and international awards.

2. **Composition:**
 - a. The Chair shall be a Past President.
 - b. The five (5) members shall be Past Presidents or former awardees.

I. DR. BALDOMERO L. ROXAS MEMORIAL LECTURER AND AWARDEE FOR ACADEMIC DISTINCTION	
- The lecture shall be delivered during the Opening Ceremonies of the Annual Convention.	
<u>Criteria:</u>	
1. Must be outstanding in the field of academic OB-GYN 2. Must be a Fellow of the POGS Foundation for at least fifteen (15) years 3. Must have rendered meritorious service to the POGS Foundation 4. Must have contributed outstanding works in Philippine OB-GYN 5. Must be of good moral character	
DR. BALDOMERO L. ROXAS MEMORIAL LECTURER AND AWARDEE FOR ACADEMIC DISTINCTION	
A. MUST BE OUTSTANDING (MARKED BY EMINENCE AND DISTINCTION) IN THE FIELD OF ACADEMIC OB-GYN (85 points)	
Criteria	Points
1. Dedication to teaching	1 point for every year of teaching; maximum of 20 points
2. Must have attained highest academic rank	Maximum of 30 points
a. Professor in OB-GYN	15 points
b. Professor Emeritus or PhD	5 points
c. Chair of an accredited OB-GYN Department	5 points
d. Dean of College of Medicine	5 points
3. Must have received special honors or recognition in academic excellence	Maximum of 20 points
a. Outstanding Medical Alumnus	5 points each
b. Outstanding Faculty in OB-GYN	
c. Outstanding Physician of a Medical Society	
d. Professional Chair holder	
e. Keynote Speaker in national and/or international scientific meetings/conventions	
f. National and/or international award	
4. Must have contributed significant works in OB-GYN	Maximum of 15 points
a. Published researches in peer-reviewed journals	
i. International journals	2 points for each paper
ii. Philippine journals	1 point for each paper
b. Authored, edited, or contributed chapters in books in OB-GYN or related specialties	
i. Author/Editor	10 points per book
ii. Chapter Contributor	2 points per chapter
c. Author in published Clinical Practice Guidelines	1 point per CPG

d. Introduced/pioneered innovative ideas, diagnostic tests, treatments, procedures and/or instruments	5 points
B. MUST HAVE RENDERED MERITORIOUS SERVICES TO THE POGS FOUNDATION (15 points)	
Criteria	Points
1. Must have been POGS Foundation President or Officer of the POGS Foundation	
a. As President	7.5 points
b. As officer or member of the BOT	2.5 points
2. Must have been Chair or member of PBOG and/or CREED	
a. As Chair	5 points
b. As member	1 point for every year of service; maximum of 3 points
3. Must have been participating in POGS CME activities as speaker/lecturer in postgraduate courses or scientific meetings	1 point per occasion, maximum of 5 points
4. President of POGS-affiliated specialty societies	2 points
A minimum of seventy-five (75 points) must be obtained to merit the award	

II. DR. HONORIA D. ACOSTA-SISON AWARD OF MERIT FOR RESEARCH

Criteria:

1. Must have outstanding OB-GYN research papers/books published
2. Must be a Fellow of the POGS Foundation in good standing for at least fifteen (15) years
3. Must be an active participant in CME, research and other scientific activities of the POGS Foundation
4. Must be a person of good moral character

DR. HONORIA D. ACOSTA-SISON AWARD OF MERIT FOR RESEARCH	
Criteria	Points
1. Must have scientific papers published in peer-reviewed medical journals	60 points
a. In Philippine journals	10 points per paper
b. In International journals	10 points per paper
2. Must be author, editor or chapter contributor in books and handbooks	30 points
a. Books	Maximum of 20 points
i. Editor	10 points per book
ii. Chapter contributor	5 points per chapter
b. Handbooks, CPGs included	Maximum of 10 points
i. Editor	5 points per handbook
ii. Chapter contributor	3 points per chapter
3. Membership in editorial boards of peer-reviewed journals	10 points
a. Editor-in-Chief of the PJOG or other DOST-recognized journal in OB GYN	4 points for each membership
b. Member in Philippine journals	2 points for each membership
c. Member in international journals	4 points for each

	membership
A minimum of seventy-five (75 points) must be obtained to merit the award	

III. DR. RAMON M. LOPEZ AWARD OF MERIT FOR COMMUNITY SERVICE

Criteria:

1. Must have rendered and submitted outstanding meritorious community work
2. Must have documented active participation in community medical outreach programs
3. Must be a Fellow of the POGS Foundation in good standing for at least fifteen (15) years
4. Must be a person of good moral character

DR. RAMON M. LOPEZ AWARD OF MERIT FOR COMMUNITY SERVICE

Criteria	Points
1. Must have rendered meritorious community service for at least five (5) years	60 points
a. POGS-initiated	40 points
b. Non-POGS initiated and collaborated	20 points
2. Must be an outstanding practitioner in OB-GYN	25 points
a. Must have attained prestigious position in field of practice	10 points
b. President of medical society (specialty, local, national or international)	10 points
c. Other positions in the medical society	5 points
3. Recipient of special awards or distinctions and recognitions granted by a medical society, socio-civic organization, government, non-government and other entities	10 points
4. Must have documented active participation in community medical outreach programs	5 points per program; maximum of 15 points
A minimum of seventy-five (75 points) must be obtained to merit the award	

IV. DR. CONSTANTINO P. MANAHAN YOUNG RESEARCHER AWARD

Criteria:

1. Must have outstanding OB-GYN research papers done and published beyond residency and/or fellowship training
2. Must be 40 years of age and below at the time of nomination
3. Must be a Diplomate/Fellow of the POGS Foundation in good standing
4. Must be a person of good moral character

DR. CONSTANTINO P. MANAHAN YOUNG RESEARCHER AWARD

Criteria	Points
1. Must have outstanding OB-GYN research papers published	70 points
a. At least one (1) research paper published in an international journal or three (3) papers (original) published in the PJOG or other local journals of wide circulation	40 points
b. Awards in any of the research paper contests	20 points
i. First prize	15 points

ii. Second prize	5 points
c. Recipient of research grants	10 points
2. Must have presented major research work in a proper forum, seminar or congress	15 points
3. Must be an active member of scientific, academic or professional organizations	15 points
A minimum of seventy-five (75 points) must be obtained to merit the award	

V. DR. JULITA R. JALBUENA AWARD OF EXCELLENCE IN CLINICAL PRACTICE

Criteria:

1. Must be outstanding in the clinical practice of OB-GYN
2. Must have been acknowledged by the Regional Director
3. Must be a Fellow of the POGS Foundation in good standing
4. Must be a person of good moral character

DR. JULITA R. JALBUENA AWARD OF EXCELLENCE IN CLINICAL PRACTICE

Criteria	Points
1. At least 30 years of practice	70 points
2. Participation in the local chapter of POGS and its CME activities	10 points
3. Social and civic works	10 points
4. Innovative ideas, devices, surgical techniques, systems, methods, diagnostic tests relevant to clinical practice and local situations	10 points
A minimum of seventy-five (75 points) must be obtained to merit the award	

All awardees shall receive an award endowment subject to approval by the BOT.

IV. CONSTITUTIONAL COMMITTEES

A. COMMON PROVISIONS

1. The Committees shall consist of the following:
 - a. Bids and Awards
 - b. Elections
 - c. Ethics and Medical Practice
 - d. Foundation Oversight
 - e. Internal Audit
 - f. Nominations
2. Each committee shall be composed of at least five (5) active Fellows (inclusive of the Chair), who are generally known to have the necessary knowledge and experience required for the position.
3. No member of a Constitutional Committee shall hold any elective position within the POGS Foundation.

B. COMMITTEE ON BIDS AND AWARDS

1. The Committee shall implement procurement processes for transactions amounting to at least five hundred thousand pesos (Php500,000) and ensure transparency, fairness and compliance in awarding contracts or acquiring goods and services.
2. The Committee shall:
 - a. Receive the sealed bid/protected file
 - b. Determine the eligibility of prospective bidders
 - c. Conduct the bidding process
 - d. Undertake post-qualification proceedings
 - e. Award the contracts
3. Members shall serve for a term of three (3) years on a staggered basis without prejudice to reappointment, consisting of a Chair and four (4) members, chosen among Past Presidents, Past Treasurers, and Past Board Secretaries. The incumbent Board Secretary shall serve as a Liaison Officer.

Note: Refer to the IRR of the Republic Act No. 12009 or the New Government Procurement Act for guidance on the process of bids and awards.

C. COMMITTEE ON ELECTIONS (COMELEC)

1. The COMELEC shall:
 - a. Oversee the organization, supervision and integrity of the election.
 - b. Administer the Election Code of the POGS Foundation.
 - c. Be the sole judge of all protests and complaints relating to the election returns and qualifications of all members of the BOT.
 - d. Have the authority to postpone, suspend and/or cancel an election for valid reasons as determined by the Committee.
2. The Chair, in the presence of its members, shall preside over the election of the Officers from among the proclaimed winners for the BOT.
3. All decisions rendered by the COMELEC shall be final, unless appealed to the appropriate body within ten (10) days from the proclamation of the election results.
4. The COMELEC shall consist of five (5) members who are Past Presidents for at least one (1) year before the current election year, appointed by the President with the approval by the BOT, serving for a term of three (3) years on a staggered basis, without prejudice to reappointment unless replaced due to incapacity to serve, or resignation.
5. The Chair shall be appointed by the President among the third year members, with the approval by the BOT for a term of one (1) year.

Note: Refer to POGS Election Code for the provisions pertinent to committee functions, guidelines and procedures.

D. COMMITTEE ON ETHICS AND MEDICAL PRACTICE

1. The Committee shall:
 - a. Uphold ethical standards and best practices in medical care, research and professional conduct.
 - b. Implement relevant provisions on professional and ethical matters, including the POGS Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct 2025 Edition. It shall make decisions and impose sanctions as deemed necessary, in accordance with the Bylaws and applicable laws.
 - c. Extend assistance to any active member upon request and provide expert witness from the POGS Foundation as necessary. (See Manual on the Guidelines for Fellows who Act as Expert Witness)
 - d. Provide the BOT and Committee on Credentials and Membership a copy of the evaluation and final decision regarding the conferment of Fellows and Diplomates.
 - e. Provide the BOT with a copy of the decision on the censure, suspension or expulsion of any member for cause, or the exoneration of any member found innocent. The decision of the CEMP is final and executory, but can be subject to appeal to the BOT within a certain reglementary period.
 - f. Actively participate in the CME Regional assemblies to integrate medico-legal and ethical topics into obstetric and gynecologic practice.
2. The Committee shall be composed of at least five (5) Past Presidents. The Board Secretary shall serve as a Liaison Officer. The incumbent PBOG and CREED Chairs shall serve as ex-officio members.
3. The Committee shall have a Subcommittee on Medico-Legal Affairs.
 - a. The subcommittee shall:
 - 1) Receive current medico-legal cases involving members, compile and evaluate them jointly to make collective decisions and recommendations to the CEMP. A copy of the decision shall be furnished to the BOT.
 - 2) Collect, assess and determine the status of ongoing litigations.
 - 3) Coordinate with the POGS legal counsel in the evaluation and resolution of medico-legal cases concerning members.
 - 4) Formulate and implement guidelines to prevent and minimize malpractice suits in OB-GYN practice.
 - 5) Coordinate with and assist the Regional Directors in addressing malpractice cases within their respective regions.
 - b. The subcommittee shall be:
 - 1) Chaired by a Past President who was a former member of the CEMP.

- 2) Composed of at least five (5) Past Presidents with at least one (1) of them being a former member of CEMP.

NOTE: Refer to the Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct 2025 Edition for the provisions pertinent to committee functions, guidelines and procedures.

E. COMMITTEE ON FOUNDATION OVERSIGHT

1. The Committee shall:
 - a. Determine the relevance and level of achievement of objectives, timelines, development effectiveness, efficiency, impact, cost and sustainability of all committees, in relation to the POGS Foundation.
 - b. Monitor and evaluate all programs, ensuring that they are in compliance with the objectives for which they exist.
 - c. Decide the continuation/dissolution of a project, reclassification of an Ad Hoc Committee or a Subcommittee, and the integration of committees with similar objectives.
2. For each project, the Committee shall:
 - a. Review the relevant information, scope of work, project cost and the efficiency of the output by designing and developing data collection and program evaluation tools.
 - b. Clarify the role of each member involved in the project.
 - c. Analyze the work plan and schedule that includes clear milestone dates.
 - d. Submit an evaluation report to the President regarding the status of the project.
3. A Past President shall serve as the Chair of the Committee and members shall be active Fellows, and shall serve for a term of three (3) years, on a staggered basis.
4. The Committee shall engage the services of an External Evaluator when deemed necessary.

F. COMMITTEE ON INTERNAL AUDIT

1. The Committee shall:
 - a. Be responsible for overseeing financial reporting, internal controls and compliance with legal and regulatory standards.
 - b. Examine and audit all accounts related to the revenue, receipts and expenditures owned by or held in trust for the POGS Foundation and its instrumentalities.
 - c. Promulgate rules and regulations, in accordance with generally accepted accounting and auditing principles, to safeguard the funds and properties, and regulate expenditures of the POGS Foundation.
 - d. Render an externally audited financial report during the Annual Business Meeting.
2. The Committee shall consist of a Chair and two (2) members, preferably Past Treasurers.

3. The Chair and members shall be appointed by the President with the approval by the BOT for a term of three (3) years.

G. COMMITTEE ON NOMINATIONS

1. The Committee shall:
 - a. Be the body responsible for overseeing and ensuring the integrity of the POGS Foundation's nomination process.
 - b. Receive and screen the eligibility of prospective nominees for the BOT in the Annual Election.
 - c. Follow the standard criteria in qualifying nominees for election to the BOT and ensure that the required number of candidates is filled.
 - d. Submit the list of qualified nominees of at least fifteen (15) Fellows from NCR, two (2) from North Luzon, two (2) from South Luzon, two (2) from the Visayas and two (2) from Mindanao to the COMELEC, with a copy furnished to the BOT, for the preparation of the Candidate's Brochure and publication in all designated sites.
2. The Committee shall consist of five (5) members who are Past Presidents for at least one (1) year before the current year, appointed by the President with the approval by the BOT for a term of three (3) years on a staggered basis, without prejudice to reappointment unless replaced due to incapacity to serve, or resignation.
3. The Chair shall be appointed by the President from among the third year members, with the approval by the BOT, for a term of one (1) year.

Note: Refer to the POGS Election Code for the provisions pertinent to committee functions, guidelines and procedures.

V. AD HOC COMMITTEES

A. GENERAL PROVISIONS

1. These Committees shall:
 - a. Be created by the BOT upon the recommendation of the President as the need arises.
 - b. Perform the tasks outlined for the purpose the Committee was created.
 - c. Shall be composed of at least five (5) active Fellows who are generally known to have the necessary knowledge and experience required for the position.
2. The composition and tenure of these committees shall be determined by the specific objectives and functions for which they are created.
3. A BOT member or an active Fellow shall serve as the Chair. Members shall be active Fellows or Diplomates.

B. COMMITTEE ON AMENDMENTS

1. The Committee shall:
 - a. Be responsible for all amendments or revisions in the Articles of Incorporation, Constitution and Bylaws.
 - b. Initiate, receive and study proposals for amendment of the Articles of Incorporation, Constitution and Bylaws and ensure timely submission of proposals to the BOT for appropriate action.
 - c. Make certain that all BOT-approved amendments are sent to the members at least sixty (60) days before the Annual Business Meeting.
 - d. Make certain that all BOT-approved amendments are presented for ratification by the members during the Annual Business Meeting.
2. A BOT member shall serve as the Chair of the Committee. Members shall be Past Presidents or active Fellows duly approved by the BOT.

CHAPTER 4

PHILIPPINE BOARD OF OBSTETRICS AND GYNECOLOGY

I. NAME AND PURPOSE

- A. The PBOG shall serve as the official accrediting and certifying body of the POGS Foundation.
- B. It shall be autonomous in its functions, but is administratively under the BOT. PBOG exercises full functional autonomy in accreditation and certification matters, while working in administrative coordination with the BOT for governance alignment and institutional support.

II. FUNCTIONS

The PBOG shall be responsible for:

A. Certifying Examination

1. Formulate the requirements, rules and regulations governing the Diplomate Certifying Examination and seek the approval of the BOT.
2. Conduct the certifying examinations.
3. Certify as Junior Members those who have passed the Part I (Written) Examination.
4. Certify as Diplomates those who have passed the Part I (Written) and Part II (Oral) Specialty Board Examinations.
5. Determine the requirements of a candidate for possible re-examination for a specified number of times.
6. Set the fees for examination and re-examination for approval by the BOT.

B. Hospital Accreditation

1. Set the minimum requirements for accreditation and periodically audit compliance of a Residency Training Program in OB-GYN through the:
 - a. Regular/Traditional Hospital Accreditation
 - b. Provisional Accreditation of Residency Training Programs (PART-P) – a modified and regulated scheme that uses a stepwise accreditation system. It is considered as Level I accreditation divided into five (5) phases (PAP 0-4) that will culminate to a Regular Level II Accreditation.
2. Accredit residency training programs and publish the list of accredited programs annually.
3. Determine the outcomes of the hospital accreditation visit.
4. Set the fees for hospital accreditation for approval by the BOT.

Note: Refer to the PBOG Handbook for details on Hospital Accreditation

- C. Formulating additional requirements, rules and regulations that are deemed necessary for the efficient functioning of the PBOG. These shall be enforced immediately upon approval by the BOT.
- D. Determining and submitting for approval the PBOG budget for the subsequent fiscal year to the BOT.

III. COMPOSITION

- A. The PBOG shall be composed of a minimum of fifteen (15) members, which shall include the Chair.
- B. The PBOG Chair shall be elected from among the outgoing (third year) members during the last regular PBOG meeting of the year as supervised by the COMELEC, approved by the BOT. The Chair shall serve as a member of the Committee on Internal Affairs and an Ex-officio member of the CEMP.
- C. The PBOG shall consist of eleven (11) representatives from five (5) academic institutions that have permanent seats. The remaining seats shall come from the regional medical schools and the non-academic sectors.

Composition of the PBOG Members/Allotment of Seats

ACADEMIC SECTOR	
NCR	
UP-PGH	3
UST	3
FEU NRMF	2
UERMMMC	2
MCU-FDTMF	1
Permanent seats (11)	
Other NCR Medical Schools, Private Sector	1
Other NCR Medical Schools, Government Sector	1
REGIONAL	
Northern and Central Luzon Medical Schools	1
Southern Luzon Medical Schools	1
Cebu Medical Schools	1
Visayas Medical Schools	1
Mindanao Medical Schools	1
Other medical schools nationwide (7)	

NON-ACADEMIC SECTOR	
NCR	
Private Sector	1
Government Sector	1
REGIONAL	
Government Sector	1
TOTAL	21

- D. [A PBOG member shall continue to represent only the institution or the sector that one represented upon entry to the PBOG.](#)
- E. [The prospective members shall be nominated by the concerned institution/sector, recommended by the PBOG and approved by the BOT.](#)
- F. Members in their third year shall be designated heads of the following committees:
1. Written Examination
 2. Oral Examination
 3. Hospital Accreditation
 4. PART-P
 5. SOPs including workshops
 6. Other Ad Hoc Committees, as deemed necessary by the PBOG
- G. A regular member of the PBOG shall not hold any chairmanship in a committee/subcommittee.
- H. [A third year PBOG member shall be appointed by the PBOG Chair to be the Liaison Officer between the PBOG and the CREED.](#)
- I. The PBOG Secretary shall :
1. [Be appointed by the PBOG Chair, approved by the BOT, and is not part of the PBOG membership.](#)
 2. Serve as the executive administrative officer and a non-voting member.
 3. Serve as an Ex-officio member of the Committee on Finance and the Committee on Credentials and Membership.
- J. [The Board Secretary shall be the Liaison Officer between the BOT and the PBOG.](#)

Note: Mechanics of the nomination process are described in detail in the PBOG Manual of Operations 2026

IV. QUALIFICATIONS

- A. All members shall be active Fellows for at least ten (10) consecutive years, except for the PBOG Secretary.
- B. The PBOG Chair shall have served as a member of the PBOG for three (3) consecutive years.
- C. The PBOG Secretary shall be an active Fellow for at least five (5) years and shall come from the Academic Sector with a minimum rank of Assistant Professor.
- D. Each PBOG member shall represent a POGS-accredited training institution upon entry. The institution being represented is mandated to maintain its accreditation status.
- E. All members from the Academic Sector shall be:
 - 1. At least an Assistant Professor
 - 2. Actively engaged in teaching in the Department of OB-GYN
 - 3. Recommended by the Department Chair that one is representing
- F. The Non-Academic Government Sector refers to institutions under the DOH or its aligned tertiary level hospitals/medical centers. This sector shall:
 - 1. Be represented by two (2) members (1 National Capital Region [NCR] and 1 Regional)
 - 2. Have been a past Chair or Training Officer of a POGS-accredited training institution
- G. The Non-Academic Private Sector shall be represented by one (1) member from any POGS-accredited private training institution or tertiary hospital in the country, with the same qualifications required of the government sector representative.
- H. Representatives from the government and private sectors shall not have an academic affiliation/rank. They shall be recommended by the Regional Director.
- I. Any of the following disqualifies one from becoming a member of the PBOG:
 - 1. Clinical Chair of the Department of OB-GYN
 - 2. Training Officer of a POGS-accredited training institution
 - 3. Chair of any POGS Committee
 - 4. Member of the POGS Committee on CME
 - 5. Anyone involved in any manner in review courses for the PBOG Parts I and II certifying examinations and Residency In-Service Examination (RISE)

Note: Details of the nomination process are described in detail in the PBOG Manual of Operations 2026

V. TENURE

- A. The PBOG Chair shall serve for one (1) year, effective from the beginning of the next calendar year.
- B. The PBOG Secretary shall serve for one (1) year without prejudice to reappointment, for a maximum of three (3) consecutive years.
- C. The PBOG members shall serve for a mandatory term of three (3) years, unless he/she resigns or is removed by the BOT upon the recommendation of PBOG. No member shall be appointed for a second consecutive term.
- D. Appointments to vacancies in PBOG shall be for the unexpired/unserved term of the original member, and shall come from the same sector, recommended by the PBOG members, and approved by the BOT.
- E. In the event that the position of the PBOG Chair becomes vacant, a new Chair is elected from among the current third year members, and shall serve the remainder of the unexpired term. This newly elected Chair shall still be eligible for nomination and election as Chair for the following year.

VI. REVENUES

All revenues derived from the functions of PBOG shall be entered in the books as income of the POGS Foundation.

VII. COMPENSATION

- A. The members of the PBOG shall not receive monetary compensation for services rendered. Incidental expenses incurred in the performance of such services shall be reimbursed upon the approval by the BOT.
- B. Material gifts given by the training institutions during hospital visits are discouraged.

VIII. PBOG CODE OF CONDUCT

- A. Protect the PBOG and uphold the honor and integrity of the esteemed PBOG at all times.
- B. Be circumspect in observing justice and equality towards all, in conduct and attitude.

- C. Observe and respect the independence of co-members in making decisions after collegial discussions by the Body.
- D. Guard all decisions of the PBOG and faithfully abide by them.
- E. Preserve the nondisclosure agreement on all matters held in trust and declared confidential by the PBOG and the POGS Foundation.
- F. Operate with objectivity, fairness, impartiality and equality towards all candidates during examinations and accreditation of residency training institutions.
- G. Give objective and impartial evaluation of all candidates and hospitals, maintaining objectivity over and above personal acquaintances or family relationships amongst persons.
- H. Serve the PBOG with integrity and commitment, by not participating in activities with residents/graduates of residency training institutions which may put the integrity of the PBOG in question.
- I. Forego serving concurrently as Training Officer or clinical Department Chair of any accredited OB-GYN residency training institution.
- J. Inhibit oneself from serving as chair of any POGS Foundation committee/subcommittee.
- K. Nurture collegiality, camaraderie and mutual respect among the members of the PBOG at all times.
- L. Carefully, freely and faithfully abide by the PBOG Code of Conduct.

Note: [The rules and regulations governing the manner and conduct of the PBOG shall be provided for in the Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct 2025 Edition and the PBOG Handbook 2023 \(6th Edition\) and its accompanying Manual of Operations 2026.](#)

- IX. The PBOG Handbook contains all the specific details on the full function of the PBOG that is continuously updated as the need arises, and shall be available to the members for reference.
- X. [There are periodic Tripartite \(BOT, CREED and PBOG\) and Quadripartite \(BOT, CREED, PBOG, CHAS/other committees\) meetings for important resolutions governing the functions of PBOG.](#)

CHAPTER 5

COUNCIL FOR RESIDENTS' EDUCATION, ENHANCEMENT, AND DEVELOPMENT

I. NAME OF THE BODY

- A. The body shall be called the Council for Residents' Education, Enhancement and Development (CREED).
- B. The CREED shall be directly under the BOT as provided in Article VI Section 1.2 of the 2025 By-Laws.

II. FUNCTIONS

The CREED shall:

- A. Oversee the implementation of the residency training curricula in POGS-accredited and PART-P hospitals, and ensure compliance with accreditation requirements for hospital certification and resident trainee qualifications, including curriculum implementation, facility standards, and residency competency.
- B. Establish a comprehensive evaluation tool for accredited residency training programs.
- C. Coordinate with other Committees on matters relevant to residency training.
- D. Align with institutions and local or international organizations (e.g., World Health Organization [WHO], DOH, PRC) on matters aligned with residency training policies.
- E. Organize regular meetings, workshops and other tools of training for the Department Chairs, Training Officers or their representatives on matters pertaining or relevant to the residency training program.
- F. Prepare, conduct and report the results of the annual RISE to the BOT, furnishing a copy to the PBOG.
- G. Review and update the CREED Handbook and Administrative Manual every five (5) years or as deemed necessary.
- H. Determine and submit an operational budget to the BOT before the end of each calendar year.

III. COMPOSITION

- A. The CREED shall be composed of a minimum of fifteen (15) members, including the Chair and the Secretary. Of these, a minimum of eight (8) members shall come from the Academic Sector, three (3) from the Non-Academic Government Sector and three (3) from the Non-Academic Private Sector. The sector represented by the Chair shall be replaced by a new member once he/she assumes office.

Composition of the CREED Members/Allotment of Seats

CHAIR (1)	1
ACADEMIC SECTOR (8)	
UP-PGH	1
UST	1
FEU NRMF	1
UERMMMC	1
MCU-FDTMF	1
Other Medical Schools (with accredited training programs in OB-GYN) and have been in existence for more than twenty (20) years	3
NON-ACADEMIC SECTOR (6)	
Private Sector	
NCR	1
Regional	2
Government Sector	
NCR	1
Regional	2
TOTAL	15

- B. The members shall be nominated by the Department Chairs of their respective institutions. The nominees shall be recommended by CREED for approval by the BOT.
- C. The CREED Chair shall be chosen among the members of the CREED who have served for three (3) consecutive years and voted upon by the members. Election of the CREED Chair shall be held during the CREED's last meeting of the year and supervised by the COMELEC, for approval by the BOT.
- D. The CREED Secretary shall either be a second or third year member and recommended by the CREED Chair, for approval by the BOT.
- E. The chairs of the CREED Committees shall be chosen among the third year members.

- F. A third year member of the PBOG shall be the Liaison Officer to the CREED.
- G. The Board Secretary shall be the Liaison Officer between the BOT and the CREED.

IV. QUALIFICATIONS

- A. All members shall come from POGS-accredited training institutions.
- B. All members shall have been active Fellows of POGS for at least ten (10) years.
- C. Members coming from the Academic Sector shall have a rank of at least Assistant Professor.
- D. Members coming from the Non-academic Sector shall have any one (1) of the following qualifications:
 - 1. A Past Department Chair/Training Officer of a POGS-accredited training institution
 - 2. A former member of BOT or PBOG
 - 3. Completed a Masters' Degree in Health Professions Education (MHPEd) or any health education-related field
 - 4. Attended at least three (3) medical education workshops or units in MHPEd
- E. The following are disqualified from becoming a member of the CREED:
 - 1. Clinical Chair of the Department of OB-GYN
 - 2. Training Officer or member of a Residency Training Committee
 - 3. Chair of any POGS Committee
 - 4. Member of the POGS Committee on CME, or any POGS scientific program committee
 - 5. Anyone involved in any manner in review courses for the PBOG Parts I and II certifying examinations and RISE
 - 6. Fellows with relatives up to the third degree of consanguinity and/or affinity taking up residency training in OB-GYN

V. TENURE

- A. The CREED Chair shall serve for a term of one (1) year.
- B. The CREED Secretary shall serve for a term of one (1) year and may be re-appointed for an additional one (1) year, upon recommendation of the incoming Chair.
- C. The members shall serve for a term of three (3) years unless removed for cause by the BOT.

- D. In the event of resignation, disability or removal of a member, the BOT shall appoint a replacement from the same sector to serve the unexpired term.

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CHAPTER 6 INFORMATION AND SCIENTIFIC PUBLICATIONS

I. PHILIPPINE JOURNAL OF OBSTETRICS AND GYNECOLOGY

A. Name of the Journal

The POGS Foundation shall publish its own official scientific publication which shall be known as the Philippine Journal of Obstetrics and Gynecology (PJOG).

B. Objectives

The PJOG shall:

1. Be the medium through which medical research and other scientific investigations shall be disseminated and have exclusive rights to researches funded by the POGS Foundation, including ownership, publication, distribution and commercial use.
2. Contribute publications to local and international medical literature.
3. Encourage scientific writing among the members of the POGS Foundation and trainees of POGS-accredited training institutions.
4. Publish OB-GYN related scientific works which are subjected to peer review and approved by the editorial board.
5. Be accessible to all members as a digital copy through the PJOG portal in the POGS website.

C. The Editorial Board

1. The Editorial Board shall:
 - a. Be composed of at least fifteen (15) members
 - 1) One (1) Editor-in-Chief
 - 2) Two (2) Associate Editors
 - 3) One (1) Business Manager
 - 4) At least twelve (12) Editorial Board Members
 - b. Identify and invite Peer Reviewers of submitted papers
 - c. Have Editorial Consultants comprising of the President and all the Past Editors-in-Chief
2. The Editor-in-Chief shall be appointed by the BOT from among the appointed members of the Editorial Board and shall serve a term of three (3) years, starting from the date of appointment and assumption of office, without prejudice to reappointment for a maximum of two (2) consecutive terms.
3. The members of the Editorial Board shall:
 - a. Be active Fellows, representing the Academic, Private and Government Sectors, and limited to two (2) representatives per institution.

- b. Have a background and experience in research, and have an updated Good Clinical Practice (GCP) certificate.
- c. Serve for a period of three (3) years, starting from the date of appointment and assumption to post, without prejudice to reappointment for a maximum of two (2) consecutive terms.

D. Duties and Responsibilities

1. The Editorial Board shall:
 - a. Review and upgrade editorial policies in accordance with research integrity principles and international standards for scholarly publications, subject to BOT approval.
 - b. Endeavor to publish an issue at least quarterly.
 - c. Screen and subject to peer review all OB-GYN papers submitted to the PJOG portal.
 - d. Ensure inclusion in reputable global research databases.
 - e. Prepare and submit to the Committee on Finance the annual budget of PJOG for inclusion in the annual budget of the POGS Foundation.
 - f. Ensure that authors acknowledge POGS-funding, if any, and obtain prior written consent from the POGS Foundation before publishing, reproducing or using the results.
2. The Editor-in-Chief shall:
 - a. Act as Chair of the Editorial Board and the Executive Officer of PJOG.
 - b. Execute and implement the policies established by the Editorial Board.
 - c. Write the editorials.
 - d. Edit the manuscripts and abstracts of articles.
 - e. Oversee day-to-day business of PJOG and supervise the office.
 - f. Prepare the annual budget.
3. The Associate Editors shall:
 - a. Assist the Editor-in-Chief in writing the editorials, and editing of the manuscripts and abstracts of articles.
 - b. Facilitate collection of materials for publication.
 - c. Perform such other tasks as may be assigned by the Editor-in-Chief and the Editorial Board.
4. The Editorial Consultants shall advise the Editorial Board and staff on the contents of PJOG.

E. Code of Ethics

PJOG shall follow the provisions of the POGS Foundation Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct 2025 Edition (Article IX The Physician and Clinical Research, Trials and Medical Publications).

II. THE POGS NEWSLETTER

A. Name of the Newsletter

The POGS Foundation shall have an official newsletter which shall be known as the POGS Newsletter.

B. Nature and Purpose

The POGS Newsletter shall:

1. Be the official publication of the POGS Foundation to disseminate its recent activities and important announcements.
2. Publish articles / write-ups and columns to maintain a good public image.
3. Disseminate important announcements and activities of the POGS Foundation.
4. Serve as a forum through which members may share updates, opinions and commentaries, subject to the approval by the Editor-in-Chief.
5. Serve as a medium through which subspecialty and affiliate societies, and international organizations may promote their activities and services, subject to the approval by the Editor-in-Chief.

C. Editorial Staff

1. The Editorial Staff shall be composed of at least five (5) members, including the PRO, who shall act as the Editor-in-Chief.
2. The members shall be recommended by the Editor-in-Chief and approved by the BOT.
3. The members shall be co-terminus with the term of the PRO.
4. The Editorial Staff shall:
 - a. Publish at least four (4) issues of the Newsletter annually.
 - b. Provide each member with a digital copy of every issue.
 - c. Document all the official functions of the POGS Foundation.

CHAPTER 7 REGIONAL DISTRICTS AND CHAPTERS

I. DEFINITION OF TERMS

A. Regional District –

1. The membership in different provinces and cities of the country shall be organized into Regional Districts based on geographic location for administrative and logistical purposes.
2. The BOT, upon the recommendation of the Regional District and in consultation with affected members, may create, modify, merge or dissolve Regional District/s based on defined criteria and operational needs.

B. Chapter – shall be composed of provinces, cities and municipalities under a Regional District and shall have a set of officers headed by a Chapter President.

C. Cluster – shall be composed of the different POGS-accredited training institutions in the NCR that are generally geographically adjacent to one another for ease of coordination, headed by the Cluster President.

II. ORGANIZATION OF REGION, CHAPTERS AND CLUSTERS

A. REGIONAL DISTRICT AND ITS COMPOSITIONS

The composition of the different Regional District (Regions) shall be as follows:

REGIONS	COMPOSITION
National Capital Region	National Capital Region (Metropolitan Manila) includes the following areas: 1. Cities: Caloocan, Las Piñas, Makati, Mandaluyong, Manila, Marikina, Muntinlupa, Paranaque, Pasay, Pasig, Quezon City, San Juan, Taguig and Valenzuela, Malabon, Navotas 2. Municipality: Pateros 3. Province: Rizal and includes the following CLUSTERS: 1. BAYCOG – Manila Adventist Medical Center, Manila Doctors Hospital, Mary Johnston Hospital, Manila Medical Center, Ospital ng Maynila Medical Center, Pasay City General Hospital, Perpetual Help Medical

	Center, UP-PGH, San Juan De Dios Hospital, Seamen's Hospital, Las Piñas General Hospital 2. PENTAMED Society – Cardinal Santos Medical Center, Victor R. Potenciano Medical Center, Ospital ng Makati, Our Lady of Lourdes Hospital, Rizal Medical Center, San Juan Medical Center, The Medical City, St. Luke's Medical Center Global City 3. CITIWIDE – AFP Medical Center, Amang Rodriguez Medical Center, Capitol Medical Center, Delos Santos Medical Center, Dr. Jesus Delgado Medical Center, East Avenue Medical Center, Fatima University Medical Center, MCU-FDTMF Hospital, Pasig City General Hospital, Quezon City General Hospital, Quirino Memorial Medical Center, St. Luke's Medical Center Quezon City, Dr. Jose N. Rodriguez Memorial Hospital, Valenzuela General Hospital, Veterans Memorial Medical Center, World Citi Medical Center, FEU-NRMF Medical Center, UERM-MMC 4. UNIVERSITY WIDE – Chinese General Hospital, Dr. Jose Fabella Memorial Hospital, Jose Reyes Medical Center, Metropolitan Hospital, Tondo Medical Center, UST Hospital and the following CHAPTERS: 5. Metro Rizal 6. CAMANAVA
Region I Northwestern Luzon	Abra, Benguet, Ilocos Norte, Ilocos Sur, La Union, Mountain Province, Pangasinan
Region II Northeastern Luzon	Apayao, Batanes, Cagayan, Ifugao, Isabela, Kalinga, Nueva Vizcaya, Quirino
Region III Central Luzon	Aurora, Bataan, Bulacan, Nueva Ecija, Pampanga, Tarlac, Zambales
Region IV Southern Tagalog	Batangas, Cavite, Laguna, Marinduque, Occidental Mindoro, Oriental Mindoro, Palawan, Quezon, Romblon
Region V Bicol	Albay, Camarines Norte, Camarines Sur, Catanduanes, Masbate, Sorsogon
Region VI Western Visayas	Panay Chapter: Aklan, Antique, Capiz, Guimaras, Iloilo Negros Occidental Chapter
Region VII Central Visayas	Bohol, Cebu, Negros Oriental (Dumaguete), Siquijor

Region VIII Eastern Visayas	Biliran, Leyte (Ormoc), Eastern Samar, Northern Samar, Southern Leyte, Western Samar
Region IX Western Mindanao	Basilan, Sulu, Tawi-tawi, Zamboanga del Norte, Zamboanga del Sur
Region X Northern Mindanao	CARAGA, Cagayan de Oro, Bukidnon, Iligan, Marawi, Ozamiz City, Camiguin, Gingoog, Oroquieta City
Region XI Southern Mindanao	ARMM, Bangsamoro, Agusan, Davao del Norte, Davao del Sur, Davao de Oro (former Oriental), South Cotabato, North Cotabato, Maguindanao, Sultan Kudarat, General Santos

B. CHAPTER

1. Organization

- a. A Chapter shall be established in a province or chartered city within a Regional District, upon petition of at least twenty percent (20%) active members in the locality, and approval by the BOT.
- b. Each Chapter shall be composed of at least twenty (20) active members in actual residence in the Regional District. Of the twenty (20), at least five (5) must be Fellows or Diplomates.

2. Objectives

The Chapter shall:

- a. Conform to the objectives of the POGS Foundation.
- b. Promote camaraderie and ethical practice among the members residing in the region.
- c. Encourage regional scientific programs and researches.
- d. Promote civic or socially-oriented activities among its members.

3. Obligations and Functions

a. The Chapter shall:

- 1) Follow and adhere to all policies, rules and regulations of the POGS Foundation, in conformity with Articles of Incorporation, Constitution, Bylaws, Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct 2025 Edition, and the Administrative Manual.
- 2) Carry out and administer the activities and affairs of the POGS Foundation within their respective geographical areas in coordination with the national office
- 3) Align with and implement the POGS Foundation programs and advocacies.
- 4) Encourage attendance to all POGS Foundation functions especially the Annual Convention and Business Meeting.
- 5) Assist the Regional Directors in screening all the candidates for membership in the POGS Foundation.
- 6) Promote the payment of the annual membership dues of the POGS Foundation.

- 7) Hold scientific meetings at least twice a year.
 - 8) Hold a Chapter Annual Business Meeting.
 - 9) Initiate locally relevant projects for the Chapter independent of POGS Foundation activities.
 - b. The POGS Foundation shall:
 - 1) Assist in the scientific meetings of the Chapters.
 - 2) Provide support to worthy projects of the Chapter whenever possible.
 - 3) Provide professional advice in medicolegal issues to Fellows and Diplomates when necessary.
 - 4) Encourage all obstetrician-gynecologists in the region to be members of the POGS Foundation.
 - 5) Act as an impartial body to arbitrate local problems or disputes upon request.
 - 6) Remit thirty percent (30%) of the collected annual dues to the Region / Chapter to cover operational expenses and other administrative requirements as well as other projects. For NCR, operational expenses comes directly from the POGS Foundation.
4. Dues, Fees and Donations
 - a. The POGS Foundation shall recognize the right of the Chapter to impose among its members any dues or fees consistent with its organizational needs over and above those obligations imposed by the POGS Foundation.
 - b. All donations and educational grants in support of Chapter activities shall belong to the Chapter except those donations solicited by and on behalf of the POGS Foundation. The Chapter shall make it explicit to the donor/s that such donations to the local chapters are exclusively for its purposes and not for the POGS Foundation.
5. Chapter Organization Procedures
 - a. The applicant shall submit to the BOT the following:
 - 1) A written petition of recognition
 - 2) Three (3) copies of their proposed Constitution and ByLaws
 - 3) List of elected officers
 - b. The BOT shall appoint an Ad Hoc Committee, to be headed by a member of the BOT, to study the merits of the petition.
 - c. The Ad Hoc Committee shall submit its official report to the BOT with its recommendations.
 - d. The BOT shall act on the petition guided by the official report and recommendation of the Ad Hoc Committee.
 - e. Upon approval, the Chapter shall be notified and officially recognized in appropriate ceremonies presided by the POGS Foundation President.
6. Use of POGS Foundation Logo and Letterhead

The Chapter, upon recognition, shall be given the privilege to create its own chapter logo provided that the guidelines as stated in the Chapter on Protocols (POGS Logo and Chapter Logo) shall be followed.

7. Dissolution of Chapter

The BOT may dissolve a Chapter for failure to comply with at least fifty percent (50%) of its obligations within two (2) years from recognition.

C. CLUSTERS

1. Organization

- a. Clusters only exist in the NCR.
- b. A cluster shall be composed of POGS-accredited training institutions that are generally geographically adjacent to one another.
- c. Each cluster shall be Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC)-accredited.
- d. Each cluster shall have a minimum of five (5) member hospitals.

2. Objectives

The Cluster shall:

- a. Conform to the objectives of the POGS Foundation.
- b. Promote camaraderie and ethical practice among the members of the POGS Foundation in the Cluster.
- c. Encourage scientific programs and researches.
- d. Promote civic or socially-oriented activities among its members.

3. Obligations and Functions

a. The Cluster shall:

- 1) Follow and adhere to all policies, rules and regulations of the POGS Foundation, in conformity with Articles of Incorporation, Constitution, Bylaws, Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct 2025 Edition, and Administrative Manual.
- 2) Carry out and administer the activities and affairs of the POGS Foundation within their respective geographical areas in coordination with the national office.
- 3) Align and implement with the national programs and advocacies.
- 4) Encourage attendance to all POGS Foundation functions especially the Annual Convention and Business Meeting.
- 5) Assist the NCR Regional Director in screening all the candidates for membership in the POGS Foundation.
- 6) Remind the payment of the annual membership dues of the POGS Foundation.
- 7) Hold scientific meetings at least twice a year.
- 8) Hold a Cluster Annual Business Meeting.

- 9) Initiate locally relevant projects for the Cluster independent of POGS Foundation activities
- b. The NCR Regional Director shall:
 - 1) Assist in the scientific meetings of the Cluster and Chapters.
 - 2) Provide support to worthy projects of the Cluster and Chapters whenever possible.
 - 3) Provide professional advice in medicolegal issues to Fellows and Diplomates of the Clusters and Chapters, when necessary.
 - 4) Encourage all obstetrician-gynecologists in the Clusters and Chapters to be members of the POGS Foundation.
 - 5) Arbitrate impartially with local problems or disputes upon request.
4. Dues, Fees and Donations
 - a. The POGS Foundation shall recognize the right of the Cluster to impose among its members any dues or fees consistent with its organizational needs over and above those obligations imposed by the POGS Foundation.
 - b. All donations and educational grants in support of Cluster activities shall belong to the Cluster except those donations solicited by and on behalf of the POGS Foundation. The Cluster shall make it explicit to the donor/s that such donations to the Cluster are exclusively for its purposes and not for the POGS Foundation.
5. Use of POGS Foundation Logo and Letterhead

The Cluster, upon recognition, shall be given the privilege to create its own cluster logo provided that the guidelines as stated in the chapter on Protocols (POGS Logo and Chapter Logo) shall be followed.
6. Dissolution of Cluster

The BOT may dissolve a Cluster for failure to comply with at least fifty percent (50%) of its obligations within two (2) years from recognition.

III. OFFICERS

A. Regional Director

1. Each Regional District shall be headed by a Regional Director with the following qualifications:
 - a. An active Fellow or Diplomate of at least five (5) years
 - b. Practicing the specialty in the region
2. Provisions
 - a. The Regional Director shall be appointed by the President with approval by the BOT.

- b. The Regional Director shall serve for a term of one (1) year, and may be reappointed to a maximum of three (3) years.
- c. In the absence of active Fellows or Diplomates in the region, the President, with the approval by the BOT, shall appoint other active members to act as the Regional Director.
- 3. Duties:
 - a. The Regional Director shall:
 - 1) Serve as the Liaison Officer between the BOT and the members of the region.
 - 2) Establish rapport and cooperation with the members.
 - 3) Implement the different activities of the POGS Foundation through the Chapter/Cluster officers.
 - 4) Serve as the COP of the region.
 - 5) Act as second endorser of candidates for induction as Fellows in the POGS Foundation.
 - 6) Serve as the regional coordinator of the CHAS by helping in the screening of applicants in the region.
 - 7) Coordinate with the various Standing Committees of the POGS Foundation in its various regional activities.
 - 8) Act as a Co-chair in the Midyear Scientific Convention held in their respective region.
 - 9) Submit midyear and annual performance and financial reports to the BOT, on the date as determined by the BOT.
 - 10) Be accountable for all funds and other resources entrusted by the POGS Foundation to the region.
 - b. All Regional Directors, except that of NCR, shall have the following additional duties and obligations:
 - 1) Coordinate and oversee the preparation of the residents for the in-service examination.
 - 2) Recommend applicants for Junior membership.
 - 3) Recommend applicants for Diplomate examination.
 - 4) Appoint Area Coordinator/s to assist in his/her different functions.

B. Area Coordinator

- 1. An Area Coordinator shall be appointed by the Regional Director as deemed necessary. He/She shall be an active Fellow, Diplomate or Junior Member.
- 2. Duties:

The Area Coordinator shall:

 - a. Serve as the Liaison Officer between the Chapter officers and the members of each province/Chapter.
 - b. Provide information to members on Chapter activities, venues and schedules.
 - c. Assist the Regional Director in coordinating and organizing activities and projects of the POGS Foundation and the Chapter on a provincial level.

C. Officers of the Chapter

1. Provisions

- a. The Chapter shall be governed by a President, a Vice President, a Secretary, a Treasurer, a PRO and other officers that may be deemed necessary, elected for such purpose by the members.
- b. Qualifications:
 - 1) The Officer shall be a Fellow or a Diplomate in good standing.
 - 2) Additional qualifications may be included, as determined by the Chapter.
- c. The actions of the officers of the Chapter shall be approved by the BOT.

2. The President shall:

- a. Implement in the region the different activities cascaded by the BOT and the different committees of the POGS Foundation with the guidance of the Regional Director.
- b. Initiate locally relevant projects for the Chapter.
- c. Coordinate with industry partners in the fulfillment of the different projects, programs and activities of the Chapter within the mandate of the Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct 2025 Edition.
- d. Create committees deemed necessary for his/her term of office.
- e. Establish rapport and cooperation with the different officers, coordinators and their members.
- f. Coordinate with the Regional Director regarding accountability for the funds provided by the POGS Foundation.
- g. Submit a midyear and annual accomplishment report to the Regional Director.

3. The Vice President shall:

- a. Assist the Chapter President in all activities.
- b. Act as the Officer-in-Charge in the absence of the Chapter President.
- c. Assume the role of Chapter President in case of the latter's disability, death or resignation for the unexpired term.
- d. Perform other duties assigned by the Chapter President or the Regional Director.

4. The Secretary shall:

- a. Be the custodian of all the records of the Chapter.
- b. Maintain membership registry and attendance records.
- c. Issue certificates of good standing to members as cleared by the Chapter President and the Regional Director.
- d. Prepare certificates issued by the Chapter.
- e. Perform other duties assigned by the Chapter President or the Regional Director.

5. The Treasurer shall:
 - a. Act as a custodian of the Chapter funds.
 - b. Keep full and accurate financial records of the Chapter including receipts, disbursements, assets, liabilities and general financial transactions of the Chapter.
 - c. Present an annual financial report to the members during the general assembly of the Chapter.
 - d. Perform other duties assigned by the Chapter President or the Regional Director.

6. The PRO shall:
 - a. Act as a liaison officer between the Chapter and the members.
 - b. Submit articles for the POGS newsletter.
 - c. Perform other duties assigned by the Chapter President or the Regional Director.

CHAPTER 8

SUBSPECIALTY AND AFFILIATE SOCIETIES

I. PRINCIPLES / CONCEPTS GOVERNING AFFILIATION TO THE POGS FOUNDATION:

- A. Foster spirit of cooperation and goodwill
- B. Promote relationships that are mutually beneficial
- C. Protect the interest of the general membership
- D. Recognize and acknowledge jointly the autonomy of both organizations
- E. Uphold honesty, openness and integrity

II. SUBSPECIALTY SOCIETY

- A. Subspecialty Society is a society with an accreditation board that utilizes credentialing based on training and examination given by the subspecialty board.
- B. A Subspecialty Society shall:
 - 1. Be a legitimate corporation, institution or organization that is duly registered with the SEC and recognized by pertinent government agencies.
 - 2. Have only POGS Fellows and Diplomates as members.
 - 3. Have an approved subspecialty training program and/or certifying exams.
 - 4. Adhere to the objectives of and maintain cooperation with the POGS Foundation.
- C. The Subspecialty Societies are:
 - 1. Philippine Society of Ultrasound in Obstetrics and Gynecology (PSUOG) – 1993
 - 2. Philippine Society for Reproductive Medicine (PSRM) – 1994
 - 3. Philippine Society for Cervical Pathology and Colposcopy (PSCPC) – 1995
 - 4. Philippine Society of Maternal and Fetal Medicine (PSMFM) – 1996
 - 5. Philippine Society for the Study of Trophoblastic Disease (PSSTD) – 2002
 - 6. Philippine Society for Gynecologic Endoscopy (PSGE) – 2004
 - 7. Philippine Society for Urogynecology and Reconstructive Pelvic Surgery (PSURPS) – 2008
 - 8. Society of Gynecologic Oncologists of the Philippines (SGOP) – 2008
 - 9. Philippine Infectious Disease Society for Obstetrics and Gynecology (PIDSOG) – 2018
 - 10. Other future subspecialty societies

III. AFFILIATE SOCIETY

- A. An Affiliate Society is a duly registered corporation, institution or organization that supports the POGS Foundation's objectives and projects.

- B. The Affiliate Society shall
 - 1. Be a legitimate corporation, institution or organization that is duly registered with the SEC and recognized by pertinent government agencies.
 - 2. Be distinct and separate from the subspecialty societies.
 - 3. Have POGS Fellows and Diplomates as members. Non-POGS members shall have special interest related to OB-GYN.
 - 4. Adhere to the objectives of and maintain cooperation with the POGS Foundation.
- C. The Affiliate Societies are:
 - 1. Perinatal Association of the Philippines (PAP) – 1991
 - 2. Philippine Society of Climacteric Medicine (PSCM) – 1992
 - 3. Asia Oceania Research Organization on Genital Infections and Neoplasia – Philippine Chapter (AOGIN) – 2014
 - 4. Pediatric and Adolescent Gynecology Society of the Philippines (PAGSPHIL) – 2015
 - 5. Aesthetic Gynecology Society of the Philippines, Inc. (AGSPI) – 2018
 - 6. Philippine Society for Fertility Preservation (PSFP) – 2021
 - 7. Society for Gynecologic Robotic Surgery in the Philippines (SGRSP) – 2026
 - 8. Other future component affiliate societies

IV. COMMITMENT TO THE POGS FOUNDATION

The Subspecialty and Affiliate Societies shall participate in the following activities of the POGS Foundation:

- A. Annual Convention
- B. CPG development
- C. CME
- D. Community service
- E. Collection and analysis of PNSS
- F. Patient safety policies
- G. Other activities requiring subspecialty and affiliate society services

V. BENEFITS OF SUBSPECIALTY AND AFFILIATE SOCIETIES

- A. Subsidized cost in the use and lease of POGS facilities
- B. Linkage with the POGS website
- C. Proper recognition in CPG development
- D. Other benefits or privileges not stated above but may be approved by the BOT, provided they are not in conflict with POGS Foundation policies

VI. REQUIREMENTS FOR APPLICATION

- A. Letter of intent
- B. Documentary requirements:
 - 1. SEC registration papers
 - 2. Constitution and Bylaws
 - 3. Officers and membership
 - 4. Activities
- C. A letter of notice shall be given to all the Subspecialty and Affiliate Societies regarding the application of a new society. The Subspecialty and Affiliate Societies shall be given two (2) weeks to respond. The BOT shall deliberate and decide on the application. The BOT resolution shall be final.

VII. GROUNDS FOR SEVERANCE

- A. The Subspecialty or Affiliate Society shall be subjected to inquiry and assessment by the POGS Foundation regarding ethical issues and conflicts of interest between the Foundation and the Subspecialty or Affiliate Society.
- B. The Subspecialty or Affiliate Society may apply for severance from the POGS Foundation.

CHAPTER 9 MEETINGS

I. COMMON PROVISIONS

- A. In all meetings of the BOT, PBOG, CREED, constitutional bodies or any of the committees, a majority of all the members shall constitute a quorum. A majority shall be defined as fifty percent (50%) of the total membership plus one (1).
- B. All meetings shall be governed by Robert's Rules of Order when these are not in conflict with the rules of the POGS Foundation.
- C. Minutes of meetings shall be taken by the Board Secretary if present, or whoever is designated, and these shall form part of the records of the POGS Foundation.
- D. Notices of meetings shall be sent reasonably ahead of time and shall contain the agenda for the meetings and the minutes of the previous meeting.
- E. Routine expenses incurred during the meeting shall be shouldered by the POGS Foundation with certain limitations as dictated by prudence and prevailing costs. The BOT is authorized to issue rules and regulations concerning special expenditures of the BOT.

II. ANNUAL CONVENTION

- A. The Annual Convention shall be held every 2nd week of November in the Principal Office (the city where the POGS Foundation is registered) of the POGS Foundation, as provided for in the Corporation Laws of the Philippines. Under special circumstances, the BOT may change the date and the venue of the Annual Convention.
- B. The Annual Convention shall have a scientific and business portion and shall be managed by the Organizing Committee on Annual Convention headed by the Vice President.
 - 1. Scientific Meeting

The scientific meeting shall include the following but not limited to:

 - a. Presentations of symposia
 - b. Scientific papers
 - c. Pre-congress workshops / lectures
 - d. Scientific exhibits
 - 2. Business Meeting
 - a. The POGS Foundation shall hold its Annual Business Meeting every 14th day of November during the Annual Convention.

- b. If the 14th day of November falls on a non-working day or is otherwise not feasible, the BOT may designate an alternative date, provided it falls within the month of November on the same calendar year.
- c. The agenda of the Business Meeting shall be as follows:
 - 1) Call to order
 - 2) Invocation
 - 3) Verification and declaration of quorum (Board Secretary)
 - 4) Reading and approval of the day's agenda
 - 5) Reading and final disposition of the minutes of the last Annual Business Meeting
 - 6) Report of the President
 - 7) Report of the Treasurer
 - 8) Amendments and resolutions to the Bylaws (Board Secretary and Chair of Committee on Amendments) (when applicable)
 - 9) Election (Chair of the COMELEC)
 - i. COMELEC Rules and Regulations
 - ii. Presentation of the Candidates
 - 10) Other Matters
 - 11) Adjournment
- d. All resolutions concerning policies approved in the Business Meeting shall form part of the standing rules of the [POGS Foundation](#) without previous notice.
- e. [In the Annual Business Meeting, the presence of fifty percent \(50%\) plus one \(1\) members registered in the Annual Convention shall constitute a quorum.](#)

III. MIDYEAR CONVENTION

- A. The Midyear Convention shall be held in the month of April or May, at such date and place determined by the BOT. The scientific program shall be prepared by the Committee on CME, in collaboration with the Region.
- B. In every decade celebration of the POGS Foundation, the Midyear Convention shall be held together with the anniversary celebration at the NCR every 6th of July and/or thereafter.

IV. SPECIAL MEETINGS

- A. The President may call a special meeting if deemed necessary. This is purely a business meeting to decide on matters requiring the vote of the general membership.
- B. The President is obliged to call a special meeting upon a written petition of at least fifty (50) Fellows in good standing.

- C. The Call for Special Meetings shall specify the time, place, format and purpose/s thereof, and no business other than that specified in the call shall be considered at any such meeting.
- D. Ten percent (10%) of active members in good standing shall constitute a quorum, except as otherwise provided for in the Bylaws.

V. BOARD MEETINGS

- A. The BOT shall meet monthly to exercise its corporate powers and duties.
- B. A Special EXECOM meeting shall be called by the President to resolve urgent issues that need immediate resolution
- C. A Special Board Meeting shall be called by the President when necessary or upon written petition of at least three (3) members of the BOT.
- D. The Joint BOT meeting shall be held every December to convene the Outgoing and Incoming officers of BOT for proper endorsements.
- E. The Joint BOT-RD meetings shall be held during the Midyear and Annual Conventions for midyear and year-end reports.
- F. All rules and regulations enacted by the BOT may be amended by at least two third (2/3) votes of the members of the BOT.

POLICY ON REVIEW OF OBSOLETE OR EXPIRED BOARD RESOLUTIONS

I. DEFINITION

1. A Board Resolution is a formal, written act and official declaration of the BOT, duly approved during a scheduled meeting or through an alternative lawful mode allowed by the By-laws. It serves as an authoritative record of decisions, policies or directives that have a continuing, binding or external legal effect on the POGS Foundation, its members and its operations.
2. Board resolutions shall be regularly reviewed to ensure relevance and enforceability. Those that are obsolete, expired or superseded shall be formally retired through BOT action, appropriately archived, and excluded from active governance references, while maintaining full traceability.

II. PURPOSE

This policy aims to:

1. Ensure the continued relevance, legality and effectiveness of Board resolutions.
2. Prevent reliance on outdated or conflicting directives.

3. Promote good governance, accountability and organizational clarity.
4. Maintain an accurate and authoritative record of active BOT actions.

III. SCOPE

This policy applies to:

1. All resolutions passed by the BOT, including policy, administrative, financial and strategic resolutions.
2. Standing resolutions, time-bound resolutions and one-time resolutions with continuing implications.

IV. CLASSIFICATIONS OF BOARD RESOLUTIONS

*as decided by the incumbent BOT

1. Active – A resolution that remains in force and applicable.
2. Expired – A resolution with a defined validity period that has lapsed.
3. Obsolete – A resolution that has been rendered irrelevant due to changes in law, policy, structure or circumstances.
4. Superseded – A resolution replaced by a newer BOT action.
5. Retired – A resolution formally declared no longer in effect by Board action.

V. MATTERS REQUIRING A FORMAL BOARD OF TRUSTEES RESOLUTION

A formal Board Resolution shall be required for any matter that meets one or more of the following criteria:

1. Policy-Making and Governance: Adoption, amendment or repeal of the Administrative Manual, codes of ethics, election rules, sponsorship guidelines or other policies of general application; issuance of interpretations or clarifications of the Constitution and ByLaws that establish precedent.
2. Membership Rights, Status, and Obligations: Matters affecting admission, reinstatement, discipline, suspension, expulsion or other changes in membership status; imposition or modification of dues, fees, assessments or financial obligations of members; rules affecting eligibility, privileges or obligations of members or officers.
3. Financial and Fiduciary Matters: Approval of annual budgets and material budget revisions; authorization of significant expenditures, contracts, sponsorship agreements or financial commitments; appointment of bank signatories, auditors or approval of financial controls and safeguards.
4. Legal, Regulatory and External Acts: Approval of amendments to the Articles of Incorporation or Constitution and Bylaws; authorization for filings with the SEC or other regulatory bodies; authority to represent the POGS Foundation in legal proceedings, negotiations or binding agreements; creation of task forces, committees, or bodies with delegated powers or defined mandates; delegation of significant authority to an Officer, committee or third party, including the grant of power of attorney or the authorization to sign documents on behalf of the BOT.
5. Precedent-Setting, Ethical, or High-Risk Matters: Decisions involving ethics, conflicts of interest or potential reputational risk; matters likely to be cited, enforced, audited, reviewed or questioned in the future; actions intended to remain effective beyond the term of the incumbent BOT.

VI. MATTERS THAT MAY BE REFLECTED SOLELY IN THE MINUTES

The following matters may be validly approved and documented through the official minutes of the meeting, without the need for a separate, formal resolution document:

1. Acceptance or notation of reports
2. Scheduling of meetings and internal timelines
3. Routine procedural or housekeeping matters
4. Expressions of appreciation, commendations or acknowledgments

5. Other non-precedent-setting matters with no material impact on policy, membership rights, finances or governance

VII. GUIDELINES FOR PERIODIC REVIEW AND RETIREMENT

1. Periodic Review

- a. The Board Secretary shall conduct a systematic review at least once every three (3) years, or more frequently as directed by the BOT.
- b. Special reviews may be initiated in response to:
 - 1) Regulatory or legal changes
 - 2) Accreditation findings
 - 3) Organizational restructuring
 - 4) Auditor / compliance recommendations

2. Identification of Resolutions for Review

Resolutions shall be flagged for review if they have:

- a. An explicit expiration date
- b. Already been fully implemented or completed
- c. Conflict with newer resolutions or current policies
- d. Refer to defunct programs, positions, structures or conditions; or are inconsistent with current laws, regulations or standards

3. Review and Evaluation Process

1. A consolidated Resolution Review Report shall be prepared, categorizing resolutions as to be:

- 1) Reaffirmed
- 2) Amended
- 3) Superseded
- 4) Retired

- b. The BOT shall submit its recommendation/s regarding the categorization of Board Resolutions to the Committee on Foundation Oversight. The report shall include justification for the action on each resolution.
- c. Final disposition will be made by the Committee on Foundation Oversight.
- d. The BOT shall adopt the final approval by the Committee on Foundation Oversight.

4. Board Action

- Obsolete or expired resolutions shall be retired only through formal BOT action, duly recorded in the minutes.
- Retired resolutions shall be clearly marked as such in the official resolution registry, with cross-references to any superseding resolutions, if applicable.

VIII. DOCUMENTATION AND RECORDS MANAGEMENT

1. All Board Resolutions shall be clearly worded, dated, and sequentially numbered, identifying the approving body and meeting date and certified by the Board Secretary or authorized officer. The Board Secretary shall maintain:
 - A master registry of Board Resolutions with clear status indicators (active, amended, superseded, retired) and should be color-coded.
 - An archive of retired resolutions, which shall remain accessible for audit, legal or historical reference. Hard copies should be kept for five (5) years. The rest are kept as digital copies.

2. The official Minutes of the Meeting shall be prepared by the Executive Officer and submitted to the Board Secretary for review. Following formal approval, the minutes shall be signed by the President and attested by the Board Secretary.

IX. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

1. The Committee on Foundation Oversight shall approve retirement, amendment or reaffirmation of resolutions.
2. The Board Secretary shall maintain records, initiate reviews, and document BOT actions.
3. The Committees shall provide inputs on operational relevance and implementation status.

X. EFFECTIVITY AND REVIEW OF THIS POLICY

This policy shall take effect upon the approval by the BOT and shall itself be reviewed every three (3) years or as necessary to ensure continued relevance and compliance.

VI. COMMITTEE MEETINGS

- A. All committees shall meet at least once a year. The Chair or any member may request for a special committee meeting.
- B. The meetings of each Committee shall be held at the POGS Building or online. It is advisable to submit to the Executive Officer the schedule of meetings at the earliest possible time to avoid conflicting schedules.
- C. The President shall be notified of these meetings in as much as he/she is an Ex-officio member of all Standing Committees.
- D. The President may be requested to attend all other meetings by the other entities of the organization (PBOG, COMELEC, Committee on Audit, CMAP, Committee on Nominations, Ad Hoc Committees). Compliance by the President is discretionary.

VII. REGION AND CHAPTER SCIENTIFIC MEETINGS

- A. The induction of the Regional Directors shall be presided by the President during the orientation of the BOT with Regional Directors which shall be held in January of each year.
- B. Each region shall organize and hold at least two (2) meetings a year. One (1) meeting shall be held during the induction of Chapter Officers and another meeting at the discretion of the Chapter.
- C. The Chapters are authorized to promulgate rules and regulations concerning attendance in these meetings.

CHAPTER 10 FINANCIAL MATTERS

I. GENERAL PROVISIONS

- A. The financial matters of the POGS Foundation shall be managed in a professional manner. The BOT exercises all the corporate powers pertaining thereto. The Treasurer shall be the custodian of the funds of the POGS Foundation and shall head the Committee on Finance. The Committee on Finance shall manage the funds of the POGS Foundation through financial planning and fiscal control.
- B. The POGS Foundation shall operate on a budget prepared for a calendar year beginning 1st day of January and ending on the 31st day of December. The Annual Financial Report shall be presented by the Treasurer during the Annual Business Meeting.
- C. The funds of the POGS Foundation shall mainly come from dues of its members. The annual dues shall be payable not later than the 1st day of the Annual Convention.
- D. Other sources of funds include:
 - 1. The fees and assessments of the members and other instrumentalities authorized by the BOT
The amount and terms of payment shall be approved by the BOT.
 - a. The application fee for Diplomate shall be payable upon application.
 - b. The initial membership fee for Junior and Affiliate Members shall be payable upon application and admission to the POGS Foundation.
 - c. MAP dues, journal subscription and other arrears for members shall be payable not later than the 1st day of the Annual Convention.
 - d. The registration fee for participation in the Annual Convention and Midyear Convention shall be approved by the BOT.
 - e. Additional assessments may be imposed by the BOT for the purpose of financing the POGS Foundation's projects.
 - 2. Interest coming from placements in banks
 - 3. Donations and grants, except funds coming from international and national development agencies and societies for specific services and projects
 - 4. Fundraising in any acceptable form to support a particular project

II. LEVELS OF APPROVAL ACCORDING TO AMOUNT

P1 – 5,000	-	Executive Officer
P5,001 – 100,000	-	President and Treasurer
P101,000 – 250,000	-	EXECOM

P251,000 – 499,000	-	BOT
P500,000+	-	BAC

III. FISCAL CONTROL

A. Budget

1. The Committee on Finance shall prepare and submit to the BOT a consolidated budget for the incoming year. This budget shall be approved by the BOT during the 1st quarter of said year. The budget of the preceding year shall remain in effect until the new budget is approved by the BOT.
2. Only appropriations approved by the BOT shall be funded by the POGS Foundation.
3. The annual budget may be amended by the BOT, provided that the variance is not more than fifteen percent (15%).
4. Re-alignment of budgeted funds shall be prohibited, unless in unforeseeable circumstances (e.g. force majeure), subject to the approval by the BOT. Unused balance of appropriations shall revert to the general funds of the POGS Foundation.
5. The BOT may authorize the President to approve / disburse a revolving fund per month, subject to audit.
6. The President, or any member of the BOT, shall not spend more than thirty percent (30%) of the current assets of the POGS Foundation without prior approval by the BOT.
7. The net income surplus of the POGS Foundation shall be for its sole benefit.
8. In case of dissolution, the remaining assets of the POGS Foundation shall be turned over to similar institutions.

B. Capital Expenditures

Capital expenditures in excess of twenty percent (20%) of the expected annual income of the POGS Foundation shall be separately appropriated and approved by the BOT, apart from the budget.

C. Contracts and Encumbrances

The BOT shall not enter into any contract or transaction which will encumber more than thirty percent (30%) of the current assets of the POGS Foundation without prior approval from two-thirds (2/3) of the general membership in the Annual Business Meeting.

D. External Audit

An external audit of all funds and properties of the POGS Foundation and its instrumentalities shall be made at the end of each calendar year by a certified public accountant or an accounting firm

which is specifically retained for this purpose, and the audited financial report shall be provided to the members annually.

E. Grants and Subsidies of the BOT, Regional Directors and Official Representatives of the POGS Foundation to International Meetings and Committees:

1. BOT

- a. The President shall be given a subsidy as official representative to FIGO or AOFOG Congress. This subsidy shall cover the following:
 - 1) Airfare: Premium Economy for flights less than 8 hours, and Business Class for flights exceeding or equal to 8 hours
 - 2) Accommodation: Single occupancy accommodations at the official convention hotel
 - 3) Daily allowance: A maximum of 100 US Dollars per day for the duration of convention. All expenses shall be supported by appropriate receipts and shall be fully liquidated within a month after the convention.
- b. The allocated subsidy may be reviewed and revised by the BOT as needed. Any revisions in subsidy shall take effect the year after the resolution has been passed.

2. Regional Directors

- a. Administrative Fund – The BOT shall allocate thirty percent (30%) of the paid annual dues by members from each region. This shall be reverted to the same region to fund operational and community service projects. This fund is subject to audit and must be liquidated by the Regional Director.
- b. Special Regional Fund (SRF)

GUIDELINES FOR SPECIAL REGIONAL FUND

Requirements:

1. The SRF can be used for any institutionalized POGS activities such as:
 - CME
 - Community Service
 - Research
 - PRIME
 - Reproductive Health Advocacies
 - Maternal and Perinatal Conferences
 - Any other POGS-related activity of the region, chapter, or cluster
2. The SRF can also be used for any other project with a written project proposal submitted to the Committee on Finance through the Treasurer for evaluation and approval by the BOT.
3. The proposal must be submitted for approval at least one (1) month prior to project implementation.
4. The accomplishment report for activities utilizing the SRF, containing all supporting documents following the policy-guidelines on liquidation, shall be submitted two (2) weeks from completion of said activities. The report must contain duly accomplished forms in conformance with the SEC requirements.

Mechanics / Implementation:

1. The BOT shall prepare an annual appropriation, included in the national budget, up to a maximum of two hundred thousand pesos (Php200,000) (subject to periodic indexation as approved by the BOT) for each region of POGS. Any expense beyond this amount may be requested in writing with relevant supplementary documents for approval by the BOT.
 2. The Regional Director shall submit the project proposal with a line-item budget through the Treasurer for deliberation and approval by the BOT.
 3. Upon approval, the Treasurer shall release the fund to the Regional Director within two (2) weeks. The Regional Director shall be responsible for the implementation of the project in his/her locality.
 4. All funds provided by the POGS Foundation are subject to audit.
 5. Approval of a subsequent request or grant shall be dependent on the full liquidation of a previous or existing grant.
 6. Accomplishment report is included in the quarterly and annual reports of the Regional Director.
- (Appendix III: Template for Application for SRF)

3. Committees

Each committee shall prepare a budget for its annual operations. It shall be submitted to the Committee on Finance for deliberation during the Budget Meeting for approval by the BOT.

4. Official Representative of the POGS Foundation to International Meetings

The Official Representative of the POGS Foundation to international meetings as approved by the BOT shall be given a travel subsidy, which shall be determined by the BOT.

5. Scientific Grant

Any Fellow, Diplomate, Fellow-in-Training or Resident-in-Training accepted as lecturer or presenter in any International Congress shall be provided a scientific grant subject to the approved guidelines of the POGS Foundation (Refer to Criteria and Guidelines for Outstanding Scientific Works). Other members with worthwhile scientific endeavors may apply for grants subject to the approval by the BOT.

UNIT RESPONSIBLE	PROCEDURE
Fellow, Diplomate, Fellow-in-Training, or Resident-in-Training	● Submits a letter to the BOT for international presentation assistance at least one (1) month before the start of the conference ● Attaches letter of invitation / acceptance of presentation ● Secures endorsement from the Chair of the POGS-accredited training institution (for Fellow-in-Training and Resident-in-Training)
Chair of Committee on Scientific Works	● Reviews documents and previous track record of applicants ● Recommends for approval to the BOT

Treasurer	• Refers approved documents to the cashier
Fellow, Diplomate, Fellow-in-Training, or Resident-in-Training	• Submits proof of presentation (digital picture, certificate of attendance or appreciation for presentation, etc.) within one (1) month from conclusion of international congress
Cashier	• Releases amount after submission of proof of attendance or participation

6. Other Funds

This pertains to other sources of funds allocated by the POGS Foundation or gained from any activity sponsored or approved by the BOT.

CHAPTER 11 AMENDMENTS

I. CONSTITUTION

- A. Any amendment to, or revision of the Constitution shall be proposed by a Constitutional Convention / Assembly, or by the Committee on Amendments and approved by the BOT. Proposed amendments shall have been sent to each member of the POGS Foundation sixty (60) days prior to the Annual Business Meeting.
- B. Any amendment to, or revision of the Constitution shall be valid when ratified by two-thirds (2/3) of all active members registered in the Annual Business Meeting, and shall take effect once approved by the SEC.
- C. Whenever any amendment to, or revision, of the Constitution is adopted, such amendment or revision shall be attached to the original Constitution in the office of the POGS Foundation and a copy, duly certified by a majority (fifty percent [50%] + one [1]) of the members of the BOT and countersigned by the Board Secretary shall be filed with the SEC for approval.

II. BYLAWS

- A. Any amendment to, or revision of, the Bylaws shall be proposed by a Constitutional Convention / Assembly, or by the Committee on Amendments as approved by the BOT. Proposed amendments shall have been sent to each member of the POGS Foundation sixty (60) days prior to the Annual Business Meeting.
- B. Any amendment to, or revision of, the Bylaws shall be valid when ratified by two thirds (2/3) of all active members registered in the Annual Business Meeting and shall take effect once approved by the SEC.
- C. Whenever any amendment to, or revision, of the Bylaws is adopted, such amendment or revision shall be attached to the original Bylaws in the office of the POGS Foundation and a copy, duly certified by a majority (fifty percent [50%] + one [1]) of the members of the BOT and countersigned by the Board Secretary shall be filed with the SEC for approval.

III. PROCESSING AND APPROVAL OF AMENDMENTS

- A. Processing and Levels of Approval of the Amendments of the Constitution and ByLaws
 - 1. Initiation and proposal by the Committee on Amendments
 - 2. Deliberation and legal consultation
 - 3. Approval by the BOT for ratification
 - 4. Ratification by the general membership during the Annual Business Meeting
 - 5. Submission to SEC for approval
 - 6. Issuance of SEC certificate
 - 7. Publication of the approved amendments in the POGS newsletter by the BOT
- B. Processing and Approval of Administrative Manual Amendments
 - 1. The President shall organize the Ad Hoc Committee for the Revision of Administrative Manual (ACRAM) every three (3) to five (5) years.
 - 2. The ACRAM shall:
 - a. Review all amendments of the Constitution and ByLaws and approved Board Resolutions after the last revision of the Administrative Manual.
 - b. Revise, edit, reformat and update the Administrative Manual (including the Employee Handbook).
 - c. Submit to the BOT for review.
 - 3. The Administrative Manual shall be amended by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the BOT provided that such amendments have been officially sent to all members of the BOT one (1) month prior to the meeting.

IV. TRANSITORY PROVISIONS

A. Incumbent Appointee

All incumbent appointees of the POGS Foundation, of its committees, and of its instrumentalities, shall continue to serve their unexpired terms, unless their positions shall have been abolished.

B. Other Matters

All other matters which may arise during the transitory period shall be decided upon by the BOT.

C. Repealing Provisions

All rules and regulations, policies and pronouncements, written or unwritten, should be consistent with the provisions of the Bylaws. In case of inconsistencies, the provisions of the Bylaws shall

prevail and the inconsistent provisions shall be repealed, if cannot be harmonized herewith, amended or modified accordingly.

DRAFT

CHAPTER 12 PROTOCOLS

SUBCHAPTER I

I. POGS FOUNDATION LOGO



The POGS Foundation Logo consists of an outer green circle on a white background. On the outer circle is the name of the POGS Foundation. The word Manila and the year 1946, which was where and when the POGS Foundation was founded, is written at the bottom of the circle, separated from the name of the POGS Foundation by dots on each side. In the center is a white stylized uterus on a green background, containing a smaller green circle which represents the product of conception. The circle was chosen because it is a symbol of perfection.

The Logo imparts a visual identity to our Foundation and represents what we are and what we intend to achieve.

The Logo was presented to the POGS Foundation in the Annual Convention of November 24-26, 1978, and has been the Foundation's emblem ever since.

The Hex code for the Green color on the LOGO is #3B8645 (R: 59, G: 134, B: 69). The font used for the lettering is Helvetica Condensed Bold.

Reference: Abad RS. The Birth of a Logo. Phil J Obstet Gynecol, 3:11-12;1979.

II. POGS FOUNDATION BANNER



The POGS Foundation Banner is of green satin fabric, measuring 24 x 39 inches. There is a yellow border at the top measuring 24 x 1.5 inches. At the center of the banner is a yellow circle that is 19 inches in diameter. The POGS logo, the stylized uterus and letterings, are imprinted in green on the yellow circle.

III. POGS FOUNDATION FLAG



The POGS Foundation Flag is of green satin fabric, measuring 36 x 60 inches. It is bordered on three (3) sides by a yellow piping 1.5 inches in width of the same fabric as the flag itself. On one side of the flag is a fold for the flagpole. The POGS Foundation Logo is printed at the center of the flag, in the same color and style as the POGS Foundation Banner.

IV. POGS FOUNDATION MACE



The head of the Mace is the shape of an inverted triangle, an ancient symbol for the feminine energy and the aspect of creation. It is also the symbol of the supreme source of the universe and signifies intense spiritual aspiration. The vine wrapped around the staff is reminiscent of the serpent-entwined rod wielded by the Greek god Asclepius, a deity associated with healing and medicine. The vine also symbolizes life and the POGS Foundation's aim to continue updating and innovating to better serve our flock. The five (5) - petalled flower represents the five (5) core values of the POGS Foundation namely integrity, competence, accountability, compassion and innovation. It is placed at the base of the Mace to symbolize that the POGS Foundation stands on its core values. The seed represents conception and fertility, not only it represents conception of life, but also conception of ideas and knowledge. The dynamic lines on the triangle represents fire. It symbolizes the flame that is our desire to do better and to be of greater service to our patients which will never falter.

The Mace was designed by Mark Q. Antonio, MD, FPOGS, FSGOP, FPSCPC. It was approved by the BOT last April 2021, and was first used on November 2021 during the POGS Midyear Convention.

The Board Secretary is the ceremonial custodian of the Mace. During a processional, the Board Secretary enters first carrying the Mace with left hand extended to hold or support the lower end and with the right hand crossing his/her chest to hold the middle part of the staff with palm facing the chest.

The top of the Mace with the POGS Foundation Logo shall be higher than the head of the bearer. The Mace is then affixed upright on its stand.

The Mace is laid on its cradle during recess, suspensions, or endings of proceedings.

During the recessional, the Board Secretary leaves the venue carrying the Mace ahead of the President and other members of the BOT.

A smaller version of the Mace is crafted for out-of-town functions of the POGS Foundation with the following dimensions.



V. PRESIDENTIAL MEDALLION



The Presidential Medallion is made of metal and bears the image of the POGS Foundation logo. The chain of the Medallion also bears the image of the POGS logo. The outgoing President turns over the Medallion to the incoming President during the closing ceremonies of the Annual Convention. The Medallion is also worn by the Past Presidents during processions and other official POGS Foundation programs.

SCRIPT FOR THE TURNOVER OF PRESIDENTIAL MEDALLION

This is the Presidential Medallion. It is the seal of the President that symbolizes the ties that bind us to those who planted the seeds of this organization.

[OUTGOING to turn over the medallion to INCOMING]

VI. PRESIDENTIAL PIN



The Presidential Pin bears the POGS Foundation logo in the middle with the word "President" above and the year of the presidency below. The pin is presented to the incoming President during the Closing Ceremonies of the Annual Convention and is affixed by a relative to the left side of the President's outfit.

SCRIPT FOR THE PRESENTATION OF THE PRESIDENTIAL PIN

This is the Presidential Pin. It symbolizes the pride and achievement of an individual person. It is a form of one's worth and importance. At this point, I would like to ask Family of Dr. _____ to do the honor of pinning.

[A member of the family of INCOMING will come to the front to do the pinning]

VII. PRESIDENTIAL GAVEL



A. Description

1. The Presidential Gavel is a traditional hardwood percussion instrument used by the President to signal authority, maintain parliamentary order, and mark key procedural events.
2. Component Specifications
 - a. The Gavel Head is a cylindrical or barrel-shaped body, typically featuring symmetrical turned accents (grooves or bands) near each striking face, with flat or slightly convex circular ends designed for high-impact point contact.
 - b. The Handle is a contoured shaft which tapers towards the connection to the gavel head.
 - c. The Sound Block is the circular base which features a flat center contact area and is fitted with felt backing on the bottom to protect resting surfaces, prevent slippage and optimize acoustic resonance upon impact.

B. Uses of the Gavel and Sound Block

1. During the Leadership Turnover Ceremony (Passing of the Gavel)
2. Parliamentary Procedure and Governance
 - a. Calling Meetings to Order: The Presiding Officer (President or Board Chair) uses a single strike of the gavel to open official Business Meetings, Board Meetings, and during the Annual Business Meeting.
 - b. Maintaining Decorum: During debated policy sessions, resolution votes or scientific committee deliberations, the gavel is struck to command attention, restore order or signal the end of a debate period.
 - c. Adjournment and Rulings: A final strike officially closes a business session, seals a voted resolution, or adjourns the convention.
3. Ceremonial Opening and Closing of Conventions
 - a. Opening Plenary Sessions: The Annual and Midyear Conventions are opened with a formal gavel strike to officially commence the scientific sessions and plenary lectures.
 - b. Induction of New Officers and Fellows: During induction or convocation ceremonies, the gavel is used to formalize the acceptance of new Diplomates, Fellows, or newly elected officers into the POGS Foundation.

SCRIPT FOR THE PASSING OF THE GAVEL

By the name of the Philippine Obstetrical and Gynecological Society, I, Dr. _____, President for the year _____, do hereby relinquish and turn over this Gavel to you as symbol of authority. Wield it unflinchingly, but righteously; with courage and humility; with determination, but with compassion and understanding, and as you accept this gavel and the authority that goes with it, may God help you with all your undertakings.

[OUT-GOING President to bang only once the gavel before turning it over to the President-elect]

I, Dr. _____, President for the year _____, do hereby accept this Gavel, as the symbol of power and authority, with the tenets expressed in the POGS Mission, Vision and Core Values as my guide and with the blessings of Almighty.

It is my covenant to wield this gavel unflinchingly BUT righteously; with courage and humility; with determination but with compassion and understanding. So be it.

[IN-COMING President to bang the gavel 2x]

VIII. POGS FOUNDATION HYMN

- A. The POGS Foundation Hymn shall be sung in all official functions of the Foundation. It shall be sung after the National Anthem and PMA Hymn.

“The Obstetrician’s Prayer”
(My Humble Hands, Lord)

Date of composition: 2005

Composer: Fidel Doroteo Dennis P. Flores III, MD

Collaborator: Editha L. Flores, MD

Originally sung by: Editha L. Flores, MD

Here are my humble hands, Lord
Chosen to receive your creation
Here is my open mind, Lord
Learning hard to master all
I am your instrument, Lord
Hold me as I bring forth a life
Sharpen my mind with knowledge
To maintain my standards high

REFRAIN:

Keep me committed to service
Advancing the art of my craft
To foster women’s advocacy
And the welfare of your flock
Fill my heart with compassion
Bless my soul with power to give
Grant me the dedication
To uphold the things I believe

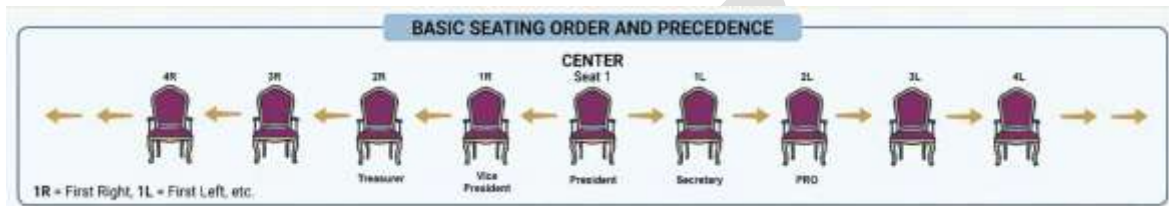
REPEAT REFRAIN TWICE

...to foster women’s advocacy and the welfare of your flock

SUBCHAPTER II GENERAL PRINCIPLES OF PROTOCOL

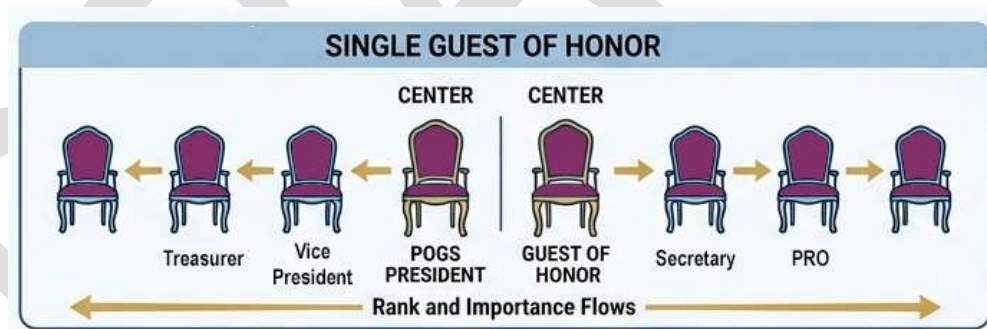
I. SEATING ARRANGEMENT

The most important seat is the center and the next is the first seat to the right (1R) followed by the first seat to the left (1L), and so on, and so forth.



A. Guest of Honor

The Guest of Honor and the President shall occupy the centermost position on the stage or presidential table. The Host is usually to the right of the Guest of Honor.



B. Office / Rank

The seating arrangement shall generally be based on the office or the rank of the people involved, except in special circumstances. High-ranking government officials or PMA officers who are present may be invited to join the presidential table or the stage, but the pre-arranged seating shall not be disrupted. They shall occupy empty seats at either side of the table or additional chairs shall be provided.

C. Occasional

In some instances, the occasion dictates the order of seating, as in scientific meetings where the Guest of Honor occupies the important seat at the presidential table or stage. If there is more than one (1) Guest of Honor, the President or the Regional Director or the Host Chapter President occupies the central position. During an Induction Ceremony, the Guest of Honor and the Inducting Officer, together with the incoming and outgoing officers, are in the main presidential table.

II. INDUCTION OF OFFICERS

It is required that the officers formally take their Oath of Office, be it at the local or national level.

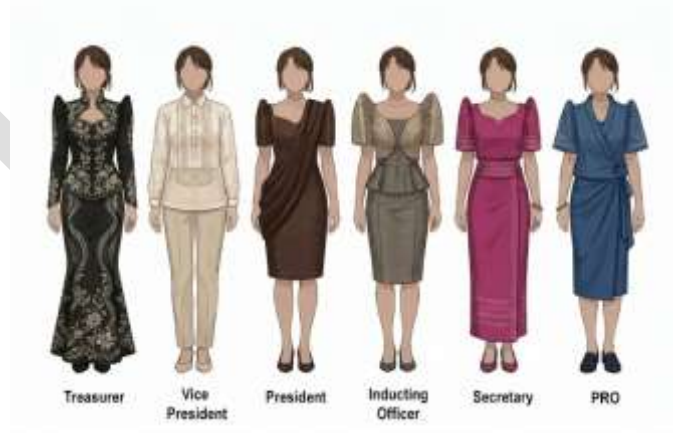
A. National Officers

1. Oath of Office

The Oath of Office shall be administered by a prominent person personally chosen by the President-Elect. The Guest of Honor and the Inducting Officer may be one and the same person.

2. Induction of the BOT

- a. The members of the BOT shall be called in alphabetical order.
- b. The officers of the POGS Foundation shall be called in the following order: PRO, Treasurer, Board Secretary, Vice President, President.
- c. The Inducting Officer shall stand next to the microphone, followed by the President, Vice President, Board Secretary, Treasurer, PRO, and the rest of the BOT.
- d. During the photo op, the standing arrangement shall follow this order:



3. Turn Over Ceremony
 - a. The outgoing President shall strike the Presidential gavel once, and shall turn over the Presidential gavel to the newly inducted President.
 - b. The incoming President shall strike the Presidential gavel twice.
 - b. The outgoing President shall bestow the Presidential Medallion to the newly inducted President.
 - c. A family member shall affix the Presidential Pin to the left side of the President's outfit.
4. The induction of the Regional Directors shall be during the joint BOT and Regional Directors meeting at the start of the year.

B. Local Chapters

The newly elected local Chapter Officers shall be inducted by the President or his/her designated Inducting Officer.

III. OATH OF OFFICE

The Oath of Office shall be signed by all elected officers and BOT and kept in the official files of the POGS Foundation.

A. BOT

I, _____ of POGS, having been elected to the position of TRUSTEE, hereby solemnly swear that I will faithfully discharge to the best of my ability the duties of my position, that I will support and defend the Constitution and By-Laws of the PHILIPPINE OBSTETRICAL AND GYNECOLOGICAL SOCIETY (Foundation), INC., that I shall embrace and embody, at all times, its core values, namely: Integrity, Competence, Accountability, Compassion and Innovation; and that I impose these obligations upon myself voluntarily without mental reservation or purpose of evasion.

SO HELP ME GOD.

Signature

Subscribed and sworn to before me this ____th day of November in the year of our Lord, Two Thousand ____, at the City of _____ Philippines.

Community Tax Certificate No.: _____

Issued at: _____

Date: _____

Oath. BOT 20____

B. Regional Director

I, _____, having been elected to the position of _____, do hereby solemnly swear that I will faithfully discharge to the best of my ability the duties of my position, that I will support and defend the Constitution and By-Laws of the PHILIPPINE OBSTETRICAL AND GYNECOLOGICAL SOCIETY (Foundation), INC., Region __, _____ Chapter, that I shall embrace and embody, at all times, its core values, namely: Integrity, Competence, Accountability, Compassion and Innovation, and that I impose these obligations upon myself voluntarily without mental reservation or purpose of evasion.

SO HELP ME GOD.

Signature

Subscribed and sworn to before me this ____th day of _____ in the year of our Lord, Two thousand ____ at the City of _____ Philippines.

Administering Officer

Community Tax Certificate No.: _____

Issued at: _____

Date: _____

Oath. Region 20____

IV. PROCESSIONAL AND RECESSIONAL

A. Processional

The lower-ranking officers shall enter first, followed by the higher-ranking officers.

B. Recessional

The higher-ranking officers shall exit first, followed by the lower-ranking officers.

V. ORDER OF REFERENCE OR ACKNOWLEDGEMENT DURING A CEREMONY

- A. The Host/Master of Ceremonies or another designated individual shall introduce the personages in the presidential table.
- B. The cardinal rule in protocol shall be in observance of the Order of Precedence. The first one to be introduced shall be the President, followed by the Guest of Honor, and the next in rank down the line.
- C. The Guest of Honor shall be introduced in a more detailed manner. Officials and guests shall stand to be recognized when their names are called.
- D. In order not to disturb the program and to instill discipline among the officers and members, the Host/Master of Ceremonies shall NOT give due recognition and importance to those who are late.

Note: In ceremonies where there is a processional, the Guest of Honor and other dignitaries shall no longer be recognized separately in the program since they have been recognized in the processional.

VI. COURTESY TITLE DISTINCTIONS

A. Government Officials

- 1. His/Her Excellency – applies to the President of the Republic, a foreign Chief of State, foreign cabinet officer, foreign ambassador or other foreign high officials.
- 2. The Honorable – the preferred title used in addressing most high-ranking Filipino officials in office or retirees, cabinet officials or those of equivalent rank. The title is also accorded to foreign diplomats, or those of equivalent rank.

B. National Scientist / Artists

The Honorable – the preferred salutation used in addressing National Scientists / Artists followed by their full title then their full name.

C. Academic Titles

Types of academic titles:

- 1. Doctor – medical degree (MD) or doctorate in philosophy (PhD)
- 2. Professor – academic position in schools or universities
 - a. If the holder of a doctoral degree is also a Professor, he/she may choose to be addressed as “Professor” rather than “Doctor”.

- b. A President, Chancellor, Dean or Professor with a doctoral degree is usually addressed as "Doctor".
- c. Those without doctoral or professorial positions shall be addressed as "Mr" or "Ms".

VII. MEETINGS

A. Monthly BOT Meetings

The monthly BOT meetings shall be conducted in the following order:

- 1. Call to order
- 2. Declaration of quorum
- 3. Reading and approval of the agenda
- 4. Approval and adoption of the minutes of the previous meeting
- 5. Business arising from the minutes of the previous meeting
- 6. EXECOM Reports
 - a. President
 - b. Vice President
 - c. Secretary
 - d. Treasurer
 - e. PRO
- 7. Members of the BOT reports
- 8. Other matters
- 9. Date of next meeting
- 10. Closing prayer
- 11. Adjournment

B. Special BOT Meetings

- 1. The President shall preside over the Special BOT meetings.
- 2. The agenda of the meetings shall be limited to one (1) topic.

C. Annual Business Meetings

- 1. The conduct of the Annual Business Meeting shall follow the provisions set forth in Chapter 9, Section II.
- 2. The Board Secretary shall assist the Presiding Officer during these meetings.

D. Committee Meetings

- 1. The Chair of the Committee shall preside over the meeting.

2. The agenda for the meeting shall depend on the business for which the meeting was called.

VIII. ANNUAL CONVENTION

A. Opening Ceremonies and Induction of Diplomates

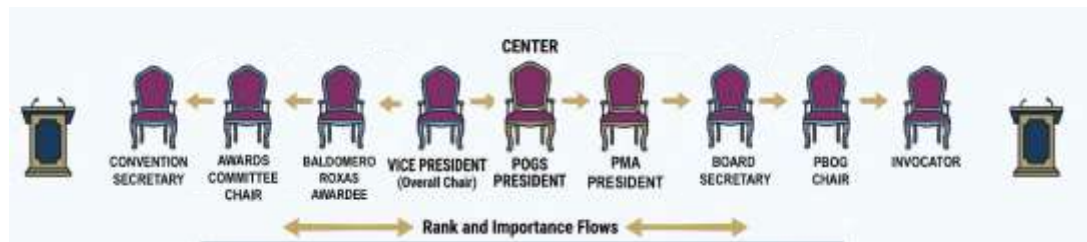
1. Processional

- a. The order of entrance shall be:
 - 1) Board Secretary (with Ceremonial Mace)
 - 2) Past Presidents (in academic gowns, in the order of the year of presidency)
 - 3) Subspecialty and Affiliate Society Presidents
 - 4) Distinguished Guests
 - 5) PBOG
 - 6) CREED Chair
 - 7) Regional Directors
 - 8) Awardees
 - 9) Members of the BOT, followed by the PRO, Treasurer, Board Secretary, Vice President
 - 10) Keynote Speaker
 - 11) PMA President
 - 12) President
- b. In case of multiple positions or awards, the person shall march donning the highest position or the award.
- c. There shall be a Marshall designated by the Chair of the Subcommittee on PATS.
- d. The Convention Secretary acts as the Host/Master of Ceremonies who shall introduce the participants of the processional.

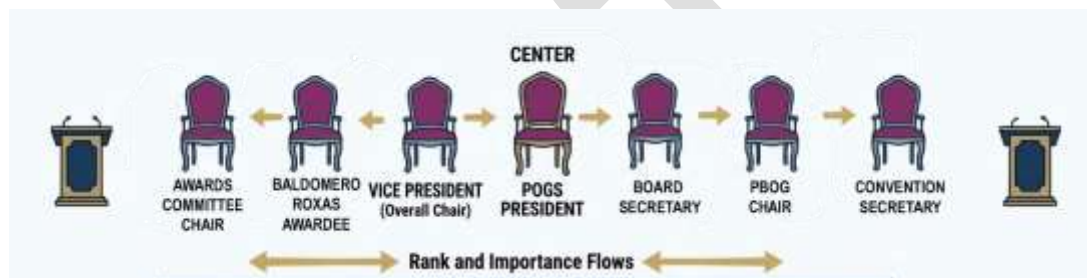
2. Seating Arrangements

- a. The President shall sit at the center of the most prominent table, usually on a dais.
- b. The Guest of Honor shall sit to the immediate left of the President.
- c. The Vice President, who is the Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee, shall sit to the immediate right of the President.
- d. The Board Secretary shall sit next to the Convention Secretary.
- e. Other ranking guests shall sit to the left of the Overall Chair and to the right of the Guest of Honor.
- f. Other honored guests or those who will be called on to speak shall be assigned the other seats.
- g. The Master of Ceremonies shall be seated nearest the rostrum.
- h. The seating arrangements shall be indicated by the name card prepared by the Subcommittee on PATS.

Seating arrangement if the PMA President is in attendance:



Seating arrangement when without the PMA President:



3. Program
 - a. Entrance of Colors
 - b. Invocation (by the Immediate Past President or a designated guest cleric or lay leader, limited to three [3] minutes)
 - c. Philippine National Anthem
 - d. PMA Hymn
 - e. POGS Foundation Hymn
 - f. Official Opening of the Convention by the President with the double striking of the gavel
 - g. Welcome Address by the Overall Chair of the Annual Convention
 - h. Introduction of the Awardees (video recording limited to five [5] minutes)
 - i. Presentation and Conferment of Awardees.
 - 1) The awards include:
 - i. Dr. Constantino P. Manahan Young Researcher Award
 - ii. Dr. Honoria D. Acosta-Sison Award of Merit for Research
 - iii. Dr. Ramon M. Lopez Award of Merit for Community Service
 - iv. Dr. Julita R. Jalbuena Award of Excellence in Clinical Practice
 - v. Dr. Baldomero L. Roxas Memorial Lecturer and Awardee for Academic Distinction
 - 2) The pictures of the persons for whom the awards were named after should be on stage during the presentation and conferment of the awardees.

- 3) The citation shall be read by the Board Secretary.
- 4) The awards shall be presented by the President, assisted by the Chair of the Committee on Awards.
- 5) The arrangement during the photo op shall be as follows:



- j. Presentation of PBOG Members and Diplomates
 - 1) The Host/Master of Ceremonies shall call on the PBOG Chair.
 - 2) The PBOG Chair shall call the roll by presenting the PBOG Secretary, followed by the members of the PBOG in the order of year level.
 - 3) The PBOG Secretary shall call the roll of diplomates for induction.
 - 4) The PBOG Chair shall distribute the Diplomate pin to each inductee.
 - 5) The President shall distribute the Diploma to each inductee.
 - 6) The PBOG Chair shall endorse the inductees to the President.
 - 7) The President shall accept the endorsement and subsequently conducts the induction.
- k. Recessional – shall be in the reverse order of the processional

B. Scientific Professorial Lecture

The Professorial Lecturer shall be introduced preferably by a person acquainted with him/her or by the Chair of the Scientific Program Committee, or by the Overall Chair of the Annual Convention.

C. Closing Ceremonies and Investiture of Fellows

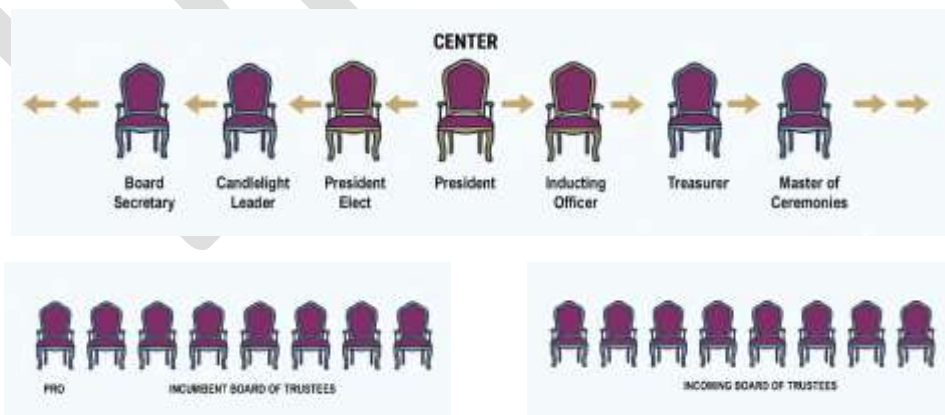
The Closing Ceremonies shall be held during the last day of the Annual Convention and shall be presided over by the President.

1. Processional

- a. The order of entrance shall be:
 - 1) Chair of the Subcommittee on Program and Invitation
 - 2) Fellows
 - 3) Candlelight Leader
 - 4) Members of the Organizing Committee
 - 5) Incoming Members of the BOT
 - 6) Incumbent Members of the BOT
 - 7) Officers (PRO, Treasurer, Secretary, Vice President)
 - 8) Guest of Honor and Inducting Officer
 - 9) President
- b. There shall be a Marshall designated by the Chair of the Subcommittee on PATS.
- c. The Chair of the Subcommittee on Programs and Invitations shall be the Host/Master of Ceremonies who shall introduce the participants of the processional.

2. Seating Arrangement

- a. The President shall be seated at the center of the table.
- b. The President-Elect shall be seated to the right of the President.
- c. The Inducting Officer shall be seated to the left of the President.
- d. The Board Secretary shall be seated to the right of the President-Elect.
- e. The Treasurer shall be seated to the left of the Inducting Officer.
- f. The rest of the BOT shall be seated accordingly at the presidential table.
- g. The presidential table shall be located on a stage or dais.
- h. The incoming BOT shall be seated at a table below and in front of the presidential table.
- i. The seating arrangement shall be indicated by name cards prepared by the Subcommittee on PATS.



3. Program
 - a. Invocation (by the Immediate Past President or a designated guest cleric or lay leader, limited to three [3] minutes)
 - b. National Anthem
 - c. POGS Foundation Hymn
 - d. Valedictory Address by the President
 - e. Awarding of Presidential Plaque of Recognition by the President-Elect and Board Secretary
 - f. Introduction of the Guest of Honor / Inducting Officer by the Host / Master of Ceremonies or designated person
 - g. Keynote Address by the Guest of Honor / Inducting Officer
 - h. Induction of New Officers and members of the BOT by the Guest of Honor / Inducting Officer
 - i. Awarding of the Plaque / Certificate of Recognition to the Guest of Honor / Inducting Officer by the President, President-Elect and Board Secretary
 - j. Presidential Turnover
 - 1) Gavel
 - 2) Presidential Medallion
 - 3) Presidential Pin
 - k. Inaugural Address by the President-Elect
 - l. Presentation of New Fellows by the Chair of the Committee on Credentials and Membership
 - 1) Candlelight Ceremonies
 - 2) Endorsement of new Fellows to the President by the Board Secretary
 - 3) Acceptance, induction and administration of oath to the Fellows by the President and the Candlelight Leader
 - 4) Awarding of Certificate of Fellowship
 - m. Closing Remarks by the Vice President-Elect
 - n. Exit of Colors
 - o. Recessional

IX. MIDYEAR CONVENTION

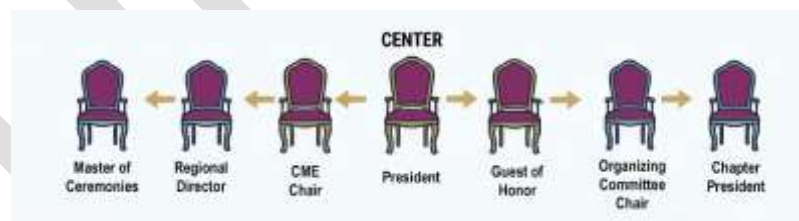
A. Opening Ceremonies

1. Processional
 - a. The order of entrance shall be:
 - 1) Past Presidents of the Chapter
 - 2) Past Regional Directors
 - 3) Organizing Committee Chairs

- 4) Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee
 - 5) Regional Officers
 - 6) Chapter President of the Host Region
 - 7) Regional Directors
 - 8) Regional Director of the Host Region
 - 9) Members of the BOT, Officers of the BOT (PRO, Treasurer, Secretary, Vice President)
 - 10) Keynote Speaker (if any)
 - 11) President
- b. The Midyear Convention Secretary shall be the Host / Master of Ceremonies who shall introduce the participants of the processional.
 - c. There shall be a Marshall designated by the Chair of the Subcommittee on PATS.

2. Seating Arrangements

- a. The President shall sit at the center of the presidential table.
- b. The Guest of Honor / Keynote Speaker shall sit to the immediate right of the President.
- c. The Chair of the Committee on CME and Midyear Convention shall sit to the immediate left of the President.
- d. The Regional Director shall sit to the right of the Guest of Honor / Keynote Speaker.
- e. The Overall Chair of the Midyear Organizing Committee shall sit to the left of the Chair of the Committee on CME and Midyear Convention.
- f. Other honored guests or those who will be called on to speak shall be assigned the other seats.
- g. The Master of Ceremonies shall be seated nearest to the rostrum.
- h. The seating arrangement shall be indicated by name cards prepared by the Subcommittee on PATS.



3. Program

- a. Processional
- b. Entrance of Colors
- c. Invocation (limited to three [3] minutes)
- d. Philippine National Anthem
- e. PMA Hymn
- f. POGS Foundation Hymn
- g. Dinner

- h. Message from the Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee of the Midyear Convention
- i. Message from the Regional Director
- j. Message from the Chair of CME and Midyear Convention
- k. Formal Opening of the Midyear Convention and Scientific Program by the President
- l. Introduction of the Keynote Speaker by the Regional Director
- m. Keynote Address (if any)
- n. Presentation of Certificate / Plaque of Appreciation by the President, assisted by the Board Secretary, Chair of CME and Midyear Convention, Regional Director and Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee of the Midyear Convention
- o. Closing Remarks by the POGS Vice President
- p. Recessional

B. Closing Ceremonies Program

- 1. Presentation of the Highlights of the Midyear Convention
- 2. Message from the President
- 3. Message from the Chair of the Committee on CME and Midyear Convention
- 4. Message from the Regional Director
- 5. Message from the Overall Chair of the Midyear Organizing Committee
- 6. Awarding of Plaque of Appreciation to the Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee of the Midyear Convention
- 7. Turnover Ceremonies
- 8. Acceptance Message and Invitation to the Next Midyear Convention
- 9. Closing Remarks by the Vice President
- 10. Exit of Colors
- 11. Recessional

X. POGS FOUNDATION DAY

A. The PRO shall be in charge of the Foundation Day.

B. Program

- 1. Eucharistic Celebration
- 2. National Anthem
- 3. PMA Hymn
- 4. POGS Foundation Hymn
- 5. Welcome Address by the President
- 6. Acknowledgement of Guests by the Board Secretary
- 7. Dinner
- 8. Recognition of Past Presidents, PBOG Chairs and CREED Chairs
- 9. Service Awards of the Employees, if any

10. Toast to the Foundation by the Vice President
11. Response from designated Past President
12. Closing Remarks
13. Fellowship

XI. PLAQUES / CERTIFICATES GIVEN BY THE POGS FOUNDATION

- A. For the Annual Convention, the signatories of the plaques / certificate shall be the:
 1. President
 2. Vice President and Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee
 3. Board Secretary
 4. Convention Secretary
- B. For the Annual Convention, the signatories of the Certificates of Appreciation for the speakers shall be the:
 1. President
 2. Vice President and Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee
 3. Board Secretary
 4. Convention Secretary
 5. Chair, Subcommittee on Scientific Program
- C. For the Annual Convention, the signatories of the Certificates of Attendance for the Delegates shall be the:
 1. President
 2. Vice President and Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee
 3. Board Secretary
 4. Convention Secretary
 5. Chair, Subcommittee on Scientific Program
- D. For the Annual Convention, the signatories for the Certificate of Appreciation for Pharmaceutical Sponsors shall be:
 1. President
 2. Vice President and Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee
 3. Board Secretary
 4. Convention Secretary
 5. Chair, Subcommittee on Ways and Means

- E. For the Annual Convention, the signatories for the Certificate of Appreciation for the Organizing Committee Chairs and Co-chairs shall be:
1. President
 2. Vice President and Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee
 3. Board Secretary
 4. Convention Secretary
- F. For the Midyear Convention, the signatories of the Certificate of Attendance shall be the:
1. President
 2. Board Secretary
 3. Chair of Committee on CME and Midyear Convention
 4. Regional Director
 5. Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee
 6. Midyear Convention Secretary
- G. For the Midyear Convention, the signatories of the Certificates of Appreciation for the Speakers shall be the:
1. President
 2. Board Secretary
 3. Chair of Committee on CME and Midyear Convention
 4. Regional Director
 5. Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee
 6. Midyear Convention Secretary
- H. For the Midyear Convention, the signatories of the Certificate of Appreciation given to the Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee shall be the:
1. President
 2. Board Secretary
 3. Chair of Committee on CME and Midyear Convention
 4. Regional Director
 5. Midyear Convention Secretary
- I. For International Conventions hosted by the POGS Foundation, the signatories of the Certificates of Attendance shall be:
1. President and Board Secretary of the International Society
 2. President
 3. Board Secretary
 4. Overall Chair of the Organizing Committee

- J. For Committee activities, the signatories shall be the:
1. President
 2. Board Secretary
 3. Chair of the Committee
- K. For awards given by the POGS Foundation, the signatories shall be the:
1. President
 2. Board Secretary
 3. Chair of the Committee on Awards
- L. For the Certificate of Good Standing, the signatories shall be the:
1. President
 2. Board Secretary
- M. For the PBOG Certificate of Accreditation, the signatories shall be the:
1. President
 2. PBOG Chair
 3. PBOG Secretary
 4. All PBOG Members
- N. For the Junior Member Certificate, the signatories shall be the:
1. President
 2. Board Secretary
 3. PBOG Chair
 4. PBOG Secretary
- O. For the Diplomate Certificate, the signatories shall be the:
1. President
 2. Board Secretary
 3. PBOG Chair
 4. PBOG Secretary
 5. All PBOG Members
- P. For the Fellow Certificate, the signatories shall be the:
1. President
 2. Board Secretary
- Q. For the Plaque of Distinction for the President, the signatories shall be:
1. Vice President
 2. Board Secretary

- R. For the Plaque / Certificate of Appreciation for the BOT Committee Chairs, Committee Chairs, PBOG Chair and Members and CREED Chair and Members given during the Annual Appreciation Dinner, the signatories shall be the:
1. President
 2. Board Secretary

POLICY ON ELECTRONIC SIGNATURES

I. DEFINITIONS

To establish clear governance within POGS Foundation operations, electronic signatures utilized within the POGS Foundation are categorized into three distinct frameworks:

1. Electronic Signature: Any letters, characters, numbers or a graphic image of a wet signature affixed to an electronic document digitally (e.g., pasting a signed image into a document or typing a name).
2. Biometric Signature: A method of authentication tied directly to unique physiological traits of the signatory, such as fingerprint or facial recognition.
3. Digital Signature: An advanced electronic signature created using asymmetric cryptography or Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) where a unique private key secures identity and prevents undetected modification after signing.

II. POGS FOUNDATION POLICY STATEMENT ON ELECTRONIC SIGNATURES

Electronic signatures are legally binding and confidential. All users are accountable for protecting their electronic signature credentials and ensuring that signed documents are accessed, transmitted and stored securely. Any misuse or compromise of electronic signatures constitutes a serious breach of institutional policy.

III. SCOPE

1. This policy applies to all BOT, members, employees and Administrative Staff of the POGS Foundation who utilize e-signature for clinical, academic and legal documents.
2. Electronic signatures are fully valid for daily office operations. However, a traditional wet-ink signature remains strictly required for financial documents and documents needing legal notarization, official affidavits or specific statutory forms.
3. All technical security measures are strictly managed under the POGS Data Privacy Manual in accordance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012.

IV. GUIDING PRINCIPLES

To ensure the legal validity and security of all electronic signatures, POGS Foundation adheres to the following core values and principles:

1. Confidentiality – refers to protection from unauthorized access
2. Integrity – the protection from alteration after signing
3. Authentication – the signatory identity must be reliably verified
4. Non-repudiation – the signatory cannot reasonably deny authorship of signed document
5. Accountability – infers that all e-signature activities shall be auditable.

V. DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

All POGS Foundation BOT, members, employees and Administrative Staff are individually responsible for ensuring the proper execution and security of all official signed documents.

1. Protocols for Affixing Electronic Signatures

The signatories shall:

- a. Utilize electronic signatures strictly on permitted documents pertaining to official office operations and communications.
- b. Affix electronic signatures only when there is an explicit, written legal authorization (through short message service [SMS] or email) to the specific transaction.
- c. Ensure their electronic signature is affixed only after the final content of the electronic document has been fully reviewed and verified.

2. The following are strictly prohibited:

- a. Pre-signing, embedding signature images into blank templates or unverified drafts, or retroactively dating an electronic signature
- b. Sharing passwords or login credentials used for electronic signing under any circumstances
- c. Using personal email accounts or unsecured personal devices to sign official POGS Foundation documents
- d. Bypassing required security logins, verification steps or tracking systems
- e. Affixing an electronic signature or signing on behalf of another person without explicit, written legal authorization

VI. TECHNICAL SECURITY MEASURES

1. Confidentiality Guidelines

a. Access Control and Authentication

- 1) Electronic signature systems shall require unique user credentials (username and password or biometric identifier).
- 2) Multi-factor authentication shall be reserved for high-risk and highly sensitive transactions (legal documents).
- 3) User credentials shall not be shared under any circumstances.
- 4) Access privileges shall follow the principle of least privilege.

b. Protection of Signature Creation Data

- 1) Passwords or biometric data used to create e-signature shall be stored in encrypted form and accessible only to the authorized signatory.
- 2) Signature creation data shall never be transmitted or stored in plain text.
- 3) Compromised or suspected compromise of signature credentials shall be reported immediately to the DPO.

c. Secure Transmission and Storage

- 1) All electronic documents containing e-signatures shall be transmitted using secure communication protocols.
- 2) Signed documents shall be stored in secure, access-controlled repositories.
- 3) Encryption at rest shall be required for repositories containing sensitive or confidential records.

d. Audit Trails and Monitoring

- 1) The e-signature system shall maintain tamper-evident audit logs capturing the identity of the signatory, date and time of signature, document version signed, Internet Protocol (IP) address or device identifier.
- 2) The audit logs shall be available only to authorized personnel and retained according to the POGS Foundation record-retention policy.

e. Document Integrity and Version Control

- 1) Once electronically signed, the document shall be locked to prevent modification.
- 2) Any subsequent changes shall require creation of new version and re-authentication and re-signing.
- 3) Digital fingerprinting shall be used to detect document tampering.

f. User Responsibilities and Training

- 1) Users are responsible for securing their devices used for e-signature.
- 2) Periodic training shall be conducted on the proper use of e-signature, confidentiality and data privacy obligations.

g. Incident Response and Breach Management

- 1) Suspected breaches shall be managed in accordance with the POGS Foundation Data Privacy and Incident Response Policy.
- 2) Immediate actions may include credential revocation, system access suspension and forensic investigation.
- 3) Affected parties shall be notified as required by applicable data protection laws.

h. Compliance with Laws and Standards

- 1) E-signature practices shall comply with Data Privacy Act 2012, and relevant international standards (International Organization for Standardization [ISO] / International Electrotechnical Commission [IEC] 27001; ISO / IEC 27002) including electronic commerce and e-signature laws.
- 2) Examples of Prohibited Practices:
 - i. Sharing of e-signature credentials
 - ii. Use of personal email or unsecured devices for signing official documents
 - iii. Circumventing authentication or audit controls
 - iv. Signing on behalf of another person

XII. INVITATIONS

A. Official Events of the POGS Foundation

1. All formal invitations issued by the POGS Foundation shall be worded in the third person form with the words placed on specified lines and centered as evenly as possible, in the following order:
Name/s of host/s on the first line; "request/s the pleasure of" on the second; name of guest on the third; and so on. The time must be expressed as, for example, "half past nine o'clock, or "half after nine o'clock", instead of "nine thirty".
2. The material and size of, and the lettering on the invitation card may vary according to the preference of the BOT. Simplicity in the design of the invitation card shall always be considered.

B. Host/Master of Ceremonies and Ushers

1. The Host/Master of Ceremonies shall be prompt and ready to start the program or event on time as specified in the invitation.
2. The Ushers shall assist in the seating of the guests.

C. Conferment of Awards

The Committee on Awards and Subcommittees on Programs and Invitations and PATS shall ensure that the families of the person in whose honor the award is given and that of the awardees are provided with prominent tables / seats.

XIII. THE FLAG OF THE REPUBLIC OF THE PHILIPPINES / NATIONAL ANTHEM

A. The National Anthem

1. The National Anthem / Flag Etiquette
The singing of the National Anthem shall always be done during the opening of any program of importance, be it scientific, socials, business or ceremonial.
2. When Sung With The Flag Undisplayed
The congregation shall stand at attention with hands on the side facing towards the source of the music.

3. When Sung With The Flag Displayed

The congregation shall stand at attention and looking towards the flag, the right hand placed over the left chest. The Philippine Flag shall be allowed to move freely and shall not be held during the singing of the national anthem.

4. The Philippine National Anthem shall:

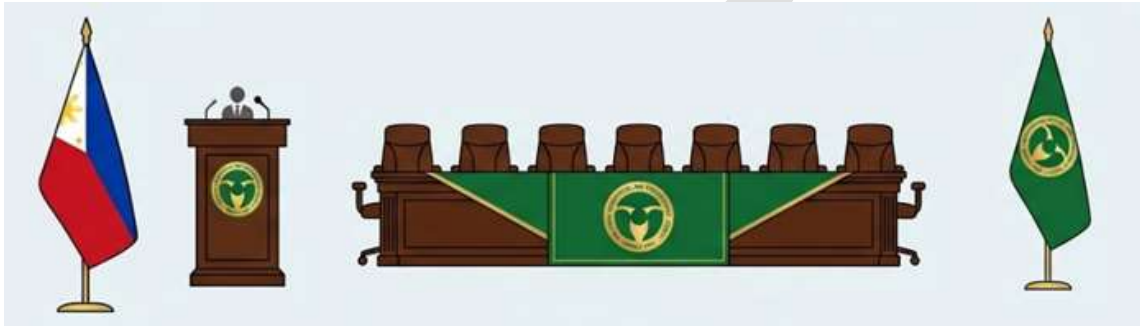
- a. Be played first before anthem of other countries.
- b. Conform to the specifications of the National Historical Institute.
- c. Be played with dignity.
- d. Never be jazzed up.
- e. Not be played as a medley; there should be no improvisation.
- f. Not be applauded at after playing.

B. Displaying the Flag of the Republic of the Philippines

1. When displayed with another flag from crossed staffs, the Philippine Flag shall be on the right (the flag's own right) and its staff shall be in front of the staff of the other flag.
2. When it is flown at half-mast, the Philippine Flag shall be hoisted to the peak for a moment and then lowered to the half-mast position, but before lowering the flag for the day, it shall again be raised to the peak.
3. When flags of provinces or cities or pennants of societies are flown on the same halyard with the Philippine Flag, the latter shall always be at the peak.
4. When flown from adjacent staffs, the Philippine Flag shall be hoisted first and lowered last.
5. When carried in a procession with another flag/s, the Philippine Flag shall either be on the marching right or, when there is a line of other flags, it shall be in front of the center of the line.
6. When a number of flags of provinces or cities or pennants of societies are grouped and displayed from staffs with the Philippine Flag, the latter shall be the center or at the highest point of the group.
7. When the flag of two (2) or more nations are displayed, they shall be flown in separate staffs of the same height and the flags shall be of approximate equal size. International usage forbids the display of the flag of one nation above that of another nation in time of peace.
8. The Philippine Flag shall be carefully protected in storage and in use so that it will not be damaged. Every precaution shall be taken to prevent it from becoming soiled or torn. Care shall always be taken so that the Philippine Flag will not touch the ground, water, nor the floor. Avoid brushing it against objects when handling it. The national emblem shall not be displayed in connection with advertisements of any kind.

XIV. DISPLAYING THE POGS FOUNDATION FLAG AND BANNER

- A. The POGS Foundation Flag shall be placed to the left of the Philippine Flag and when crossed, the staff shall be under the staff of the Philippine Flag.
- B. The POGS Foundation Banner shall be displayed at the center of the main rostrum. During Chapter meetings, the POGS Foundation Banner shall be displayed at the center of the main table and the Chapter Banner in front of the rostrum.



XV. MULTIMEDIA COMMUNICATIONS

- A. All media communications regarding projects, policies or announcements of the POGS Foundation or any standing or special committees shall be channeled through the PRO. Releases of local chapters or regional districts shall be the responsibility of the concerned chapter or region. The Secretariat shall be furnished a copy of such releases.
- B. Such releases shall be correct and proper and in accordance with accepted journalistic practices.
- C. The PRO shall be responsible for media coverage of programs or activities of the POGS Foundation, PMA, AOFOG and FIGO.
- D. Statements on controversial issues or issues of national concern shall have clearance from the BOT before release.
- E. Opinions, remarks or comments made by any member not coursed through the BOT shall not in any way reflect the views and position of the POGS Foundation.

XVI. MEDIA APPEARANCE / INTERVIEWS

- A. Invitations for multimedia appearance shall be coursed through the PRO.
- B. The PRO shall screen all invitations and make recommendations to the BOT.
- C. The PRO shall observe the following guidelines in pre-screening invitations for interview:
 - 1. If the interview seeks information, the interviewee shall observe the following guidelines:
 - a. Stick to facts or information based on available evidence.
 - b. Avoid advancing personal opinion.
 - c. Adhere strictly to the PMA Code of Ethics and the POGS Foundation Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct 2025 Edition, and avoid using the opportunity to advertise his/her own private practice, personal techniques, or methods.
 - 2. If the interview seeks opinions or comments from key opinion leaders or prominent personalities:
 - a. Discussion shall be based on resolutions passed by the BOT.
 - b. Personal opinions shall be discouraged.
 - c. If the subject is about a certain subspecialty, it shall be referred to the proper subspecialties.
 - d. If the interview is to feature POGS Foundation as a society, the President shall accept the interview or delegate to a member of his/her choice.
- D. Interviews without prior notice shall not be entertained.
- E. For any type of interview, the following guidelines shall be observed:
 - 1. Know the purpose and topic of the interview, and ask beforehand what questions will be asked.
 - 2. Know what company or media enterprise the interviewer represents.
 - 3. Make a self-assessment if one is capable of handling the interview as an expert on the topic.
 - 4. Ask for a copy of the interview.

XVII. CORPORATE SEAL

The Corporate Seal shall be kept by the Secretariat and used on official certificates and important documents.

XVIII. POGS FOUNDATION LOGO AND REGIONAL / CHAPTER LOGO

The Regional / Chapter / PBOG / CREED Logo may be used in the letterhead, publicity materials, paraphernalias and infographics of the respective entities provided that they are placed below the official

POGS Foundation Logo seen at the left-hand side of the document. The size of the Logo shall be smaller than the official POGS Foundation Logo.

XIX. FELLOWS' / DIPLOMATE'S PLEDGE

The POGS Foundation shall adopt a Fellows' / Diplomate's Pledge which shall be signed and affirmed to by all members upon admission and kept in the official files of the POGS Foundation.

DIPLOMATE/FELLOWS' PLEDGE

I solemnly pledge to uphold the Constitution and ByLaws of the Philippine Obstetrical and Gynecological Society, Inc.

I shall always place the welfare of my patients above all considerations holding myself accountable for all health care decisions.

I shall conduct myself with honor and integrity, limiting my practice as defined by my training.

I shall extend to my colleagues a helping hand so that my calling shall always command respect.

I shall constantly endeavor to improve myself by study, association or travel thus advancing the science and art of my specialty.

I shall share with the profession whatever may come my way in the form of discovery, invention, improvement or observation.

I shall abide with the ethical and professional guidelines set by the society in the practice of my specialty.

As righteous individuals and health care professionals, I shall embrace and embody, at all times, the core values of the Society namely: Integrity, Competence, Accountability, Compassion and Innovation.

I swear that I will faithfully discharge to the best of my ability the duties and responsibilities as DIPLOMATE of the Philippine Obstetrical and Gynecological Society, Inc.

SO HELP ME GOD.

CHAPTER 13

HOSTING CONVENTIONS IN COORDINATION WITH INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

I. THE POGS Foundation SHALL:

- A. Bid to host an international convention upon approval by the BOT.
- B. Submit at least two (2) years prior to the intended date of the actual convention, or as the International Society so stipulates.
- C. Present in the bid that the date shall coincide with the POGS Annual Convention.
- D. Sign a formal contract / MOA as host with the international organization upon successful bid.

II. AD HOC COMMITTEE: COMPOSITION, TASKS AND RESPONSIBILITIES

- A. The Ad Hoc Committee shall:
 - 1. Be formed by the President with approval by the BOT.
 - 2. Serve as the local Organizing Committee upon a successful bid for the preparation and conduct of the convention, without prejudice to additional membership.
 - 3. Prepare a full proposal for the bid and present to the BOT prior to the international organization's presentation.
 - 4. Submit periodic reports to the BOT to ensure continuity, oversight and accountability.
 - 5. Coordinate with the Organizing Committee of the International Organization as to protocols and related matters.
 - 6. Collaborate with local Organizing Committee of the Annual Convention of the year being hosted.
- B. The BOT shall retain overall authority over the international convention based on the guidelines of both organizations, including approval of major decisions, policies and financial arrangements, upon the recommendation of the Ad Hoc Committee constituted for this purpose.

III. FINANCES

An agreement shall be forged between POGS Foundation and the international organization's EXECOM regarding the projected revenue from the convention.

CHAPTER 14
COLLABORATION WITH LOCAL / SUBSPECIALTY AND AFFILIATE SOCIETIES

I. RESPONSIBILITY OF THE SUBSPECIALTY AND AFFILIATE SOCIETIES

The national Subspecialty and Affiliate Society shall:

- A. Submit a proposal to the BOT on hosting an international convention in partnership with the POGS Foundation at least two (2) years prior to the proposed date of convention.
- B. Be endorsed by the POGS Foundation through the BOT upon the approval of the proposal.
- C. Form an Organizing Committee where members are from the POGS Foundation.
- D. Submit a periodic report to POGS Foundation through the BOT member.
- E. Handle submission of necessary permits / documents for the conference.
- F. Comply with all necessary documents for the undertaking with the POGS Foundation.

II. RESPONSIBILITY OF POGS

POGS Foundation shall:

- A. Monitor the progress of the collaboration.
- B. Undertake an active role in the committees mutually agreed upon with local/subspecialty and affiliate societies.
- C. Submit to BOT through the liaison officer the proceedings and audited financial report.

III. The CPD accreditation shall be for the sole use of POGS Foundation activities, without consideration.

CHAPTER 15

MISCELLANEOUS PROVISIONS

I. USE OF POGS EQUIPMENT AND MATERIALS

The equipment and materials include, but are not limited to: training models, community service materials (i.e. speculum, drop lights, cryotherapy), and POGS Foundation toga.

A. Priorities in the Use of the Equipment and Materials

1. The use of POGS equipment and materials shall be on a first come-first served basis.
2. The Committees shall avail of the use of these equipment and materials, provided that it is for a POGS-related activity, as approved by the BOT.

B. Custodian of the Equipment and/or Materials

1. The Executive Officer shall take charge of the safekeeping of the equipment and materials. He/she shall assign a member of the Secretariat for the implementation of the use, maintenance and safekeeping of the equipment and materials. The Executive Officer shall be responsible to the Board Secretary and the BOT.
2. The approval of the Board Secretary shall be secured prior to release of equipment and materials for any function. In his/her absence, he/she shall delegate this responsibility to one of the BOT in writing, with concurrence of the President.

C. Procedures in the Use of Equipment and/or Materials

1. An inventory shall be done before and after the use of the equipment and/or materials.
2. Procedure in borrowing of equipment and/or materials:
 - a. A Borrower's Slip shall be submitted one (1) week before the actual date of usage of the equipment and/or material. (Appendix IV: Training Model and Equipment Borrower's Form)
 - b. The Borrower's Slip shall be approved by the Executive Officer.

D. Responsibilities of the User/Committee

1. The user/committee shall ensure safekeeping of the equipment and/or materials.
2. In case of damage or loss due to gross negligence, it shall be the responsibility of the user/committee to shoulder the expense (based on fair market value) of the repair or replacement of the equipment and/or materials.

GUIDELINES ON BORROWING AND USE OF PELVIC MODULES

1. Purpose of Use
The pelvic models and other training materials shall be used solely for legitimate educational, training, skills enhancement, and other POGS Foundation-approved learning activities.
2. Request and Approval
Borrowers shall submit a written request indicating the purpose, venue and duration of use. Release of the pelvic models and other training materials shall be subject to approval by the BOT or officer designated by the POGS Foundation. (Appendix IV: Training Model and Equipment Borrower's Form)
3. Release and Return of Items
The pelvic models and other training materials shall be released on the approved date of borrowing and must be returned immediately after the completion of the activity, unless an extension has been approved in writing.
4. Duty of Care
The borrower shall exercise due care and diligence in handling, transporting, storing and using the pelvic models and other training materials to prevent loss, theft, damage or deterioration.
5. Liability for Loss or Damage
The borrower shall be responsible for any loss, damage, destruction or misuse of the pelvic models and other training materials while under his/her custody. The borrower may be required to repair, replace or reimburse the POGS Foundation for the cost of the lost or damaged item, subject to evaluation by the POGS Foundation.
6. Inspection Upon Return
The pelvic models and other training materials shall be inspected by the designated staff upon return to determine their condition and completeness. Any deficiency, loss, or damage shall be documented and reported accordingly.
7. Non-Transferability
Borrowed pelvic models and other training materials shall not be lent, transferred, or assigned to any other individual or organization without the prior written approval of the POGS Foundation.

II. TRANSPORTATION

A. POGS Foundation VANS

1. It is understood that the vehicle is a property of the POGS Foundation and shall be used primarily for official activities of the Foundation.
2. The Chair of the activity, any Officer and/or the Secretariat shall be responsible to make the request at least one (1) to two (2) weeks before the official date of activity.

3. The Executive Officer shall be responsible for the implementation of this policy. An official Dispatch Form (Trip Ticket) should be properly complied with, endorsed by the Executive Officer and to be approved by the Board Secretary and/or the President before the vehicle is released for use.
4. Replenishment of gasoline and toll fees shall be validated by an official receipt dated during the inception date/s of activity.
5. Hiring of a driver shall be on a case-to-case basis, to be determined in advance and with prior approval by the Board Secretary and/or the President.
6. In case of damages, the POGS Foundation shall be responsible for the accidental or unforeseen circumstances incurred during the official undertaking of the activity. It is understood that the user/driver shall be held liable for damages due to personal negligence.
7. Any other policies governing the use of the vehicle shall be subject for approval by the BOT.
8. A system of prioritization shall be made based on need, and the use of transportation network vehicle services (e.g. Grab) shall be considered as an alternative.
9. It is the responsibility of the Executive Officer to look into the ways and means to cater to all the activities of the committees.
10. All Trip Tickets and/or transaction histories used by the committees shall be kept on file.

B. Third Party Transport Service Provider

1. Outsourcing of transportation service shall be allowed only when the use of the POGS Foundation vans is not feasible.
2. In requesting service from third party transport service provider, the following methods shall be undertaken according to priority of the committee.
3. It is the responsibility of the Executive Officer to seek approval to the Board Secretary or Treasurer whenever additional service is needed.
4. A letter of request for a third party transport service provider must be submitted to the Executive Officer one (1) week before the date of usage. The Executive Officer shall affix his/her signature on the quotation and forward to the Board Secretary or Treasurer for approval prior to booking the service.
5. A duplicate copy of the conforme and/or statement of account signed by the Chair of the Committee must be submitted to the Accounting Department in preparation for payment.
6. The meal allowance, salary and overtime rate of the third party service provider shall be determined by the BOT.

III. USE OF MEETING ROOMS IN THE POGS FOUNDATION BUILDING

These include the Assembly Hall, Board Room and other meeting rooms.

A. Priorities in the Use of Meeting Rooms

1. The use of meeting rooms shall be on a first come-first served basis.
2. The following shall avail of the use of meeting rooms, provided it is for a POGS Foundation-related activity:
 - a. All committees and its instrumentalities
 - b. Regional Districts, Chapters and Clusters

B. Custodian of the Use of Meeting Rooms

1. The Executive Officer shall take charge of schedules in the use of the meeting rooms. He/she shall assign a member of the Secretariat to oversee the preparation, set-up and maintenance of the meeting rooms. The Executive Officer shall be responsible to the Board Secretary and the BOT.
2. The approval of the Board Secretary shall be secured prior to use of the meeting rooms for any function. In his/her absence, he/she shall delegate this responsibility to one of the BOT in writing, with concurrence of the President.

C. Procedures in Reserving the Use of the Meeting Rooms

1. The procedures in reserving the use of the meeting rooms is channeled through the Executive Officer.
2. The various rooms may be reserved by the subspecialty and affiliate societies or other organizations subject to a maintenance fee as determined by the BOT.

IV. USE OF POGS FOUNDATION DORMITORY

A. Purpose

These guidelines regulate the proper, safe and equitable use of the POGS Foundation Dormitory to support members in good standing who require temporary accommodation in relation to official functions and activities of the POGS Foundation.

B. Coverage and Eligibility

1. Only Fellows and Diplomates in good standing are eligible for accommodation, subject to approval by the BOT.
2. POGS Foundation employees may be allowed use of the dormitory under specific conditions (Section D.3).

C. General Principles

1. The dormitory is a shared institutional resource and must be used responsibly.
2. Priority shall always be given to official POGS Foundation-related use over personal use.
3. Utilization of the dormitory shall be prioritized over booking hotel accommodations whenever feasible.

D. Priority of Use and Fees

1. Accommodation shall be provided free of charge to members in good standing under the following:
 - a. Attendance at official POGS Foundation meetings, board functions, committee activities or POGS Foundation-sanctioned events in Metro Manila
 - b. Transitional accommodation prior to travel to a province for an official POGS Foundation activity
 - c. Regional officers during inception dates of official POGS Foundation functions.
2. Fee-Based Use
 - a. Other members in good standing may avail of the dormitory for personal or non-official purposes, subject to availability and BOT-approved fees.
 - b. Member's immediate family (spouse and/or child) may be accommodated with the member, subject to availability and BOT-prescribed regulations.
3. Use by POGS Foundation employees is allowed only under the following circumstances:
 - a. Official function beyond office hours
 - b. Official function with travel requirement
 - c. Emergency or inclement weather conditionsRequests must be submitted through the Executive Officer for endorsement to the Board Secretary and/or President. In their absence, they may delegate this responsibility to any two (2) available BOT.

E. Reservation and Confirmation

1. Reservations shall be made at least one (1) week prior to intended use.
2. Requests shall include complete occupant details and may be submitted via:
 - a. Written request
 - b. Telephone or text message
 - c. E-mail
3. All reservations must be confirmed prior to check-in.
4. Official-use reservations take precedence over personal-use bookings when necessary.

F. Duration of Stay

1. Stay shall be limited to the period necessary for the stated purpose.
2. Extensions require approval from the Board Secretary.

G. Billing, Payment, and Cancellation

1. Billing is computed on a per night basis.
2. For stays of two (2) or more nights, a down payment equivalent to one (1) night is required upon reservation or check-in.
3. Single-night stays shall be paid in full upon check-in.
4. Payment methods:
 - a. Cash
 - b. GCash
 - c. Current dated personal check
 - d. Bank-to-bank payment (applicable charges shall be borne by the occupant)
5. An Official Receipt shall be issued for all payments.
6. Cancellation policy:
 - a. Cancellation shall be made at least twenty four (24) hours prior to check-in.
 - b. No-show or late cancellation results in forfeiture of reservation and payment.

H. House Rules and Housekeeping

1. Cleanliness and proper decorum shall be observed at all times.
2. Daily room cleaning shall be provided upon request and shall be performed by the Maintenance.
3. Linen shall be changed every three (3) days unless earlier replacement is requested (subject to fee).
4. The following are strictly prohibited within the premises:
 - a. Smoking ("No Smoking" policy enforced) or Vaping
 - b. Alcoholic beverages

- c. Firearms and deadly weapons
- d. Prohibited drugs
- e. Cooking and laundry activities
- f. Use of stove and other flammable items

I. Security and Safety Measures

- 1. Only registered occupants shall be allowed inside the dormitory.
- 2. Deliveries and business transactions shall be conducted at the guard's counter.
- 3. Regular security checks shall be conducted by POGS Foundation security personnel; occupants may request privacy with prior notice.
- 4. POGS Foundation shall not be liable for loss or damage to personal belongings.
- 5. Occupants shall familiarize themselves with entry/exit points for emergencies.
- 6. Occupants with special health concerns shall inform the designated officer or security personnel.

J. Amenities and Other Services

- 1. The following shared amenities are available:
 - a. Television
 - b. Refrigerator
 - c. Hot shower
 - d. Internet services
- 2. Additional appliances brought in by occupants require prior approval and may be subject to fees.
- 3. Hair dryer and electric flat iron are available upon request.
- 4. Parking is available within the POGS Foundation premises for occupants' vehicles, subject to space availability.

K. Administration

- 1. The Secretariat shall oversee implementation, reservations and records.
- 2. The BOT shall determine applicable fees and policies.

OVERNIGHT STAY OF POGS FOUNDATION EMPLOYEES IN THE POGS BUILDING DURING OFFICIAL ACTIVITIES

1. Purpose

This policy establishes guidelines for personnel who are required or permitted to stay overnight in the office during official activities, ensuring safety, accountability and proper use of facilities.

2. Scope

This applies to all employees involved in officially sanctioned activities requiring extended hours or overnight presence in the office.

3. General Policy

Overnight stay in the office is not allowed unless authorized by the Board Secretary and must be directly related to official functions, deadlines, or scheduled events.

4. Authorization

- Prior written approval must be obtained from the Executive Officer
- A list of authorized personnel staying overnight must be submitted to Executive Officer/Security before the activity.

5. Permissible Situations

Overnight stay may be allowed under the following conditions:

- Official events, conventions, PBOG and CREED examinations
- Urgent deadlines requiring extended work hours
- Emergencies or unforeseen circumstances
- Logistical necessity (e.g. early morning activity preparation)

6. Safety and Security Measures

- All individuals must log in and out with security personnel.
- Office access shall be limited to designated areas only.
- Emergency contact details must be available.
- Compliance with fire safety and building regulations is mandatory.

7. Use of Facilities

- Office equipment and spaces must be used responsibly.
- Sleeping arrangements should be confined to designated areas, if any.
- Cleanliness and order must be maintained at all times.

8. Code of Conduct

- Professional behavior is expected at all times.
- Consumption of alcohol, smoking (except in designated areas), or any prohibited activities is strictly forbidden.
- Respect for shared spaces and other personnel must be observed.

9. Liability

The POGS Foundation shall not be liable for personal belongings. Individuals are responsible for their own valuables.

10. Violations

Failure to comply with this policy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with POGS Foundation rules.

11. Effectivity

This policy takes effect immediately upon approval and shall remain in force until amended or revoked.

V. USE OF THE ELEVATOR

1. The elevator shall be operational during office hours.
2. There shall be no elevator service beyond office hours, except when there are official functions.
3. The Executive Officer shall be responsible for the operation and scheduling of the preventive maintenance of the elevator.

VI. BEREAVEMENT AND SYMPATHY FUND

A. Background

1. As part of POGS Foundation social responsibility, wreath/flower/mass card is being sent to the immediate family of the:
 - a. Past and Present BOT
 - b. Past and Present PBOG and CREED Members
 - c. Past and Present Regional Directors
 - d. Past Presidents
 - e. Their immediate relative (parent, spouse, child)
 - f. Past and Present Secretariat who has served for at least 5 years
 - g. Secretariat's immediate relative (parent, spouse, child)
2. Depending on the proximity, it is usually done when information is forwarded to the national office, conveyed to and approved by the concerned officer of the BOT.

B. Guidelines

1. Past and Present Members of the BOT, PBOG and CREED Members, and Regional Directors
In the event of the death of a past or present member of the BOT, PBOG or CREED, or a Regional Director, the POGS Foundation shall provide:
 - a. A Mass Card

- b. Commissioning of a church and offering of Mass, when appropriate, for a nominal fee
 - c. A standing spray or basket of flowers worth up to P6,000.00
- 2. Immediate Relative of a Past or Present Member of the BOT, PBOG or CREED, or Regional Director
For the death of an immediate relative of a past or present member of the BOT, PBOG or CREED, or a Regional Director, the POGS Foundation shall provide:
 - a. A Mass Card
 - b. A standing spray or basket of flowers worth up to P6,000.00.
- 3. Past Presidents
For the death of a Past President, the POGS Foundation shall provide:
 - a. A Mass Card
 - b. Commissioning of a church and offering of Mass, when appropriate, for a nominal fee
 - c. A standing spray or basket of flowers worth up to P6,000.00
 - d. A necrological service to be offered by the incumbent BOT
- 4. Past and Present Executive Officers
For the death of a past or present Executive Officer, the POGS Foundation shall provide:
 - a. A Mass Card
 - b. A standing spray or basket of flowers
 - c. A cash donation in an amount to be determined by the BOT
- 5. Secretariat
 - a. For the death of a present Secretariat staff member or a former Secretariat staff member who has rendered at least five (5) years of service to the POGS Foundation, the POGS Foundation may provide a cash donation in an amount to be determined by the BOT.
 - b. For the death of an immediate relative of a Secretariat staff member, the POGS Foundation may provide a cash donation in an amount to be determined by the BOT.
- 6. External Support Staff
For the death of an external support staff member, the POGS Foundation may provide a cash donation in an amount to be determined by the BOT.